

FINITE FAILURE SCHEMES AND THE RECONSTRUCTION OF QUADRATIC PENCILS

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ABSTRACT. Every complex quadratic pencil, including singular pencils, is recovered from its unmarked, ungraded finite failure algebra at a sharp order. The relative inverse recovers moving pencils and their actual source bundles over smooth connected projective reductions. We study the intrinsic first-relation boundary on the maximal-lower-Hilbert-function stratum through the finite normalization of a degree-prescribed common-divisor image. Beyond its exact normal locus and nonreduced normalization fibres, we determine completed local rings on the coprime two-divisor stratum and along collisions of two common binary roots. These models give conductors, intrinsic singular ideals, branch intersections, and exact Cohen–Macaulay criteria. A scalar-matrix contraction connects this geometry to the pencil inverse: the first-relation orbit closures of all pencils contain a common ramified boundary point. Its exact gcd and entire normalization-fibre algebra follow from the osculating filtration of a flag coefficient representation. In dimension three the unique normalization point has a fibre of embedding dimension forty-four. The all-pencil inverse, nonreduced-base rigidifications, transverse fixed-support families, covering-map reconstruction, and spectral Fitting data form a single intrinsic reconstruction theory.

1. INTRODUCTION

A degeneracy locus usually forgets the map that defines it. We study an inverse problem in which neither the ambient embedding nor the normal directions are retained: can the abstract nonreduced failure scheme recover a quadratic pencil? The answer is affirmative for every complex pencil, including singular pencils. The first relation, rather than its reduced determinant support, carries this information. The inverse is also global: a thickening over a projective reduction recovers an entire varying pencil subbundle and its actual source bundle, up to one constant left transformation. No fibrewise choice of coordinates or projective line-bundle ambiguity is left. A single unmarked local algebra suffices for the constant-pencil problem; a Schubert line gives another geometric realization.

Let V be a complex vector space of dimension $n \geq 3$, and put

$$W = \operatorname{Sym}^2 V, \quad N = \binom{n+1}{2}, \quad R \in \operatorname{Gr}(2, W), \quad S_R = W/R, \quad p = N - 2.$$

The cube-zero algebra $A_R = \mathbb{C} \oplus V \oplus S_R$ has multiplication $\operatorname{Sym}^2 V \twoheadrightarrow S_R$, with $(V \oplus S_R)S_R = 0$. On $X_R = \operatorname{Gr}(n, V \oplus S_R)$, let $\mathcal{K}$ denote the tautological bundle. For any $m \geq 2$, set

$$\widehat{D}_R = V(\operatorname{Fitt}_0 \operatorname{coker}[\operatorname{Sym}^m(\mathcal{O} \oplus \mathcal{K}) \longrightarrow A_R \otimes \mathcal{O}]). \quad (1.1)$$

This is the maximal-minor scheme of multiplication, not merely its support. It is independent of $m \geq 2$. Its reduction is the Schubert divisor where $\mathcal{K} \rightarrow V$ drops rank. Write $B_R = \operatorname{Gr}(n, S_R)$,

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let $\mathfrak{b}_R$ be its ideal in $\widehat{D}_R$, and define

$$Z_R^{[k]} = V(\mathfrak{b}_R^{k+1}) \subset \widehat{D}_R, \quad d = n + 2p = n^2 + 2n - 4.$$

An isomorphism of these neighbourhoods means an abstract complex scheme isomorphism; it is supplied with no ambient or tensor marking.

Theorem 1.1 (Sharp intrinsic reconstruction). *For all quadratic pencils $R, R' \subset \text{Sym}^2 V$,*

$$Z_R^{[d]} \simeq Z_{R'}^{[d]} \iff R' = gR \text{ for some } g \in \text{PGL}(V).$$

For every $0 \leq k < d$, the isomorphism class of $Z_R^{[k]}$ is independent of R . Thus d is the smallest uniform reconstruction order. The same statements hold after restriction, using the graph projection, to any Schubert line in B_R . The resulting abstract curve-supported neighbourhood is independent of the choice of that line.

The Grassmannian statement is Theorem 13.1. The curve-supported statement is Corollary 14.2. Its more general form, Theorem 14.1, applies over any smooth connected projective curve with a rank- n bundle having nontrivial projectivization. For example, $\mathcal{O}_C(-P) \oplus \mathcal{O}_C^{n-1}$ works on every such pointed curve. The curve is intrinsic as the reduction; a chosen embedding of the curve is not part of the isomorphism data.

1.1. A moving family, not only its individual fibres. The same finite object also reconstructs a pencil that varies over its projective reduction. Let B be a smooth connected projective complex variety, let $\mathcal{U}$ have rank n , and let $\mathcal{R}$ be a rank-two subbundle of $\text{Sym}^2 V \otimes \mathcal{O}_B$ with locally free quotient. Use the local ideal $(\det T)I_p(\gamma \text{Sym}^2 T)$ in $\text{Hom}(\mathcal{U}, V)$ and truncate at order d . Theorem 16.2 states that two resulting abstract finite schemes are isomorphic exactly when their data are related by an isomorphism of reduced bases, one constant linear left map, and an actual isomorphism of the source bundles, carrying one pencil subbundle to the other. The projection and both tensor factors are forgotten in the input. The varying coefficient line is recovered as a subbundle, not by pointwise choices of projective coordinates.

This strengthens the constant-pencil curve theorem in two directions: the reduced base and source bundle may vary in the comparison, and the pencil need not be constant on that base. Example 15.6 has a nonconstant unordered cross-ratio and six spectral collision points, all retained by the same finite scheme. Theorem 15.4 then identifies the remaining freedom in an isomorphism. Its quotient is the group of the recovered linear data; its kernel acts trivially on the associated graded scheme and has a terminating commutator filtration. Explicit nonlinear shears show why that kernel cannot be omitted. These statements are consequences of the unmarked inverse, not additional claims of novelty for the classical Pluecker map or for spectral cross-ratios.

1.2. A single unmarked local algebra suffices. The strongest form of the inverse needs no positive-dimensional support. Choose an n -dimensional source space U , write $T = (t_{ij})$ for its universal map to V , and let $\mathfrak{m} = (t_{ij})$. Define

$$\mathfrak{A}_R^{[d]} = \mathbb{C}[t_{ij}] / ((\det T)I_p(\gamma_R \text{Sym}^2 T) + \mathfrak{m}^{d+1}).$$

Theorem 1.2 (Local algebraic inverse). *For every pair of complex quadratic pencils, an ungraded algebra isomorphism $\mathfrak{A}_R^{[d]} \simeq \mathfrak{A}_{R'}^{[d]}$ exists if and only if $R' = gR$ for some $g \in \text{PGL}(V)$. The order $d = n^2 + 2n - 4$ is the smallest uniform order already for these single-point objects.*

The full statement and proof are Theorem 16.3. Proposition 2.1 separates the general truncation argument from the pencil-specific orbit rigidity: nonlinear coordinate changes form an explicitly described unipotent kernel, whereas the first relation space carries the reconstruction data. The extra local ingredient is that the residual coefficient module has factor-support ranks $(1, \binom{N}{2})$.

Transposition reverses these unequal ranks and therefore cannot carry one pencil ideal to another. This orients the unordered matrix factors without a nontrivial projective bundle. Theorem 16.2 consequently removes that restriction from the moving-family theorem as well. This is not a claim that the reduced determinant cone alone remembers the pencil: the nonreduced first relation kernel and its residual coefficients are indispensable. Proposition 16.4 also identifies the entire tangent-identity kernel, including its affine-space parametrization and nonadditive group law.

1.3. Conductors, collision singularities, and actual failure orbits. Normalization alone does not describe the gluing of its branches. Theorems 8.1 and 8.3 determine two successive local models. On the coprime two-divisor stratum the completed image is

$$\mathbb{C}[[z, x_1, \dots, x_c, y_1, \dots, y_c]]/(x_i y_j).$$

Its conductor is (x, y) , its intrinsic singular ideal is $(x, y)^c$, and its depth is $\dim(z) + 1$. When two common binary roots collide, the model is instead

$$\mathbb{C}[[u, \Delta]] \oplus (u_1, \dots, u_m)t \subset \mathbb{C}[[u, t]], \quad \Delta = t^2,$$

up to a specified smooth factor. Its conductor has a ramified double cover in the normalization. These formulas determine the Cohen–Macaulay cases and distinguish the singular scheme from its reduced support. Proposition 9.1 organizes the reduced intersections of different divisor-degree images by the common part of two chosen divisors.

The boundary also has a direct role in the pencil inverse. Theorem 10.1 constructs a common point in every intrinsic first-relation orbit closure of a pencil failure algebra. A scalar-matrix contraction of the flag-pencil relation has gcd a^{D-q_n} , where $q_3 = 3$ and $q_n = 4$ for $n \geq 4$. The selected degree- $n(n-1)$ divisor is unique but ramified; its normalization fibre has tangent dimension $\binom{n^2+3n-5-q_n}{3n-4-q_n} - 1$. Proposition 10.3 gives its entire Artin algebra by reciprocal-polynomial equations. This specializes *actual* failure algebras through flat families; it does not merely place an unrelated common-factor example beside the inverse theorem. The exact order of the flag coefficient filtration, proved in Lemma 10.2, is the link between the pencil representation and the divisor collision.

1.4. Factorization loci and the geometric comparison. The normalization mechanism has classical precedents. Chipalkatti’s coincident-root locus parametrizes one binary form with a prescribed root partition. His Proposition 5.1, Theorem 5.4, and Corollary 5.8 distinguish multiple normalization points from failure of tangent injectivity and describe the singular support [19]. Kurmann gives local incidence equations, proves their scheme-theoretic equality in Theorem 1.5, and expresses smoothness through splittings of partitions in Proposition 2.1 [20]. In particular, uniqueness plus tangent injectivity is not a new general principle of the present paper.

Here the datum is an r -plane of forms in e variables, not one binary form; the selected divisor has prescribed degree, not a root partition. The residual datum is a Grassmannian subspace, and for $e > 2$ divisor degrees need not fill an interval. These changes produce high-codimension conductor strata and non-Cohen–Macaulay branch gluings. Theorems 8.1 and 8.3 compute the image rings, not merely the incidence graph or singular support. Ferrand’s conductor-square formalism [21] is the standard algebraic framework; the particular conductor ideals, singular Fitting ideals, and depths are calculated here for these Grassmannian strata.

There is a second, closer binary comparison. Hu–Lin–Shao [23, §2.2, Corollary 3.6, and Theorem 1.1] study tuples of binary forms, define common-factor strata using resultant homomorphisms, and resolve the map-space boundary by successive blow-ups. On the open set of linearly independent r -tuples, passing to their span is the frame quotient onto $\mathrm{Gr}(r, S_D)$; the common-divisor condition is invariant under this quotient. Thus our binary loci genuinely meet that theory rather than forming an unrelated example. We do not identify its resultant

scheme structure with our image structure without a scheme comparison, nor claim a new general resolution. Our multivariate local rings and the pencil-orbit boundary are the specific additional conclusions.

Rigidification is used as infrastructure, not as an independent headline innovation. The appropriate primary general result is Abramovich–Olsson–Vistoli, Appendix A, Theorem A.1 [22], for compatible flat finitely presented normal inertia subgroups, without a centrality assumption. Our argument identifies the particular substitution subgroup and twisted right-factor subgroup and retains their actual group laws. The boundary statement is on the maximal-lower-Hilbert-function first-relation stratum throughout.

The comparison with regular-pencil Segre strata is made in Remark 10.5. The common closed flag orbit is not presented as a new classification of congruence orbits. The new pencil-side conclusion is its explicit ramified boundary under intrinsic cotangent changes, together with the complete normalization-fibre algebra. The separate documentary status of Ballico’s 1993 paper, discussed below, remains unchanged: absent its full theorem text, no nonanticipation conclusion is drawn.

1.5. The intrinsic mechanism. In the graph neighbourhood of B_R , with tautological bundle $\mathcal{U}$ and graph map $T : \mathcal{U} \rightarrow V$, the ideal is

$$(\det T)I_p(\gamma_R \operatorname{Sym}^2 T).$$

Its generators have degree d . This degree calculation alone only explains why lower orders are constant. The inverse requires three further intrinsic operations. Multiplication in the finite scheme recovers the first relation kernel and hence the whole homogeneous cone. The rank-one Fano scheme of its reduced determinant cone then recovers the two tensor rulings. On the socle Grassmannian one may distinguish them by projective triviality, already on a Schubert line. In general the unequal coefficient-support ranks orient them without that restriction. Properness forces the induced map to $\operatorname{PGL}(V)$ to be constant. After choosing its linear lift, the actual normal-bundle map lies in the commutant of $\operatorname{End}(V)$, which recovers the right bundle without a line twist (Lemma 4.2). Finally, cancellation of the intrinsic determinant ideal recovers the coefficient module. For pencils its exterior representation is irreducible, and exterior duality identifies its single coefficient line with the Pluecker line of R .

Theorem 11.1 separates this geometric mechanism from the particular multiplication algebra. The curve theorem shows why the mechanism is not tied to the dimension of the original parameter Grassmannian. The geometric orientation used here has a local replacement: coefficient-support asymmetry. Theorem 16.3 uses it to reconstruct the pencil from one unmarked Artin local algebra.

Theorem 4.3 gives the broader principle. It reconstructs simultaneously varying subspaces in several Schur modules from the unmarked first-relation thickening, provided one coefficient support is nonzero and proper. The coefficient spaces may have arbitrary prescribed ranks; they need not be lines coming from quadratic pencils. Its proof isolates the actual factor-descent step from classical linear-preserver theory. Example 4.4 shows why the global descent is not equivalent to fibrewise reconstruction: two Zariski locally trivial families have the same Artin fibre and isomorphic nilradical graded vector bundles in every degree, but their abstract total schemes differ. The inverse detects the inequivalent degree-three coefficient maps. This is the mechanism behind the moving-pencil theorem, rather than an assertion of novelty for canonical grading or for the numerical value of the first relation degree.

1.6. An exact image criterion and a pencil-native global consequence. The coefficient inverse admits an intrinsic converse. Theorem 5.1 starts with an unmarked first relation whose homogeneous radical is a determinant cone. After recovering its unordered rulings, invariance under one full factor group is necessary and sufficient for the residual relation to come from

coefficient subspaces in the Cauchy modules. Both orderings satisfy this test precisely when every coefficient support is zero or full. Thus the strict-support condition is exactly the criterion for a unique admissible orientation in the recognized class. Theorem 5.2 computes its entire affine stabilizer, including the transpose component and the universal nonlinear automorphism kernel. Corollary 5.4 expresses the inverse as an equivalence of geometric orbit sets, with those ambiguities specified rather than suppressed.

A global consequence lies inside the quadratic-pencil problem itself. Fix a plane $H = \langle x, y \rangle \subset V$. For a degree- m map $f = [a : b] : \mathbb{P}^1 \rightarrow \mathbb{P}(H)$, take the pencil subbundle

$$\mathcal{R}_f = (ax + by)H.$$

Every fibre is equivalent to $\langle x^2, xy \rangle$. Nevertheless, Theorem 21.1 proves

$$Y_f \simeq Y_{f'} \iff f' = \alpha \circ f \circ \sigma, \quad \alpha, \sigma \in \mathrm{PGL}_2(\mathbb{C}),$$

for their unmarked order- d failure thickenings with trivial source bundle. Their fibre algebras and every nilradical graded vector bundle depend only on n, m , not on f . Their abstract pencil, quotient and first-relation bundles are fixed as well. Thus the entire covering equivalence problem, not only one chosen pair, is retained in the global multiplication and is invisible to those additive data. The maps z^3 and $z^3 + z$ give an explicit separating pair of quadratic pencils (Corollary 21.2).

Neither complete reducibility of Cauchy modules, linear preservers of a Segre cone, nor division by the common factor of a pencil is new in isolation. Their synthesis here has a precise output: recognition of the image and its exact orientation ambiguity after all matrix markings are forgotten, followed by recovery of a whole covering map from a locally isotrivial pencil thickening. A projective factor map alone would not recover the actual source bundle; the intrinsic normal map and its commutant do so. A pointwise pencil inverse would not recover a covering map; one constant left transformation over the entire proper base does so. These distinctions specify the geometric content beyond the classical ingredients. The recognized coefficient class is not the class of all determinant-radical relations. Its geometric orbit statement alone does not describe nonreduced deformation groupoids; the relative comparison below uses a further scheme-theoretic inverse.

1.7. Intrinsic strata, infinitesimal parameters, and pencil moduli. The relative inverse begins with a geometric condition on the first relation, not invariance under a factor group. For a space K of homogeneous forms, the divisor-incidence functor defines a canonical scheme-theoretic image in the relation Grassmannian. Its exact-gcd open is the locally closed stratum of Lemma 6.1, now identified by its incidence universal property in Corollary 7.5. Multiplication by the universal common-divisor line is an isomorphism onto this open. Consequently the common factor is recovered even over a nonreduced parameter base. The condition is scheme-theoretic: merely asking all geometric fibres to have the specified common factor is insufficient. When that divisor is a power of a determinant, the remaining parameter is an arbitrary gcd-free residual subspace, modulo the full determinant-preserver group (Theorem 6.3). This is a smooth quotient stack, and neither of the two factor symmetries is required.

For pencils the exact common divisor is δ^{n-1} , and the primitive residual relation has degree $3n - 4$ (Lemma 17.1). The Cauchy projection and the Pluecker equations recognize its image as a locally closed scheme, not just a set of complex points. The resulting relative theorem is

$$\mathcal{F}_{\mathrm{pen}}^{\mathrm{eff}} \simeq [\mathrm{Gr}(2, \mathrm{Sym}^2 V) / \mathrm{PGL}(V)]. \quad (1.2)$$

Here the superscript records two explicit operations on morphisms: first remove tangent-identity nonlinear substitutions, then remove the ineffective right matrix factor, and fppf stackify. Theorem 17.2 proves this equivalence over arbitrary complex parameter schemes, retaining all singular pencils. It does not identify the unrigidified algebra stack with the pencil stack. Its tangent

complex is $[\mathbf{pgl}(V) \rightarrow \mathrm{Hom}(R, \mathrm{Sym}^2 V/R)]$, so the effective stack is smooth of dimension $n - 3$, with precisely the pencil stabilizer jumps. Rank-incidence and spectral Fitting strata retain their scheme structures and deformation equations by Corollary 17.3. This is an exact-image and rigidification comparison; the displayed rank and spectral consequences are its functorial restrictions, not an independent classification of those loci. The two quotient operations have the universal properties of Theorem 18.1 and Corollary 18.2.

The ambient determinant-divisor stratum is substantially larger. Theorem 20.1 computes its normal space to the pencil stratum in three parts: non-Pluecker lines, non-scalar right-factor directions, and other Cauchy summands. Theorem 20.2 constructs through every pencil a projective Grassmannian of relations with the same determinant radical, containing a projective line whose other points admit neither factor symmetry. Thus the family inverse describes how the coefficient and pencil loci sit in, and can be left within, a larger intrinsic stratum. It does not falsely infer deformation stability from fibrewise recognition.

1.8. The normalization of a natural common-divisor boundary. There is a different geometric question beyond the pencil image: what happens when a divisor of a first relation is no longer uniquely recoverable in a family? Let E have dimension $e \geq 2$, set $S_j = \mathrm{Sym}^j E$ and $s_j = \dim S_j$, and fix $g, h \geq 1$, $D = g + h$, and $2 \leq r \leq s_h$. Let $Y_g \subset \mathrm{Gr}(r, S_D)$ be the scheme-theoretic image of the incidence of a line of degree- g divisors of a rank- r relation bundle. This definition uses the vanishing of the universal quotient map; it does not first recover a pencil, impose a factor symmetry, or choose a reduced structure on a set.

Theorem 1.3 (The divisorial boundary). *The multiplication morphism*

$$\mathbb{P}(S_g) \times \mathrm{Gr}(r, S_h) \longrightarrow Y_g, \quad ([f], J) \longmapsto fJ$$

is finite and is the normalization. The locus Y_g is integral, of dimension $s_g - 1 + r(s_h - r)$. At a geometric relation K it is normal exactly when $F_K = \gcd(K)$ has one degree- g divisor $[f]$ and $\gcd(f, F_K/f) = 1$. At the preimage $([f], K/f)$, if this last gcd has degree k , the fibre tangent dimension is $s_k - 1$.

The theorem is proved in Section 7. Lemma 7.3 supplies equations for the entire normalization fibre, not only its tangent space. For example, $K = \langle x^2y, x^2z \rangle$ has a unique linear divisor, but the normalization fibre is $\mathrm{Spec} \mathbb{C}[a, b]/(a, b)^2$, of length three. A different relation has two reduced divisor lifts; yet another has a gcd-degree jump at a normal point. The exact criterion distinguishes these behaviours. Corollary 7.8 carries this intrinsic boundary to the first-relation algebra stack. It is not a classification of all finite-flat smoothings or of all linear orbits in that boundary.

A direct consequence on the pencil side is proved separately in Section 19. Every quadratic pencil admits an explicit congruence degeneration to $\langle x_1^2, x_1x_2 \rangle$; its orbit is the closed flag variety $\mathrm{Fl}(1, 2; V)$, and it is the unique closed orbit in the full pencil Grassmannian. The construction is uniform for regular and singular pencils and lifts to a finite-flat family of their failure algebras with exact common factor δ^{n-1} . This proves a particular universal orbit-closure adjacency by equations, rather than by copying a prescribed invariant locus through the effective-stack equivalence. Its elementary highest-weight mechanism is distinct from the normalization theorem, which deals with a larger boundary of arbitrary first relations.

1.9. Framed families and spectral consequences. Once tensor coordinates are retained, the parameter map is simpler. The first relation spaces give a closed immersion of $\mathrm{Gr}(2, W)$ into a Grassmannian, by Theorem 13.3. Its proof factors through the classical Pluecker embedding, tensoring a line with a fixed space, and a fixed linear inclusion. This is the framed encoding consequence of the coefficient calculation, not a substitute for the unmarked inverse. Theorem 23.1

glues the actual universal order- d neighbourhood. It is finite locally free over the relative socle of rank $\binom{n^2+d}{d} - \binom{N}{2}$, and projective and flat over the pencil parameter scheme. It commutes with arbitrary complex base change with that socle retained. Over a nonreduced base, the specified relative socle ideal need not be the absolute nilradical. These marked statements alone do not identify unmarked moduli stacks or deformation groupoids. The common-divisor descent and ineffective-inertia analysis in Theorem 17.2 supply that separate step.

For regular pencils, the spectral sheaf and its Fitting incidence schemes are read from the reconstructed pencil. We retain these consequences because they exhibit information genuinely lost by coarser invariants: fixed discriminants and fixed reduced rank loci can conceal different elementary divisors. In Theorem 24.2, every classical dominance specialization is transported to a flat family of the finite neighbourhoods, with every strict transition detected at order d . The spectral orbit classification itself is classical, not a second independent Torelli theorem.

1.10. Prior work and the publication object. The Weierstrass–Segre classification is used in its root-labelled form; compare [4, Theorem 1.1 and Corollary 2.1]. The orthogonal nilpotent input is isolated in Lemma 24.1, with precise references to [5, Proposition 1 and Theorem 1], an independent dimension calculation, and an explicit distinction between full orthogonal orbits and their special-orthogonal components.

Ballico’s relative multiplication construction [2, Theorem 0.2; §1, Remark 1.2 and equation (6)] is a substantive antecedent for studying quadratic-normality failure on finite linear sections of an embedded surface. Here the defining algebra varies, and the inverse starts from an unmarked infinitesimal failure scheme. The opening page of the distinct earlier paper [1, p. 5] concerns higher-order embedding properties and restriction maps to finite subschemes. Its remaining theorem and proof text has not been inspected; that first page does not establish the absence of an inverse statement. No anticipation or nonanticipation conclusion relative to that article is asserted.

The Artin-local aspect is compared at theorem level with [7, 8] in Section 2, including the distinction between canonical grading of a nonhomogeneous local algebra and orbit rigidity of our already homogeneous first relation. The linear-preserver input is classical [9]; its precise hypotheses and a proof in the required case are included in Lemma 4.1. The algebraic-group quotient step is supplied by the homomorphism theorem [11, Theorem 5.39 and Remark 5.42]; its use in the exact stabilizer calculation distinguishes a scheme-theoretic quotient from a bare bijection of complex points.

The present article consists of intrinsic reconstruction, the canonical common-divisor boundary, relative rigidification, explicit pencil specialization, and spectral readout. The reciprocal-likelihood theorem and projective critical schemes are preserved in a separate applications manuscript. Its finite-flat critical divisor requires supplied split semisimple data and simple disjoint projective poles; its totally real cover requires a supplied real definite realization and separated data. None of those hypotheses enters the all-pencil theorem here. Independent web, exterior-operator, K3, polarized, and boundary results are preserved in an explicitly non-submitted research archive. They are not inputs to any proof in this article and are not part of its significance claim. Every proof required here is included here.

2. FIRST RELATIONS, UNGRADED ISOMORPHISMS, AND INVERSE SYSTEMS

The passage from a finite local algebra to its first relation space is independent of pencils. We isolate it before undertaking the geometric inverse. In this section E denotes a space of degree-one *generators*; thus it is a cotangent space, rather than the dual normal space used later. Let $e = \dim E$, $d \geq 2$, and $K \subset \mathrm{Sym}^d E$. Set

$$A(K) = \mathrm{Sym} E / ((K) + \mathfrak{m}^{d+1}), \quad \mathfrak{m} = (E), \quad \mathfrak{n} = \mathfrak{m}A(K). \quad (2.1)$$

The grading in this presentation is not supplied to an isomorphism.

Proposition 2.1 (The first-relation orbit principle). *The abstract algebra $A(K)$ recovers E and K , up to linear isomorphism, by*

$$E = \mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2, \quad K = \ker[\mathrm{Sym}^d(\mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2) \longrightarrow \mathfrak{n}^d]. \quad (2.2)$$

Consequently $A(K) \simeq A(K')$ as ungraded complex algebras if and only if some $a : E \xrightarrow{\sim} E'$ satisfies $(\mathrm{Sym}^d a)K = K'$.

More precisely, after fixing the homogeneous inclusions of generators, all isomorphisms with tangent map a are exactly the substitutions

$$x \longmapsto a(x) + u(x), \quad u \in \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(E, \mathfrak{n}^2).$$

These assertions about substitutions remain valid after scalar extension to any commutative complex algebra.

Proof. The positive ideal is the unique maximal ideal, and $\mathfrak{n}^{d+1} = 0$. Multiplication of d lifts of cotangent vectors is independent of their lifts: replacing any one by an element of $\mathfrak{n}^2$ changes the product in $\mathfrak{n}^{d+1}$. There are no relations of smaller degree, and the degree- d quotient is $\mathrm{Sym}^d E/K$. This proves (2.2). In particular every isomorphism induces the stated linear equivalence.

Conversely substitute $a(x) + u(x)$ for each generator. A relation of degree d changes, beyond its linear substitution, only in degrees at least $d + 1$. Those terms vanish. The relations of degree $d + 1$ also vanish. The induced map on associated graded algebras is the isomorphism induced by a ; a finite filtration then makes the algebra map invertible. Every map with this tangent map has precisely such generator images. These polynomial identities hold over any commutative complex coefficient algebra. The intrinsic preservation of the augmentation under that scalar extension is verified in the next proof, so no preservation of a chosen origin has tacitly been added to the isomorphism problem. $\square$

Proposition 2.2 (The full automorphism group scheme). *Write $\ell = \dim_{\mathbb{C}} A(K) = \binom{e+d}{d} - \dim K$ and $H_K = \mathrm{Stab}_{\mathrm{GL}(E)}(K)$, with its closed subgroup scheme structure. The functor $D \mapsto \mathrm{Aut}_D(A(K) \otimes_{\mathbb{C}} D)$ is an affine group scheme of finite type and fits into a split exact sequence of affine group schemes over $\mathbb{C}$:*

$$1 \longrightarrow U_K \longrightarrow \mathrm{Aut}(A(K)) \longrightarrow H_K \longrightarrow 1. \quad (2.3)$$

The kernel is unipotent. Choosing the homogeneous lifting of E identifies its underlying scheme, but not generally its group law, with the affine space associated to $\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(E, \mathfrak{n}^2)$. Its dimension is $e(\ell - 1 - e)$. Intrinsically, U_K acts simply transitively on the affine space of linear splittings of $\mathfrak{n} \twoheadrightarrow \mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2$. The splitting of (2.3) uses a choice of such a lifting; it is not an additional intrinsic grading.

Proof. Choose a basis of the finite-dimensional vector space $A = A(K)$. Inside $\mathrm{GL}(A)$, the equations $f(1) = 1$ and $f(xy) = f(x)f(y)$, imposed on basis elements, are polynomial equations. They represent the automorphism functor, including its values on nonreduced complex algebras.

The augmentation can be recovered without mistaking the absolute nilradical after scalar extension for the augmentation ideal. If M_z denotes multiplication by z , the homogeneous filtration gives

$$\mathrm{tr}(M_z) = \ell \epsilon(z). \quad (2.4)$$

Indeed multiplication by a positive-degree element is strictly triangular, whereas multiplication by a scalar has that scalar on every diagonal entry. Identity (2.4) holds over every commutative complex algebra D . Algebra automorphisms conjugate multiplication matrices, so they preserve $\epsilon = \ell^{-1} \mathrm{tr}(M_{(-)})$, its kernel $\mathfrak{n}_D$, and all its powers. Thus the tangent map is a morphism of group schemes into H_K , not merely a map on complex points.

Linear substitutions give a morphism $H_K \rightarrow \text{Aut}(A)$ sectioning this tangent map. By Proposition 2.1, its kernel has, functorially in D , the unique parametrization $x \mapsto x + u(x)$ with $u : E_D \rightarrow \mathfrak{n}_D^2$. Reading generator images and making these substitutions are inverse polynomial maps. On a basis ordered by the positive filtration all kernel matrices are unitriangular, proving unipotence. Multiplication is substitution, which need not be addition of corrections. The dimension follows from $\dim \mathfrak{n}^2 = \ell - 1 - e$.

Finally two splittings of $\mathfrak{n} \twoheadrightarrow E$ differ by exactly a map $E \rightarrow \mathfrak{n}^2$. Any splitting generates A , and its degree- d products impose exactly K ; the preceding substitution argument therefore gives the unique element of U_K relating any two splittings. This is the asserted coordinate-free torsor description. $\square$

2.1. The inverse-system description and its precise role. Put $E^\vee = \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{C}}(E, \mathbb{C})$. Use the apolar pairing in which dual divided monomials satisfy $\langle x^\alpha, y^\beta / \beta! \rangle = \delta_{\alpha\beta}$. Here the pairing means evaluation at the origin after applying the constant-coefficient differential operator. For $I = (K) + \mathfrak{m}^{d+1}$, its Macaulay inverse system is

$$I^\perp = \bigoplus_{j < d} \text{Sym}^j E^\vee \oplus K^\perp, \quad K^\perp \subset \text{Sym}^d E^\vee. \quad (2.5)$$

To check this equality, the relations of degree $d + 1$ bound the degree of every inverse-system element by d . The degree- d relations pair only with its top component. All lower components are unrestricted. Conversely that direct sum is stable under every partial derivative: differentiating its top part lands in the full lower-degree space. It is therefore annihilated by I , proving the displayed equality. Thus the orbit problem for K is equivalently the contragredient orbit problem for $K^\perp$. This uses the classical inverse-system correspondence; it does not assert a new canonical-grading theorem.

Elias and Rossi prove that Gorenstein local algebras with Hilbert function $(1, e, e, 1)$ are canonically graded [7, Theorem 3.3 and Corollaries 3.4–3.5]. Their proof removes a lower-degree term of the inverse-system generator by a nonlinear coordinate change. In their later work, compressed Gorenstein algebras of socle degree at most four are canonically graded, with counterexamples beyond the stated range [8, Theorem 3.1 and Examples 3.3–3.5]. In contrast, (2.1) is homogeneous by construction, and its truncation makes all higher substitutions invisible to its first relation. We do not deduce that an arbitrary filtered deformation with the same Hilbert function is graded.

For the pencil algebras, $e = n^2$, $d = n^2 + 2n - 4 \geq 11$, and $\dim K = \binom{N}{2}$. They are not Gorenstein: their socles contain $\mathfrak{n}^d$, whose dimension is $\binom{e+d-1}{d} - \binom{N}{2} > 1$. For example, the first binomial is at least $\binom{e+1}{2}$, while $e = n^2 > N$. The issue left by Proposition 2.1 is accordingly not the removal of a nonhomogeneous inverse-system term. It is the recovery of the matrix factors and defining coefficient data from the *unrestricted* $\text{GL}(E)$ -orbit of K . The next sections establish that recovery and its global descent.

3. INTRINSIC TENSOR RULINGS

The first step of the inverse problem is to recognize the two tensor factors of a determinant cone without an ambient marking. The following scheme-theoretic ruling calculation and descent lemma supply precisely this step. They apply to the pencil argument independently of the web and exterior-contraction constructions in the separate research archive.

Lemma 3.1 (The relative scheme of maximal rank-one spaces). *Let B be any complex scheme and E, F vector bundles of rank $n \geq 2$. In $\text{Gr}_B(n, E \otimes F)$, let $Z(E, F)$ be the zero scheme of the restriction of the quadratic rank-one equations to the universal subbundle $\mathcal{T}$. Equivalently it is*

the zero scheme of

$$\mathrm{Sym}^2 \mathcal{T} \longrightarrow \bigwedge^2 E \otimes \bigwedge^2 F.$$

The natural morphism

$$\mathbb{P}_B(E) \sqcup \mathbb{P}_B(F) \longrightarrow Z(E, F), \quad \ell \mapsto \ell \otimes F, \quad m \mapsto E \otimes m, \quad (3.1)$$

is an isomorphism. It commutes with arbitrary change of complex base, including change to a nonreduced base.

Proof. We first work over $\mathbb{C}$. Each displayed map to the Grassmannian is a closed immersion. Its composition with the Pluecker embedding is the degree- n Veronese embedding on $\ell^{\otimes n} \otimes \det F$, respectively $\det E \otimes m^{\otimes n}$, followed by its natural linear inclusion into $\bigwedge^n(E \otimes F)$. This linear inclusion is injective: polarization of the nonzero pure-power map gives the corresponding irreducible symmetric-power summand. The rank-one equations vanish identically on both universal families, so the closed immersions factor through $Z(E, F)$.

Every geometric point is in one of the two images. Indeed the sum of two rank-one tensors is rank at most one only if their first factors or their second factors are proportional. Starting with two independent tensors, this observation forces a linear space consisting of rank-one tensors to fix the same factor throughout. A space of dimension n is then exactly one of the displayed spaces. The two images are disjoint: a space fixing both factors has dimension one, not n .

We verify that these pointwise statements omit no infinitesimal structure. At $\ell \otimes F$, choose a generator of ℓ and a complement in E . A Grassmannian tangent vector is a map $\phi : F \rightarrow (E/\ell) \otimes F$. For each coordinate of E/ℓ , write its component as $A : F \rightarrow F$. Linearizing the restricted minors gives

$$u \wedge A(u) = 0 \quad \text{for every } u \in F.$$

Polarizing this diagonal identity gives

$$u \wedge A(v) + v \wedge A(u) = 0 \quad (u, v \in F).$$

In characteristic zero the diagonal and polarized identities are equivalent. These are precisely all coefficients of the bilinear linearization of the restricted quadratic map on $\mathrm{Sym}^2 F$, so no infinitesimal equation is omitted by testing the diagonal. Taking the basis vectors shows that A is diagonal; taking their pairwise sums makes all its diagonal entries equal. Conversely a scalar A satisfies all the linearized equations. Thus the Zariski tangent space to $Z(E, F)$ is precisely $\mathrm{Hom}(\ell, E/\ell)$, of dimension $n - 1$. The other image has the symmetric calculation.

At every closed point the closed immersed projective space gives local dimension at least $n - 1$, whereas the tangent calculation gives embedding dimension exactly $n - 1$. The local ring is therefore regular. A finite-type complex scheme whose closed-point local rings are regular is reduced: a nonempty support of its nilradical would contain a closed point. In particular there is no nilpotent thickening or embedded associated structure at either image. The disjoint union of the two closed immersions is itself a closed immersion, surjective on geometric points. Its ideal in the now reduced target vanishes at every closed point, so it is zero. This proves the scheme isomorphism over $\mathbb{C}$.

For general B , trivialize E, F on a common open cover. The Grassmannian and the zero scheme of the displayed universal quadratic map are, on such an open, the base change of the constant construction just proved. Thus (3.1) is an isomorphism there even if the base has nilpotents. The maps are natural under changes of frame and hence glue. This argument is an identification by equations and base change, not an inference of relative flatness from a fibrewise tangent calculation. $\square$

Lemma 3.2 (Oriented relative Segre descent). *Let B be a connected projective complex variety with $H^0(B, \mathcal{O}_B) = \mathbb{C}$, and let V, V' have the same dimension $n \geq 2$. Let $\mathcal{U}, \mathcal{U}'$ be vector bundles of rank n on B . Suppose a linear bundle isomorphism*

$$\alpha : V \otimes \mathcal{U}^* \xrightarrow{\sim} V' \otimes \mathcal{U}'^*$$

preserves the rank-one cones and the ruling whose parameter bundle is $\mathbb{P}(V) \times B$. The induced isomorphism $\mathbb{P}(V) \times B \simeq \mathbb{P}(V') \times B$ is regular and is induced by one constant projective isomorphism $[g] : \mathbb{P}(V) \rightarrow \mathbb{P}(V')$. Locally $\alpha(T) = gTh^{-1}$, with the same $[g]$ on every chart. The possible line-bundle twists of vector-bundle lifts do not change the projective left coefficient lines of any homogeneous functorial coefficient construction.

Proof. Lemma 3.1, applied to $E = V \otimes \mathcal{O}_B$ and $F = \mathcal{U}^*$, identifies the closed relative Fano scheme with $(\mathbb{P}(V) \times B) \sqcup \mathbb{P}_B(\mathcal{U}^*)$. In particular its two components carry their displayed scheme structures, with no additional nilpotent or embedded components. The isomorphism α induces a regular map of these relative parameter schemes, and the orientation hypothesis preserves the first component.

For completeness, an isomorphism of two trivial $\mathbb{P}^{n-1}$ -bundles over any base gives a regular projective-matrix-valued map, not merely a fibrewise collection. Its pullback of the relative $\mathcal{O}(1)$ has the form $\mathcal{O}(1) \otimes p^*L$ for a line bundle L on the base. To see this, tensor by $\mathcal{O}(-1)$; the resulting line bundle is trivial on every projective-space fibre, and its pushforward and evaluation identify it with a pullback from the base. Pushing forward $\mathcal{O}(1)$ now gives an isomorphism of the corresponding trivial rank- n bundles, with that line-bundle twist. On charts trivializing L , it is an invertible matrix g_i of regular functions. On overlaps, $g_j = u_{ij}g_i$ for an invertible regular function u_{ij} . The classes $[g_i]$ thus glue to a regular morphism to the projective-isomorphism scheme, identified after choosing fixed bases with PGL_n . This accounts explicitly for the possible absence of a global linear lift.

The group PGL_n is affine: it is the determinant-nonzero principal open in the projective space of matrices. A morphism from B to an affine scheme factors through $\mathrm{Spec} H^0(B, \mathcal{O}_B) = \mathrm{Spec} \mathbb{C}$, so the projective map is constant. Choose a constant linear lift g . Each local g_i then differs from g by a scalar unit. After removing its two projective-factor actions, a linear map preserving every decomposable line is scalar: apply it to sums of two tensors with one common factor. Consequently the remaining action is a right bundle map, and the scalar units may be absorbed in its local lifts h . This proves the local tensor formula.

Finally a scalar multiplying a lift acts on a homogeneous functor of degree a by its scalar to the power a (or $-a$ on its dual). It cannot alter a projective coefficient line. The conclusion applies to every homogeneous degree. In particular, no right change of frame can replace the single projective left map by separate transformations on different coefficient spaces. $\square$

4. ACTUAL FACTOR DESCENT AND MOVING COEFFICIENT SPACES

We now separate the linear-preserver input, the descent of vector bundles, and the recovery of coefficients. The resulting principle allows several varying coefficient spaces, of arbitrary prescribed ranks, rather than only the line associated with a pencil.

Lemma 4.1 (Linear preservers of the determinant cone). *Let U, V, U', V' be complex vector spaces of dimension $n \geq 2$. An invertible linear map $\Phi : \mathrm{Hom}(U, V) \rightarrow \mathrm{Hom}(U', V')$ carrying the determinant hypersurface onto the determinant hypersurface has one of the forms*

$$T \mapsto gTh^{-1}, \quad T \mapsto gT^{\mathrm{t}}h^{-1},$$

where the second formula is written after choosing identifications for transposition. The two cases respectively preserve and exchange the two rank-one rulings. In the first case the pair (g, h) is unique up to a common nonzero scalar.

Proof. At a matrix of rank r , an invertible r -minor reduces the local rank condition to the rank condition on a generic $(n - r)$ -square matrix. The singular locus of the rank-at-most s variety is therefore the rank-at-most $s - 1$ variety for $1 \leq s < n$: on the rank- s stratum the Schur-complement entries give independent equations, whereas on a lower stratum the linear terms of its defining $(s + 1)$ -minors vanish. Starting with the determinant cone and iterating reduced singular loci hence recovers the rank-one cone. For $n = 2$ that cone is already the determinant cone.

If $v \otimes u$ and $w \otimes z$ have rank one, their sum has rank at most one only if v, w or u, z are dependent. It follows that each maximal linear space of rank-one tensors has one factor fixed. The two families are $\mathbb{P}(V)$ and $\mathbb{P}(U^*)$. The induced Segre automorphism must preserve these families or exchange them. In the preserving case its restriction to a ruling gives projective linear maps on each factor. Remove linear lifts of both maps. The remaining linear transformation fixes each decomposable line. In tensor bases its eigenvalues at $v_i \otimes u_j$ agree along each row and each column by applying it to $(v_i + v_k) \otimes u_j$ and $v_i \otimes (u_j + u_l)$. They are all equal, so the remaining map is scalar. This proves the first form and its uniqueness. Composing with transposition reduces the exchanging case to the first.

This is the square invertible case of the classical rank-one preserver theorem of Marcus and Moyls [9, Theorem 1, pp. 1218–1219]; the argument above specifies the reduction from the determinant hypersurface that is needed here. $\square$

Lemma 4.2 (An actual tensor map removes the line twist). *Let B be a reduced complex variety, V a complex vector space with $\dim V \geq 2$, and $\mathcal{A}_1, \mathcal{A}_2$ vector bundles. Suppose an actual bundle isomorphism*

$$\Psi : V \otimes \mathcal{A}_1 \xrightarrow{\sim} V \otimes \mathcal{A}_2$$

preserves the rank-one cones and induces the identity on the $\mathbb{P}(V)$ -parameter space of rulings. There is a unique bundle isomorphism $a : \mathcal{A}_1 \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_2$ with $\Psi = 1_V \otimes a$.

Equivalently, the intrinsic operation of taking the commutant of the constant matrix algebra gives

$$\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{End}(V) \otimes \mathcal{O}_B}(V \otimes \mathcal{A}_1, V \otimes \mathcal{A}_2) \simeq \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_B}(\mathcal{A}_1, \mathcal{A}_2). \quad (4.1)$$

Thus after a constant left projective map has been lifted linearly, no residual line-bundle twist is left in the recovery of the right factor from Ψ .

Proof. For every constant line $\mathbb{C}v \subset V$, the corresponding ruling is fixed, so on every geometric fibre Ψ maps $v \otimes \mathcal{A}_1$ onto $v \otimes \mathcal{A}_2$. Choose a basis $v_1, \dots, v_n$ for the purpose of checking this assertion as an equality of bundle maps. The rulings for v_i force all off-diagonal blocks of Ψ to vanish. The rulings for $v_i + v_j$ force its diagonal blocks to agree. Since B is reduced, fibrewise zero morphisms of vector bundles are zero. Therefore Ψ commutes with every constant matrix unit, hence with $\mathrm{End}(V) \otimes \mathcal{O}_B$.

For clarity, commutant recovery itself is canonical and does not use these chosen matrix units as extra data. Tensoring a bundle map a with 1_V gives the forward map in (4.1). Commutation with matrix units shows locally that it is bijective, with inverse reading any diagonal block. This proves that it is an isomorphism of sheaves, independent of the checking basis. Its inverse applied to the global section Ψ produces a global section a , not projective local sections requiring arbitrary scalar lifts. Applying the same operation to Ψ^{-1} proves that a is invertible. Uniqueness follows from injectivity of $a \mapsto 1_V \otimes a$.

Projective-factor data alone would permit replacing a bundle by a line twist. The additional datum used here is the actual linear map of the tensor bundles. It is this datum, recovered from the dual of the first nilradical quotient, that makes the commutant argument applicable. $\square$

4.1. A general finite-order coefficient inverse. Fix $n \geq 2$, $q \geq 1$, and integers $0 \leq r_\lambda \leq m_\lambda = \dim \mathbb{S}_\lambda \mathbb{C}^n$ for partitions λ of q of length at most n . Assume that for at least one partition

$$0 < r_\lambda < m_\lambda. \quad (4.2)$$

Let B be a smooth connected projective complex variety, V a constant n -dimensional space, and $\mathcal{U}$ a rank- n bundle. For each λ , choose a subbundle with locally free quotient

$$\mathcal{L}_\lambda \subset \mathbb{S}_\lambda V^* \otimes \mathcal{O}_B, \quad \text{rank } \mathcal{L}_\lambda = r_\lambda.$$

Zero and full subbundles are permitted. In the matrix bundle $\mathcal{E} = \text{Hom}(\mathcal{U}, V \otimes \mathcal{O}_B)$, the multiplicity-one Cauchy decomposition supplies the subbundle

$$\mathcal{J}_q = \bigoplus_{\lambda} \mathcal{L}_\lambda \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda \mathcal{U} \subset \text{Sym}^q \mathcal{E}^*. \quad (4.3)$$

Let $\mathcal{D}_n \subset \text{Sym}^n \mathcal{E}^*$ be the determinant line, put $D = n + q$, and define

$$\mathcal{K} = \mathcal{D}_n \mathcal{J}_q, \quad \mathcal{A} = \text{Sym } \mathcal{E}^* / ((\mathcal{K}) + \mathfrak{a}^{D+1}), \quad Y = \text{Spec}_B \mathcal{A}, \quad (4.4)$$

where $\mathfrak{a}$ is the positive homogeneous ideal. The notation D in this subsection is an integer, not a failure locus. The scheme Y is finite over B , and need not be zero-dimensional over $\mathbb{C}$.

Theorem 4.3 (Unmarked descent for moving coefficient spaces). *For fixed $n, q, (r_\lambda)$ satisfying (4.2), the abstract complex scheme Y recovers its coefficient data as follows. Two such schemes Y_1, Y_2 are isomorphic if and only if there are an isomorphism $\sigma : B_1 \rightarrow B_2$, a constant linear isomorphism $g : V_1 \rightarrow V_2$, and an actual bundle isomorphism $h : \mathcal{U}_1 \rightarrow \sigma^* \mathcal{U}_2$ such that, for every λ ,*

$$\mathcal{L}_{1,\lambda} = (\mathbb{S}_\lambda g)^* \sigma^* \mathcal{L}_{2,\lambda}. \quad (4.5)$$

Every unmarked isomorphism induces a normal-bundle map $T \mapsto gTh^{-1}$; for that map the pair (g, h) is unique up to a common nonzero constant scalar. Conversely every such triple lifts homogeneously to an isomorphism. The scheme is finite locally free over its reduced base of rank

$$\binom{n^2 + D}{D} - \sum_{\lambda} r_\lambda m_\lambda.$$

No nontriviality hypothesis on $\mathbb{P}_B(\mathcal{U}^)$ is required.*

Proof. Recovering the intrinsic linear data. Multiplication by a determinant polynomial is an injective linear map of polynomial spaces. In local bundle frames its matrix is constant over $\mathbb{C}$ and its cokernel is free. The Cauchy summands and the $\mathcal{L}_\lambda$ are subbundles, so $\mathcal{K}$ is a subbundle of rank $\sum r_\lambda m_\lambda$. The graded pieces of $\mathcal{A}$ below D are the full symmetric powers; its top piece is $\text{Sym}^D \mathcal{E}^* / \mathcal{K}$. This proves local freeness and the rank formula.

The nilradical $\mathfrak{n}$ of $\mathcal{O}_Y$ is its positive ideal, since B is reduced. Thus $Y_{\text{red}} = B$ and $\mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2 = \mathcal{E}^*$ intrinsically. The multiplication kernel

$$\ker[\text{Sym}^D(\mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2) \rightarrow \mathfrak{n}^D]$$

is precisely $\mathcal{K}$, by the proof of Proposition 2.1 in local frames. An abstract isomorphism consequently gives the base isomorphism σ and an actual linear normal-bundle isomorphism carrying $\mathcal{K}_1$ to $\mathcal{K}_2$ contravariantly. The normal map is linear over the reduced base even when the original scheme map does not preserve the chosen graph projection. Indeed the action on $\mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2$ is linear over $\mathcal{O}_Y/\mathfrak{n}$.

Recovering and orienting the factors. Generate the homogeneous ideal $(\mathcal{K})$ in the recovered symmetric algebra; do not confuse its cone with the finite truncation. Its radical is the determinant ideal. To verify this, at an invertible matrix T , the map $\mathbb{S}_\lambda T$ is invertible. For a partition with $r_\lambda > 0$, a nonzero covector in $\mathcal{L}_\lambda$ has a nonzero matrix coefficient there. Thus the residual

coefficients cannot all vanish off the determinant. All generators vanish on the determinant. The relative determinant hypersurface is reduced over the smooth base; the equality of radicals follows on affine charts from this equality of closed points. Successive reduced singular loci and Lemma 3.1 recover its two unordered tensor rulings with their relative scheme structures.

Cancellation of the determinant line is intrinsic and recovers the ideal generated by $\mathcal{J}_q$, and hence its degree- q piece. In a Cauchy summand the two contraction supports of $\mathcal{L}_\lambda \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda \mathcal{U}$ have ranks (r_λ, m_λ) . Separate factor changes preserve these ranks. By Lemma 4.1, an exchange of the two matrix factors interchanges the ranks in each summand. At a partition satisfying (4.2), the result (m_λ, r_λ) cannot equal (r_λ, m_λ) for the other datum. Thus no fibre permits an exchange. Twisting local factor lifts by lines changes no support rank. The V -ruling is thereby oriented intrinsically, including when both projective ruling bundles are trivial.

Descending the actual map. By Lemma 3.2, the induced morphism $B_1 \rightarrow \text{Isom}(\mathbb{P}(V_1), \mathbb{P}(V_2))$ is constant: the target is affine and $H^0(B_1, \mathcal{O}_{B_1}) = \mathbb{C}$. Choose a constant linear lift g . Remove it from the actual normal map. Lemma 4.2, applied to $\mathcal{A}_1 = \mathcal{U}_1^*$ and $\mathcal{A}_2 = (\sigma^* \mathcal{U}_2)^*$, supplies the unique global right factor. Dualizing its inverse gives the actual isomorphism h . This step uses more than an isomorphism of projective bundles; it is exactly what excludes an undetected line twist. Replacing g by cg replaces h by ch . These are all ambiguities because the left lift is constant.

Recovering every coefficient subbundle. The oriented Cauchy decomposition is now functorial for the recovered left-right map. Project the residual degree- q module onto each summand and contract against the full right dual factor. The image is precisely $\mathcal{L}_\lambda$, as a subbundle of the constant left module, not just a collection of fibrewise projective subspaces. The right map acts invertibly on the full Schur factor and hence does not change this image. Pullback by the normal map therefore gives (4.5) for the same constant g in all summands. Scalar choices in the determinant line do not change these subbundles. This proves necessity.

Conversely $T \mapsto gTh^{-1}$ carries the determinant line, all coefficient subbundles, and every power of the positive ideal to the corresponding objects. It induces the required homogeneous scheme isomorphism. The stated uniqueness refers to the induced normal map; it does not eliminate the higher-order automorphisms of that scheme. $\square$

4.2. Identical fibres and graded bundles do not determine a family. The global conclusion has content even when neither fibre isomorphism classes nor the underlying graded vector bundles vary. The following example uses the general coefficient theorem, not a further spectral readout of a reconstructed pencil.

Example 4.4 (Two isotrivial thickenings separated by coefficient descent). Take $B = \mathbb{P}^1$, $V = \mathbb{C}^3$, $\mathcal{U} = \mathcal{O}_B^3$, $q = 1$, and $r_{(1)} = 1$. The two everywhere nonzero columns

$$(s^3, t^3, 0)^t, \quad (s^3 + st^2, t^3, 0)^t$$

define subbundles $\mathcal{L}_0, \mathcal{L}_1 \subset V^* \otimes \mathcal{O}_B$, both isomorphic to $\mathcal{O}_B(-3)$. Let Y_0, Y_1 be their order-4 thickenings (4.4). They are finite flat of rank 712 over B and Zariski locally trivial with the same Artin algebra as fibre. Their nilradical graded vector bundles are isomorphic in every degree, although Y_0 and Y_1 are not isomorphic as abstract complex schemes.

Proof. Neither column vanishes, since its second entry is nonzero when $t \neq 0$, and its first is nonzero at $t = 0$. The left coefficient map to its image line $\mathbb{P}^1 \subset \mathbb{P}(V^*)$ is, in the coordinate $z = s/t$, respectively

$$f_0(z) = z^3, \quad f_1(z) = z^3 + z.$$

A local frame completing a generator of $\mathcal{L}_i$ to a basis of $V^* \otimes \mathcal{O}$ changes the coefficient line to a fixed line. This gives Zariski local product presentations of both thickenings. Alternatively,

equality of the fibre isomorphism classes follows from transitivity of $\mathrm{GL}(V)$ on nonzero coefficient lines. The rank formula is $\binom{13}{4} - 3 = 712$.

Let $E = V^* \otimes \mathbb{C}^3$, of dimension nine. For $j < 4$, the degree- j nilradical quotient is $\mathrm{Sym}^j E \otimes \mathcal{O}_B$. Multiplication by the fixed determinant embeds E as a fixed nine-dimensional subspace of $\mathrm{Sym}^4 E$. Choosing a constant linear complement gives, for the top quotient,

$$\mathfrak{n}_i^4 \simeq \mathcal{O}_B^{486} \oplus ((V^* \otimes \mathcal{O}_B)/\mathcal{L}_i)^{\oplus 3}.$$

Each column has only its first two entries nonzero, and these two entries have no common zero. The rank-one quotient of $\mathcal{O}_B^2$ by $\mathcal{O}_B(-3)$ is consequently $\mathcal{O}_B(3)$, by determinants. Thus the displayed top bundle is $\mathcal{O}_B^{489} \oplus \mathcal{O}_B(3)^{\oplus 3}$ for both i . The assertions about every graded vector bundle follow. They are not assertions that the graded *algebra* structures agree.

If an abstract isomorphism $Y_0 \simeq Y_1$ existed, Theorem 4.3 would identify their coefficient maps by one automorphism of B and one constant projective transformation of V^* . Both maps have as image the same projective line, so the latter transformation would restrict to a projective automorphism of that line. Hence f_0 and f_1 would be equivalent by independent projective changes in source and target. This is impossible. The map f_0 has two ramification points, each of index three. The map f_1 has the two simple zeros of $3z^2 + 1$, each of index two, and infinity, of index three. Ramification indices are invariant under those projective changes. Thus the unmarked algebra scheme distinguishes these two globally different coefficient maps even though its fibre algebras, conormal bundle, abstract first-relation bundle, and all graded vector bundles agree. $\square$

4.3. Pencils and the category of their automorphisms. For pencils, take $q = 2p$, $p = N - 2$, and $F(H) = \bigwedge^{N-2} \mathrm{Sym}^2 H$. By Lemma 12.2 this is a single Schur module of dimension $M = \binom{N}{2}$, and Lemma 15.1 identifies its coefficient subbundle with $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}} = \bigwedge^p (\mathrm{Sym}^2 V/\mathcal{R})^*$. Its rank is one, so the strict-support hypothesis holds for every pencil. Exterior duality recovers the subbundle $\mathcal{R}$ from that line. Theorem 4.3 therefore proves the unrestricted moving-pencil inverse, including its actual source-bundle conclusion. This is a simultaneous reconstruction theorem for a map into a coefficient Grassmannian, not just a classification of its individual fibres.

Corollary 4.5 (Algebraic automorphism sequence for a pencil). *Let $\mathfrak{A}_R^{[d]}$ be the unmarked local algebra of Theorem 16.3, and let $G_R = \{g \in \mathrm{GL}(V) : (\mathrm{Sym}^2 g)R = R\}$. There is a split exact sequence of complex affine algebraic groups*

$$1 \longrightarrow U_R \longrightarrow \mathrm{Aut}(\mathfrak{A}_R^{[d]}) \longrightarrow (G_R \times \mathrm{GL}(U))/\mathbb{G}_m \longrightarrow 1, \quad (4.6)$$

where $\mathbb{G}_m$ is the diagonal scalar subgroup. Its intrinsic quotient is the closed stabilizer of K_R in the general linear group of the cotangent space. In that form the sequence represents automorphisms after extension to every commutative complex algebra. Its splitting is homogeneous after choosing generators, and U_R has the intrinsic description and dimension in Proposition 2.2.

Proof. Proposition 2.2 gives the represented sequence with quotient H_{K_R} . The coefficient inverse and Lemma 4.1 identify its complex points with the image of the left-right action; transposition is excluded by the support ranks $(1, M)$. Use the contragredient of the normal action to obtain a homomorphism on the cotangent space. Its kernel is exactly the diagonal scalar subgroup: a tensor product acting identically has both factors scalar, with reciprocal actions on the dual factors. The image is a closed algebraic subgroup and all the groups in question are smooth in characteristic zero [10, Lemma 39.8.2]. Thus the stabilizer and this image agree as closed subgroup schemes, not only on complex points. The induced quotient identification is an isomorphism of algebraic groups: after division by the kernel it is a bijective separable homomorphism between smooth groups. The splitting and kernel are those already constructed by substitutions. $\square$

For a positive-dimensional projective reduction, Theorem 15.4 is used as an exact sequence of groups of complex scheme automorphisms, with its stated filtered kernel. We do not identify that sequence with a finite-type affine group scheme or a moduli-stack equivalence. Likewise, the marked construction over nonreduced parameter bases later in the paper retains its specified relative socle: it does not replace that ideal by the absolute nilradical. These distinctions preserve the full unmarked geometric assertion while specifying its category.

5. RECOGNITION AND THE EXACT AMBIGUITY OF COEFFICIENT SYSTEMS

The support inequality in the preceding section is not merely a sufficient test in the class under consideration. We characterize that class intrinsically and determine exactly when its orientation is unique. We then compute the full linear stabilizer, including the cases in which an orientation is lost. These are statements about unmarked first relations, not about a supplied matrix presentation.

Throughout this section $n \geq 2$, $q \geq 1$, and $D = n + q$. Let E have dimension n^2 , put $S = \text{Sym } E$, and let $0 \neq K \subset S_D$. The affine cone is in E^* . Suppose that the radical of the homogeneous ideal (K) is a reduced hypersurface linearly equivalent to the determinant hypersurface in square n -by- n matrices. We call this the *determinant-radical condition*. The ideal (K) is taken in the full symmetric algebra, not in its Artin truncation. Its reduced equation gives a line $\mathbb{C}\delta \subset S_n$, and unique factorization gives the intrinsic residual subspace

$$J = K/\delta \subset S_q. \quad (5.1)$$

Changing the generator δ does not change this subspace. The reduced singular loci of the recovered cone determine its unordered tensor rulings. An ordering identifies $E = V^* \otimes U$, with $\dim U = \dim V = n$, up to separate factor changes. The subgroup induced by $\text{GL}(U)$ on the second factor is independent of those changes. An ordering is called *admissible* when J is invariant under this full subgroup. Admissibility is therefore an intrinsic condition on an ordered ruling, and does not ask for a chosen basis of either factor.

Theorem 5.1 (Intrinsic recognition and orientation dichotomy). *Under the determinant-radical condition, an ordering is admissible if and only if its Cauchy decomposition has*

$$J = \bigoplus_{\lambda \vdash q, \ell(\lambda) \leq n} L_\lambda \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda U, \quad L_\lambda \subset \mathbb{S}_\lambda V^*. \quad (5.2)$$

The coefficient spaces are unique and are recovered by projection and contraction. Suppose at least one ordering is admissible and put $r_\lambda = \dim L_\lambda$ and $m_\lambda = \dim \mathbb{S}_\lambda \mathbb{C}^n$. Then exactly one of the following alternatives occurs.

- (i) *Some $0 < r_\lambda < m_\lambda$. Precisely one of the two orderings is admissible, and every linear isomorphism between such relation spaces preserves that ordering.*
- (ii) *Every r_λ is either zero or m_λ . Both orderings are admissible. The residual space is a sum of full Cauchy summands, and transposition preserves K after identifications of the two matrix factors.*

Conversely, every nonzero system in (5.2) satisfies the determinant-radical condition after multiplication by δ . Thus the theorem characterizes the image of the coefficient construction, without assuming a coefficient presentation as part of the input.

Proof. The determinant polynomial is irreducible for $n \geq 2$. Every element of K belongs to the radical (δ) , so $K \subset \delta S_q$ and the cancellation in (5.1) is legitimate. The intrinsic recovery of the unordered factors follows from Lemma 4.1 and the rank-one rulings. Changing either factor frame conjugates its full general linear group into itself; scalar changes act as scalars on S_q . Consequently the definition of admissibility is independent of all these choices.

For an ordering, the Cauchy formula is

$$S_q = \bigoplus_{\lambda \vdash q, \ell(\lambda) \leq n} \mathbb{S}_\lambda V^* \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda U.$$

As representations of $\mathrm{GL}(U)$, the nonzero $\mathbb{S}_\lambda U$ are irreducible and pairwise nonisomorphic. Finite-dimensional rational representations of this group over $\mathbb{C}$ are completely reducible. Hence an invariant subspace splits across its isotypic components. In the λ -component, evaluation identifies that subspace with

$$\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{GL}(U)}(\mathbb{S}_\lambda U, J) \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda U.$$

Schur's lemma embeds the displayed multiplicity space uniquely in $\mathbb{S}_\lambda V^*$; this is L_λ . This proves necessity in (5.2), including the absence of unrecorded cross-summand graphs. Sufficiency follows since the second factor is full. Projection onto a Cauchy summand followed by contraction with the dual of its second factor recovers L_λ .

If the reverse ordering is also admissible, J is invariant under both full factor groups. Their product acts irreducibly on each Cauchy summand, and these product representations are pairwise nonisomorphic. Complete reducibility now makes J a sum of whole summands. Equivalently, all r_λ are zero or full. Conversely a sum of whole summands is invariant under both groups and under the factor exchange. This proves the dichotomy. One may also see uniqueness directly from the contraction ranks (r_λ, m_λ) : a factor exchange reverses them, which is impossible at a nonzero proper support. Every linear isomorphism of relation spaces preserves the determinant cone; Lemma 4.1 leaves just the two factor alternatives. It must therefore preserve the unique admissible ordering in case (i).

Finally choose a nonzero L_λ . At an invertible matrix $T : U \rightarrow V$, the map $\mathbb{S}_\lambda T$ is invertible. A nonzero covector in L_λ consequently has a nonzero matrix coefficient at T . Thus the residual coefficients do not vanish simultaneously at any invertible matrix. All elements of δJ vanish on the determinant hypersurface. Their common zero set is exactly that hypersurface; the Nullstellensatz and its reduced irreducible equation give $\mathrm{rad}(\delta J) = (\delta)$, as asserted. $\square$

The complete reducibility and Cauchy statements here are classical representation theory; see [3]. Their role is to supply an intrinsic image criterion *after* the matrix factors have been recovered. For a relation space that fails the admissibility criterion, the theorem does not assert a one-sided coefficient description. In particular it is not a classification of arbitrary homogeneous ideals or arbitrary degeneracy schemes.

5.1. Stabilizers and the full transpose ambiguity. Use the normal action $T \mapsto gTh^{-1}$. Its action on polynomial functions is inverse pullback, so it gives an honest representation ρ on $E = V^* \otimes U$. The kernel of $\rho : \mathrm{GL}(V) \times \mathrm{GL}(U) \rightarrow \mathrm{GL}(E)$ is the diagonal scalar subgroup. For a recognized system define

$$G_L = \{g \in \mathrm{GL}(V) : (\mathbb{S}_\lambda g^{-1})^* L_\lambda = L_\lambda \text{ for every } \lambda\}, \quad H_K = \mathrm{Stab}_{\mathrm{GL}(E)}(K).$$

These are closed subgroup schemes, with the stabilizer scheme structures from their actions on Grassmannians.

Theorem 5.2 (Exact coefficient stabilizer). *In case (i) of Theorem 5.1,*

$$H_K \simeq (G_L \times \mathrm{GL}(U)) / \mathbb{G}_m. \tag{5.3}$$

In case (ii), after choosing bases for the two factors,

$$H_K \simeq ((\mathrm{GL}_n \times \mathrm{GL}_n) / \mathbb{G}_m) \rtimes C_2, \tag{5.4}$$

where C_2 is generated by transposition. These are isomorphisms of affine algebraic groups over $\mathbb{C}$, and hence of their represented functors on commutative complex algebras.

For the ungraded algebra $A(K) = S/((K) + \mathfrak{m}^{D+1})$, they give the split exact sequence

$$1 \longrightarrow U_K \longrightarrow \text{Aut}(A(K)) \longrightarrow H_K \longrightarrow 1. \quad (5.5)$$

Here U_K is the universal higher-order substitution group from Proposition 2.2, of dimension $n^2(\text{length } A(K) - 1 - n^2)$.

Proof. Every element of $H_K(\mathbb{C})$ preserves the radical of (K) , and therefore the determinant cone. In case (i), the unique admissible orientation excludes its transposed component. The remaining map is $\rho(g, h)$. Cancellation of the determinant line and projection onto each Cauchy summand show that it preserves J if and only if $g \in G_L$; the arbitrary right map acts on the full factor and introduces no additional condition. The kernel is the diagonal $\mathbb{G}_m$. In case (ii), every separate factor transformation and transposition preserves each active full summand. These exhaust the determinant preservers, so they exhaust $H_K(\mathbb{C})$. The transposition has order two and lies outside the preserving component for $n \geq 2$, giving the asserted semidirect product. Its action on the left-right quotient is conjugation by the matrix-transpose map; no particular formula for its action on chosen factor lifts is needed.

We justify the scheme statement as well. The homomorphism theorem for algebraic groups identifies the quotient by the kernel with the closed image [11, Theorem 5.39 and Remark 5.42]. Every finite-type group scheme over a characteristic-zero field is smooth [10, Lemma 39.8.2]. Thus the stabilizer and the image are reduced closed subgroup schemes. The equalities on complex points just proved imply equality of their defining radical ideals. This gives (5.3) and (5.4) as algebraic-group isomorphisms, not only as bijections on complex points. Finally Proposition 2.2 applies in degree D and gives (5.5) with the stated kernel, splitting and dimension. $\square$

For completeness, the omitted zero system has $K = 0$. Then $A(K)$ is the free truncated symmetric algebra, $H_K = \text{GL}(E)$, and its linear automorphisms need not preserve any matrix factors. The determinant-radical condition deliberately excludes this third possibility. A full nonzero coefficient system and a zero system therefore lose information in different ways: the former retains unordered matrix geometry and has exactly a transpose ambiguity, while the latter retains no intrinsic matrix geometry at all.

5.2. The zero/full case over a projective reduction. The local transpose ambiguity also has an exact global form. Fix a nonempty set of active partitions and take the corresponding $\mathcal{L}_\lambda$ to be full, with all other coefficient bundles zero. Use the same construction as in (4.4), without its strict-support hypothesis.

Proposition 5.3 (Global ambiguity for full coefficient systems). *Let Y_i be two such schemes, for the same n, q and active partitions, over smooth connected projective bases B_i with source bundles $\mathcal{U}_i$. They are isomorphic as abstract complex schemes if and only if there are an isomorphism $\sigma : B_1 \rightarrow B_2$ and an actual bundle isomorphism $\mathcal{U}_1 \simeq \sigma^* \mathcal{U}_2$. An isomorphism exchanging the two ruling families over a fixed σ exists precisely when, in addition, the common source bundle is projectively trivial. Equivalently,*

$$\mathcal{U}_1 \simeq \mathcal{M}^{\oplus n}, \quad \sigma^* \mathcal{U}_2 \simeq \mathcal{M}^{\oplus n}$$

for a line bundle $\mathcal{M}$ on B_1 . Thus even the full systems recover the actual source-bundle class; the extra ambiguity is an exchange, not an undetected line twist.

Proof. An abstract isomorphism recovers the reduction, the actual normal bundle map, the first relation, and the unordered determinant rulings by the proof of Theorem 4.3, which uses strict support only to orient the rulings. Over the connected base the choice to preserve or exchange the two components is constant. In the preserving case, projectivity makes the left projective map constant. A constant lift and Lemma 4.2 give an actual isomorphism of the source bundles.

In the exchanging case each source projective bundle is identified with the constant left projective bundle on the other side. It is therefore trivial. A vector bundle with a trivialized projectivization is a line twist of a constant vector space: locally lift the given projective trivialization to linear frames; on intersections their differences are scalar matrices, whose scalar cocycle is the required line bundle. After pullback by σ , write $\mathcal{U}_i^* = \mathcal{M}_i^* \otimes W_i$, with W_i constant of dimension n . The normal bundles become $\mathcal{M}_i^* \otimes (V_i \otimes W_i)$. Their actual isomorphism induces a morphism from B_1 to the projective-linear isomorphisms between two constant n^2 -spaces. This target is affine; the morphism is constant. Choose its constant linear lift. On removing it, the actual bundle map is scalar on each projective fibre. In local line frames its off-diagonal entries vanish and all diagonal entries agree. Reducedness makes these equalities hold as bundle maps. Their common entry is a nowhere vanishing section of $\mathcal{H}om(\mathcal{M}_1^*, \mathcal{M}_2^*)$, and hence $\mathcal{M}_1 \simeq \mathcal{M}_2$. This proves necessity of the common actual line twist, and thus of the source-bundle isomorphism.

Conversely any actual source-bundle isomorphism, together with a constant left identification, preserves all active full Cauchy summands, so it gives an isomorphism of the schemes. If the source bundles have the common line-twist presentation above, choose identifications of the constant factor spaces and transpose their tensor factors, leaving the line factor intact. This is a global actual normal map. It preserves the determinant line, every active full summand, and the truncation, and supplies an exchanging isomorphism. These constructions prove all the claims. $\square$

5.3. The intrinsic orbit space. Fix a rank vector $\mathbf{r}$ with at least one proper nonzero entry and form the product of Grassmannians

$$X_{\mathbf{r}} = \prod_{\lambda \vdash q, \ell(\lambda) \leq n} \text{Gr}(r_{\lambda}, \mathbb{S}_{\lambda} V^*).$$

Zero and full factors in this product are points. Let $\mathcal{Z}_{\mathbf{r}}$ denote the set of subspaces of $\text{Sym}^D \mathbb{C}^{n^2}$ satisfying the determinant-radical condition and the intrinsic admissibility test, with ranks $\mathbf{r}$ in the unique admissible orientation.

Corollary 5.4 (Geometric orbit classification). *The coefficient construction induces bijections*

$$X_{\mathbf{r}}(\mathbb{C}) / \text{PGL}(V) \simeq \mathcal{Z}_{\mathbf{r}} / \text{GL}_{n^2}(\mathbb{C}) \simeq \{A(K) : K \in \mathcal{Z}_{\mathbf{r}}\} / \simeq. \quad (5.6)$$

Their stabilizers, including the ineffective right factor and the nonlinear kernel of the last passage, are precisely those in Theorem 5.2. For a nonempty zero/full rank pattern there is just one relation orbit for that pattern, with the stabilizer in (5.4).

Proof. The recognition theorem gives surjectivity of the first map. A linear isomorphism of two such relations is orientation-preserving; its left factor carries every L_{λ} to the corresponding coefficient space, and its right factor is unrestricted. Scalars act trivially on the Grassmannians. This proves injectivity and the first bijection. The first-relation orbit proposition gives the second. For a zero/full pattern each coefficient Grassmannian is a point, and the full-stabilizer theorem supplies the last claim. $\square$

Equation (5.6) is a statement about geometric orbit sets with the explicitly computed affine stabilizers. It does not identify nonreduced moduli stacks or assert that every infinitesimal deformation remains in this class. For smooth projective reduced bases, its uniquely oriented case combines with actual factor descent in Theorem 4.3. The following pencil-native application shows that this global step separates an entire covering problem that fibrewise classification cannot see.

6. COMMON-DIVISOR STRATA AND INTRINSIC FAMILIES

The coefficient condition in Theorem 5.1 is not imposed in this section. We instead retain the common divisor of a space of first relations. This geometric condition gives a larger smooth parameter space, includes relations without either factor symmetry, and has a scheme-theoretic inverse. The distinction between a stratum and the condition on its geometric points is essential when the parameter base is nonreduced.

Write $S_j(E) = \text{Sym}^j E$, where E is a complex vector space. For $r \geq 2$, denote by

$$X_{h,r}(E) \subset \text{Gr}(r, S_h(E))$$

the locus of subspaces with greatest common divisor equal to 1, up to a scalar. Empty Grassmannians are omitted throughout. When $h = 0$ this notation can also be used for $r = 1$.

Lemma 6.1 (Universal common divisor). *Let $D = g + h$. The spaces of r degree- D forms whose exact greatest common divisor has degree g form a locally closed reduced subscheme Z_g of $\text{Gr}(r, S_D(E))$. Multiplication induces an isomorphism*

$$\mathbb{P}(S_g(E)) \times X_{h,r}(E) \xrightarrow{\sim} Z_g, \quad ([f], J) \mapsto fJ. \quad (6.1)$$

In particular, the common-divisor line and the residual subbundle of a family with classifying map in Z_g are recovered uniquely and commute with arbitrary complex base change.

Proof. For each a , multiplication from $\mathbb{P}(S_a(E)) \times \text{Gr}(r, S_{D-a}(E))$ has closed image: its domain is projective. The union for $a > g$ is closed. Remove this union from the image for $a = g$, and give the resulting locally closed set its reduced structure. Its points are exactly those in the statement. The inverse image of this set under multiplication is $\mathbb{P}(S_g(E)) \times X_{h,r}(E)$. The same closed-image argument with $D = h$ shows that $X_{h,r}(E)$ is open.

The restricted multiplication map is proper, by base change. It is injective on geometric points over every algebraically closed extension of $\mathbb{C}$, since a greatest common divisor is unique up to scalar in a polynomial ring. Its differential is injective as well. Indeed, a tangent vector in its kernel satisfies

$$\dot{f}j + f\dot{j} \in fJ \quad (j \in J).$$

Consequently $f \mid \dot{f}j$ for every $j \in J$. For each irreducible factor of f , some element of J is not divisible by that factor. Comparison of its valuation gives $f \mid \dot{f}$. Equality of degrees makes $\dot{f}$ a scalar multiple of f ; then $\dot{J} = 0$ in $\text{Hom}(J, S_h(E)/J)$.

In characteristic zero the geometric-point injectivity and this differential calculation imply that the map is universally injective and unramified. A proper, universally injective, unramified morphism is a closed immersion [12, Lemma 41.7.2]. Here its image is all of the reduced target. The defining ideal of a closed immersion with this support is zero in a reduced scheme. This proves the isomorphism, including its assertion for nonreduced test schemes. Equivalently, one can check properness on the base change of the original projective multiplication map; that base change has the same underlying open preimage. Its source is reduced because it is this open subscheme of the original smooth product. $\square$

Remark 6.2. A map from a nonreduced scheme is required to factor through the locally closed scheme Z_g , not merely to have geometric points in its underlying set. These are different requirements. For example, over $\mathbb{C}[\epsilon]/(\epsilon^2)$ the span of $x^2 + \epsilon y^2, xy$ specializes to a pair with common divisor x , but has no factor $x + \epsilon(ax + by)$. Comparison of the y^2 coefficient in the first form proves this. The stratum in Lemma 6.1 excludes this transverse infinitesimal family. No use of a fibrewise radical can replace its scheme structure.

Now let $\dim V = \dim U = n \geq 3$, $E = V^* \otimes U$, and $\delta = \det T$. Denote by $G \subset \mathrm{GL}(E)$ the stabilizer of the line $\mathbb{C}\delta$. By Lemma 4.1,

$$G^\circ = (\mathrm{GL}(V) \times \mathrm{GL}(U))/\mathbb{G}_m, \quad G/G^\circ = \mathbf{Z}/2\mathbf{Z}. \quad (6.2)$$

The second component exchanges the two tensor factors; the diagonal scalars in the displayed product act trivially on the matrix space. Fix $s \geq 1$ and $D = sn + h$. Inside Z_{sn} , impose the condition that the common-divisor line is the s -th power of a determinant form after a linear change of the n^2 variables. Call the resulting locally closed scheme $Z_{s,h,r}^{\det}$.

Theorem 6.3 (Intrinsic determinant-divisor stratum). *There are canonical isomorphisms of schemes and algebraic stacks*

$$Z_{s,h,r}^{\det} \simeq \mathrm{GL}(E) \times^G X_{h,r}(E), \quad [Z_{s,h,r}^{\det} / \mathrm{GL}(E)] \simeq [X_{h,r}(E) / G]. \quad (6.3)$$

They hold over arbitrary complex parameter schemes. The stack is smooth. At a residual relation J , its tangent complex, in degrees $-1, 0$, is

$$[\mathrm{Lie}(G) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}(J, S_h(E)/J)], \quad X \longmapsto (j \mapsto Xj \bmod J). \quad (6.4)$$

No invariance of J under either full factor group is assumed. The equivalence identifies stabilizers, infinitesimal families, and specializations whose classifying maps remain in this stratum.

Proof. The power map $\mathbb{P}(S_n(E)) \rightarrow \mathbb{P}(S_{sn}(E))$, $[f] \mapsto [f^s]$, is a closed immersion in characteristic zero. It is proper and geometrically injective, and its differential has kernel given by $sf^{s-1}\dot{f} \in \mathbb{C}f^s$, hence by $\dot{f} \in \mathbb{C}f$. The same closed-immersion criterion as above applies. The orbit of $[\delta]$ is the smooth locally closed homogeneous space $\mathrm{GL}(E)/G$. The preimage of its power orbit under the first projection in (6.1) is therefore a locally closed subscheme. It is exactly $Z_{s,h,r}^{\det}$.

Pulling back along the G -torsor $\mathrm{GL}(E) \rightarrow \mathrm{GL}(E)/G$ trivializes the common-divisor form, leaving the unrestricted residual relation $J \in X_{h,r}(E)$. Descent gives the first isomorphism in (6.3); descent of equivariant maps and morphisms gives the second. This proof uses morphisms of schemes, not a comparison only on complex points. It also supplies local lifts of all isomorphisms over an fppf cover.

The space $X_{h,r}(E)$ is open in a Grassmannian and G is smooth. The quotient is algebraic and smooth [13, Theorem 97.17.2]; see also [14, Lemma 101.33.7]. For completeness, write a first-order residual subspace as the graph of $\epsilon\phi : J \rightarrow S_h(E)/J$. An infinitesimal change $1 + \epsilon X$ replaces ϕ by $\phi + X|_J \bmod J$. This proves the tangent complex. Its kernel records infinitesimal automorphisms and its cokernel records first-order isomorphism classes. The same torsor description proves compatibility with specialization. No assertion is made about limits outside the specified common-divisor stratum. $\square$

The next step connects these parameter spaces with ungraded finite algebras. It is useful to state the family condition intrinsically, since an absolute nilradical is unsuitable over a nonreduced base. Put $e = \dim E$ and $\ell = \binom{e+D}{D} - r$. Consider finite locally free commutative unital algebras $\mathcal{A}$ of rank ℓ on a complex scheme T_0 , subject to the following conditions. The map $\epsilon(a) = \ell^{-1} \mathrm{tr}(M_a)$ is multiplicative. For $\mathcal{N} = \ker \epsilon$, one has $\mathcal{N}^{D+1} = 0$; all quotients of its power filtration are locally free; $\mathcal{E} = \mathcal{N}/\mathcal{N}^2$ has rank e ; and multiplication gives isomorphisms $\mathrm{Sym}^j \mathcal{E} \simeq \mathcal{N}^j / \mathcal{N}^{j+1}$ for $j < D$. In degree D its kernel has rank r . These conditions specify the maximal-lower-Hilbert-function stratum; they do not assert that arbitrary smoothings of a local algebra remain in it.

Proposition 6.4 (Relative first-relation algebra). *Every such algebra is locally isomorphic, over its base, to*

$$\mathcal{A}(\mathcal{K}) = \mathrm{Sym} \mathcal{E} / ((\mathcal{K}) + \mathfrak{m}^{D+1}), \quad \mathcal{K} = \ker(\mathrm{Sym}^D \mathcal{E} \longrightarrow \mathcal{N}^D).$$

Its trace augmentation, $\mathcal{E}$, and $\mathcal{K}$ are intrinsic and compatible with arbitrary base change in this stratum. For two such algebras, taking the linear part gives a locally surjective map of isomorphism

sheaves to the sheaf of isomorphisms of $(\mathcal{E}, \mathcal{K})$. Its kernel is the smooth substitution group whose underlying scheme in a local presentation is $\mathrm{Hom}(\mathcal{E}, \mathcal{N}^2)$.

After quotienting morphisms by this tangent-identity kernel and fppf stackifying, the algebras with first-relation map in $Z_{s,h,r}^{\det}$ have stack $[X_{h,r}(E)/G]$.

Proof. Locally lift a basis of $\mathcal{E}$ to $\mathcal{N}$. Nilpotence and multiplication on the successive quotients make the induced map from the truncated symmetric algebra surjective. A relation with a nonzero term of least degree $j < D$ would give a nonzero kernel in degree j of the associated graded algebra, which is impossible. Its entire kernel therefore lies in degree D and is precisely $\mathcal{K}$. Changing a lift by an element of $\mathcal{N}^2$ does not alter a product of D generators, since the difference has degree at least $D + 1$. This also proves the asserted uniqueness of the first relation.

In this presentation multiplication by a positive-degree element is strictly filtration-increasing. Its trace is zero over any base ring. Multiplication by a scalar has trace ℓ times that scalar, proving that the presentation's augmentation is the specified intrinsic trace augmentation. All filtration sequences are locally split sequences of vector bundles, so their kernels and quotients commute with base change.

An isomorphism must preserve trace and induces a linear map carrying $\mathcal{K}$ to $\mathcal{K}'$. Conversely such a map lifts locally to an isomorphism by the homogeneous presentations. All other lifts are obtained by substituting generators plus arbitrary elements of $\mathcal{N}^2$; the inverse is constructed degree by degree in a finite filtration. This gives the stated kernel and its smoothness, without replacing its substitution law by addition. After identifying morphisms with the same linear part, frames of $\mathcal{E}$ give the quotient $[Z_{s,h,r}^{\det}/\mathrm{GL}(E)]$. Theorem 6.3 completes the proof. $\square$

Remark 6.5. The original algebra stack is not this quotient stack: it has the additional nonlinear inertia just computed. The phrase *effective first-relation stack* will refer to the specified quotient on morphisms followed by stackification. The construction retains the full automorphism group before taking that quotient. It does not identify algebras with the same geometric fibres, nor does it discard nilpotent parameters. In particular, its relation to a stratum of first relations is stronger than a bijection of isomorphism classes over $\mathbb{C}$.

7. THE COMMON-DIVISOR BOUNDARY AND ITS NORMALIZATION

The exact-common-divisor stratum has a canonical completion which need not be normal. Its normalization records a divisor, and its failure to be an isomorphism is controlled by two different phenomena: choices of that divisor and overlap with the residual common factor. We establish these assertions for arbitrary spaces of forms. No determinant, Cauchy, or Pluecker equation is imposed in this section.

Let E have dimension $e \geq 2$, put $S_j = \mathrm{Sym}^j E$ and $s_j = \dim S_j = \binom{e+j-1}{j}$, and fix

$$g, h \geq 1, \quad D = g + h, \quad 2 \leq r \leq s_h.$$

Write $\mathcal{G} = \mathrm{Gr}(r, S_D)$. A *degree- g divisor incidence* over a complex scheme T_0 consists of a line subbundle $\mathcal{L} \subset S_g \otimes \mathcal{O}_{T_0}$ and a rank- r subbundle $\mathcal{K} \subset S_D \otimes \mathcal{O}_{T_0}$ such that

$$\mathcal{K} \longrightarrow (S_D \otimes \mathcal{O}_{T_0})/(\mathcal{L} \cdot S_h) = 0. \quad (7.1)$$

Subbundle always means that the quotient is locally free. In particular, the form generating $\mathcal{L}$ is nonzero on every geometric fibre. Condition (7.1) is the vanishing of a bundle map, not a condition imposed only on closed points.

Proposition 7.1 (Canonical divisor incidence). *The incidence functor is represented, with its full scheme structure, by*

$$\mathcal{X}_g = \mathbb{P}(S_g) \times \mathrm{Gr}(r, S_h).$$

Its forgetful morphism is multiplication

$$\nu_g : \mathcal{X}_g \longrightarrow \mathcal{G}, \quad ([f], J) \longmapsto fJ. \quad (7.2)$$

This morphism is finite. Its scheme-theoretic image Y_g is an integral projective scheme. If K is a geometric point of Y_g and $F_K = \gcd(K)$, the underlying set of $\nu_g^{-1}(K)$ is

$$\{[f] : f \mid F_K, \deg f = g\}, \quad (7.3)$$

with residual space $J = K/f$. The incidence construction and its scheme-theoretic fibres commute with arbitrary complex base change.

Proof. On $\mathbb{P}(S_g)$, multiplication from the tautological line tensored with S_h to S_D has constant rank s_h . Indeed, multiplication by a nonzero polynomial over a field is injective. A nonzero maximal minor locally splits this map, so its image and cokernel are vector bundles, also after a nonreduced base change. The closed incidence (7.1) is therefore the relative Grassmannian of rank- r subbundles of $\mathcal{L} \otimes S_h$. Tensoring by $\mathcal{L}^{-1}$ identifies it canonically with the stated product. In more elementary terms, $\mathcal{K}$ has a unique inverse image in $\mathcal{L} \otimes S_h$; its quotient there is locally free because the quotient of $S_D/\mathcal{K}$ onto $S_D/(\mathcal{L} \cdot S_h)$ is a surjection of vector bundles. This proves the functorial assertion, including its scheme structure.

The source of ν_g is projective. Unique factorization in the polynomial ring over an algebraically closed field gives (7.3). A fixed polynomial has only finitely many divisors of a fixed degree, up to scalar. The morphism is thus proper with finite fibres and is finite [15, Tag 02LS]. Define Y_g by the kernel of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{G}} \rightarrow (\nu_g)_* \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{X}_g}$, as in [16, Tag 01R5]. Its integrality follows from the integrality of $\mathcal{X}_g$: on an affine open meeting the image, the coordinate ring of the image injects into the domain which is the coordinate ring of its finite inverse image. Reducedness is therefore a consequence of this incidence construction, not an extra choice. Representability of incidence gives the base-change assertion. $\square$

Remark 7.2. The condition defining Y_g is the existence of a divisor of degree g . In several variables it is not the condition $\deg \gcd(K) \geq g$: an irreducible polynomial of larger degree need not have a degree- g factor. Nor do we assert that formation of the scheme-theoretic image, or normalization itself, commutes with arbitrary nonflat base change. The assertion for arbitrary bases in Proposition 7.1 concerns the incidence functor and the base change of its representing morphism.

We next retain the nilpotents of a fibre. This will distinguish a ramified divisor choice from several distinct divisor choices.

Lemma 7.3 (Fibre equations and the overlap space). *Let $K = fJ$, set $H = \gcd(J)$, and put $c = \gcd(f, H)$ and $k = \deg c$. Then the tangent space of the scheme-theoretic fibre at $([f], J)$ is naturally, after the displayed representatives have been chosen,*

$$\ker(d\nu_g)_{([f], J)} \simeq S_k/\mathbb{C}c, \quad \dim \ker(d\nu_g) = s_k - 1. \quad (7.4)$$

More explicitly, choose a projective coefficient chart $f(u) = f + \sum u_\alpha m_\alpha$, with one coefficient normalized to its value in f . Let $M(f(u))$ be the matrix of multiplication $S_h \rightarrow S_D$. Choose a set A_0 of s_h rows for which $M_{A_0}(f)$ is invertible, and let B_0 denote the remaining rows. For a matrix C whose columns form a basis of K , the full fibre on this chart is defined by

$$C_{B_0} - M_{B_0}(f(u))M_{A_0}(f(u))^{-1}C_{A_0} = 0, \quad \det M_{A_0}(f(u)) \neq 0. \quad (7.5)$$

In particular its completed local ring is the power-series ring in the $s_g - 1$ variables u_α , modulo the entries in (7.5); no radical is taken.

Proof. For each column of C , its possible quotient by $f(u)$ is forced by the A_0 rows to be $M_{A_0}^{-1}C_{A_0}$. The remaining rows are exactly the condition that this quotient works. These quotients span a subbundle wherever the equations hold, by the incidence argument above. Thus elimination has introduced neither additional solutions nor discarded nilpotents, proving the fibre presentation over arbitrary coefficient rings in the chart.

A tangent vector is a pair $(\dot{f} \bmod \mathbb{C}f, \dot{J})$. It lies in the fibre precisely when

$$\dot{f}j + f\dot{j} \in fJ \quad \text{for all } j \in J.$$

It is necessary and sufficient that $f \mid \dot{f}j$ for every $j \in J$; the class of $\dot{j}$ modulo J is then forced. Taking the minimum valuation over a basis of J , for each irreducible polynomial, makes this equivalent to $f \mid \dot{f}H$. Writing $f = cf_1$, $H = cH_1$, with $\gcd(f_1, H_1) = 1$, gives $\dot{f} = f_1w$ with $w \in S_k$. The scalar tangent direction $\dot{f} \in \mathbb{C}f$ is exactly $w \in \mathbb{C}c$. This proves (7.4) and its dimension assertion. $\square$

Theorem 7.4 (Normalization and the exact normal locus). *The finite map*

$$\nu_g : \mathbb{P}(S_g) \times \text{Gr}(r, S_h) \longrightarrow Y_g$$

is the normalization of the natural degree- g divisor locus. Its dimension is

$$\dim Y_g = s_g - 1 + r(s_h - r). \quad (7.6)$$

For a geometric point K , the scheme Y_g is normal at K if and only if F_K has exactly one degree- g divisor $[f]$ and

$$\gcd(f, F_K/f) = 1. \quad (7.7)$$

Normality at a point is also equivalent to smoothness there. Thus the two precise obstructions are more than one divisor choice, or overlap between the selected divisor and the residual common factor. The latter gives the fibre tangent dimension in (7.4), and (7.5) determines its higher nilpotents.

Proof. The locus of gcd-free r -planes in S_h is nonempty: a space containing x_1^h, x_2^h is one example, and it can be extended to every allowed rank r . It is open, since the loci possessing a positive-degree divisor are the finitely many closed images of projective multiplication maps. It is therefore dense in the irreducible Grassmannian. Its product with $\mathbb{P}(S_g)$ maps to the locus where the exact gcd has degree g .

This last locus is open in Y_g : remove the finitely many closed images for divisor degrees $a > g$. Call it U_g . Every fibre over a geometric point of U_g has one point and, by Lemma 7.3 with $H = 1$, zero tangent space. A finite local algebra over an algebraically closed field with zero cotangent space is the field itself, by Nakayama's lemma. The fibre consequently has length one, not merely one point.

Here is the local argument which also settles the scheme structure. At a closed point of U_g , write A for the local ring of Y_g , and B for its finite inverse-image algebra. The map $A \rightarrow B$ is injective, and $B/\mathfrak{m}_A B = \mathbb{C}$, generated by 1. Nakayama's lemma, applied to the finite module B/A , gives $B = A$. The non-isomorphism locus of a finite morphism is closed, so the same conclusion holds throughout U_g . Hence ν_g is birational. The source is smooth and integral, thus normal. On affine opens, a finite birational extension $A \subset B$ with B integrally closed is the integral closure of A in the common fraction field: every element integral over A is integral over B and hence belongs to B . This proves the normalization assertion; compare [17, Tag 035E]. The dimension follows from the product description.

If Y_g is normal at K , its normalization is an isomorphism there, so its fibre is one reduced point. Formula (7.3) gives uniqueness of $[f]$, and (7.4) gives $s_k - 1 = 0$, equivalent to $k = 0$ because $e \geq 2$. Conversely uniqueness and $k = 0$ again make the entire fibre a single reduced point. The same finite local Nakayama argument shows that the normalization is an isomorphism

near K . Its source is normal, so Y_g is normal at K . The source is smooth, so every normal point of the target is smooth; the converse holds for every complex variety. This proves both directions without replacing a nonreduced fibre by its set of points. $\square$

Corollary 7.5 (Universality of the exact stratum). *The open subscheme $U_g \subset Y_g$ represents the unmarked relation families in the divisor incidence whose residual space is gcd-free on every geometric fibre. Over it the divisor line and residual subbundle are unique and commute with arbitrary base change. Moreover U_g , as a locally closed subscheme of $\mathcal{G}$, is the reduced exact-gcd stratum of Lemma 6.1.*

Proof. The inverse image of U_g is $\mathbb{P}(S_g) \times X_{h,r}(E)$, and the proof above shows that its finite map to U_g is an isomorphism. Its source is reduced, so U_g has the reduced induced structure on its locally closed support. The incidence functor supplies the asserted universal property. A family in the ambient Grassmannian which only has the right geometric gcd need not factor through Y_g . In particular, the transverse dual-number family of Remark 6.2 is not admitted by this corollary. The corollary is a scheme-theoretic identification, not a claim that fibrewise gcd tests detect nilpotent equations. $\square$

Example 7.6 (A nonreduced fibre at a divisor collision). Take $E = \langle x, y, z \rangle$, $g = 1, h = 2, r = 2$, and $K = \langle x^2y, x^2z \rangle$. Its gcd is x^2 , so the only point of the normalization fibre has divisor x . In the chart $f = x + ay + bz$, division by this monic linear form amounts to substitution $x = -ay - bz$. The two remainders are

$$(ay + bz)^2y, \quad (ay + bz)^2z.$$

Their coefficient ideal is (a^2, ab, b^2) . Thus the full fibre is

$$\text{Spec } \mathbb{C}[a, b]/(a, b)^2, \tag{7.8}$$

of length three and tangent dimension two. It is not a reduced point, despite uniqueness of the geometric divisor. The family

$$K_t = x\langle xy + ty^2, xz + tz^2 \rangle$$

has independent generators for every t , exact gcd x when $t \neq 0$, and the displayed collision at $t = 0$. Consequently this nonreduced fibre occurs on the boundary of the exact stratum, not in an unrelated example.

Example 7.7 (Several branches and a normal gcd jump). For the same g, h, r, E , let $K = xy\langle x, z \rangle$. The divisors x and y give two points of the normalization fibre. At both points the overlap is one, so the fibre consists of two reduced points. The point of Y_1 is nonnormal. By contrast, put $q = x^2 + yz$ and $K = xq\langle y, z \rangle$, now with $h = 3$. The polynomial q is irreducible and is not divisible by x . There is exactly one linear divisor of gcd $K = xq$, and its overlap with the residual gcd q is one. This point of Y_1 is normal although its gcd degree is three. These two examples show why neither gcd degree nor the number of geometric lifts alone is a sufficient normality criterion.

Corollary 7.8 (An intrinsic boundary for first-relation algebras). *On the maximal-lower-Hilbert-function stratum of Proposition 6.4, the algebras whose intrinsic degree- D kernel has classifying map in Y_g have, after removing only tangent-identity substitutions, stack $[Y_g/\text{GL}(E)]$. Its normalization is the finite representable morphism*

$$[\mathcal{X}_g/\text{GL}(E)] \longrightarrow [Y_g/\text{GL}(E)]. \tag{7.9}$$

All members of the universal relation family give finite locally free algebras of rank $\binom{e+D}{D} - r$. This construction imposes no pencil image equations and permits the divisor and residual common factor to collide.

Proof. For every subbundle $\mathcal{K}$ classified by the Grassmannian, $\mathrm{Sym} E/((\mathcal{K}) + \mathfrak{m}^{D+1})$ is, as a module, the sum of S_j for $j < D$ and $S_D/\mathcal{K}$. This proves finite local freeness and the rank. The first-relation proposition identifies the quotient after the specified nonlinear inertia is removed. Incidence and multiplication are $\mathrm{GL}(E)$ -equivariant. Pulling (7.9) back along the smooth frame atlas $Y_g \rightarrow [Y_g/\mathrm{GL}(E)]$ gives precisely ν_g . Finiteness, representability, and the normalization identification follow by descent; equivalently normality and integral closure may be checked on these smooth atlases. This quotient is not claimed to classify smoothings outside the specified Hilbert stratum. $\square$

For the pencil first relations one can take $e = n^2$, $g = n(n-1)$, $h = 3n-4$, and $r = \binom{n+1}{2}$. Every pencil then lies in the exact-gcd open of this canonical boundary. The boundary theorem concerns the much larger space of all degree- g divisorial first relations, rather than a closure defined by recovering a pencil and reimposing its Pluecker equations. It determines its normalization and normal locus, but does not assert a classification of all its linear orbits or of all finite-flat algebra deformations.

8. CONDUCTORS AND LOCAL MODELS OF DIVISOR COLLISIONS

We retain the notation of Section 7. All completed local rings below are completed at closed complex points. For a reduced local ring A with finite normalization B , its *conductor* is $\mathfrak{c} = \mathrm{Ann}_A(B/A)$, regarded also as an ideal of B . We use the intrinsic singular subscheme defined by $\mathrm{Fitt}_{\dim A} \Omega_{A/\mathbb{C}}$; on completions, differentials mean continuous differentials. The conductor and this Fitting ideal need not agree. Our first result determines both on a multivariate stratum. The second identifies the way two branches merge when a common binary root becomes double.

8.1. Two coprime divisor choices.

Theorem 8.1 (The split-divisor stratum). *Suppose $h > g$, $2 \leq r \leq s_{h-g}$, and*

$$K = abL, \quad [a], [b] \in \mathbb{P}(S_g), \quad L \in \mathrm{Gr}(r, S_{h-g}), \quad \mathrm{gcd}(L) = 1.$$

Assume that a, b are coprime and that the only degree- g divisors of ab , up to scalar, are a and b . Put

$$\begin{aligned} t &= 2(s_g - 1) + r(s_{h-g} - r), \\ c &= r(s_h - s_{h-g}) - (s_g - 1), \quad d_g = t + c. \end{aligned}$$

Then $c \geq 1$, and there are formal coordinates in which

$$\widehat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y_g, K} = \mathbb{C}[[z_1, \dots, z_t, x_1, \dots, x_c, y_1, \dots, y_c]] / (x_i y_j : 1 \leq i, j \leq c). \quad (8.1)$$

Its normalization is $\mathbb{C}[[z, x]] \times \mathbb{C}[[z, y]]$. The conductor is

$$\mathfrak{c} = (x_1, \dots, x_c, y_1, \dots, y_c), \quad \widehat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y_g, K} / \mathfrak{c} = \mathbb{C}[[z]], \quad (8.2)$$

and the intrinsic singular subscheme has ideal $\mathfrak{c}^c$. The two smooth branches meet scheme-theoretically in a smooth t -dimensional subscheme. The local ring has multiplicity two and depth $t+1$; it is Cohen–Macaulay exactly when $c = 1$.

Proof. We first determine the intersection as a scheme, not by comparing closed points or tangent dimensions. The normalization has precisely two points above K , namely (a, bL) and (b, aL) . At either point, the overlap in Lemma 7.3 is zero. The map from the completed local ring of the ambient Grassmannian to each completed source ring is consequently surjective: its cotangent map is surjective, and completeness and Nakayama’s lemma lift successive homogeneous terms. Thus each source completion is a closed smooth formal branch of the image.

Here is the required assertion over infinitesimal bases. Let A_0 be a local Artin $\mathbb{C}$ -algebra. A point on both formal branches carries unique marked lifts a_{A_0}, b_{A_0} near a, b . If homogeneous

polynomials have coprime reductions, those reductions form a regular sequence in the polynomial ring over $\mathbb{C}$. Its graded Koszul complex is exact. In each degree the polynomial modules are finite free; lifting a splitting of the complex, or applying the local criterion for flatness successively, shows that its lift over A_0 is exact and that the quotient is A_0 -flat. In particular

$$(a_{A_0}) \cap (b_{A_0}) = (a_{A_0} b_{A_0}). \quad (8.3)$$

This also follows by noting that b_{A_0} is a nonzerodivisor modulo a_{A_0} and solving a relation between them. Applying (8.3) to the columns of the relation subbundle gives, uniquely,

$$K_{A_0} = a_{A_0} b_{A_0} L_{A_0}.$$

The residual module is a subbundle: multiplication by $a_{A_0} b_{A_0}$ is a split injection in degree D , and the quotient of the ambient free module by K_{A_0} is free. The kernel of the induced surjection onto the complementary quotient is therefore free. This proves that the formal intersection is represented by the product of the two divisor charts and the Grassmannian chart for L , with no nilpotents omitted.

The differential of this product parametrization is injective. Indeed, an infinitesimally constant product gives

$$(\dot{a}b + a\dot{b})l + ab\dot{l} \in abL \quad (l \in L).$$

Taking valuations at the factors of a , and using $\gcd(a, b) = \gcd(L) = 1$, forces $a \mid \dot{a}$; similarly $b \mid \dot{b}$. These are the two projective scalar directions, and then $\dot{L} = 0$. The intersection is thus a smooth formal closed subscheme of dimension t .

Let R_0 be the ambient completed local ring and I_a, I_b the ideals of these branches. Finiteness of the normalization, exactness of completion on finite modules, and the definition of the scheme-theoretic image give

$$\widehat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y_g, K} = R_0 / (I_a \cap I_b) = (R_0 / I_a) \times_{R_0 / (I_a + I_b)} (R_0 / I_b).$$

This is the elementary conductor-square construction; see also [21, Lemma 1.3 and §1.3.2]. All three quotient rings are regular. Choosing compatible regular parameters for the two surjections gives (8.1). The branch dimension is $d_g = s_g - 1 + r(s_h - r)$, so its codimension along the intersection is the asserted c . It is positive: if $c = 0$, both branch ideals would coincide locally with the intersection ideal, contradicting the two distinct normalization branches of a reduced local ring.

In the fibre-product description, an element belongs to the conductor exactly when both its restrictions to the intersection vanish. This gives (8.2). The Jacobian of the relations $x_i y_j$ has nonzero entries only among the x_i and y_j . The Fitting ideal in question is its ideal of c -minors. Every such minor belongs to $\mathfrak{c}^c$. Conversely, choosing the c columns indexed by the y_j and one row (i_j, j) for each j gives every monomial $x_{i_1} \cdots x_{i_c}$. The symmetric choice gives every degree- c monomial in the y 's. Mixed monomials vanish in the ring. Thus the ideal is exactly $\mathfrak{c}^c$, including its nonreduced structure.

Finally use

$$0 \longrightarrow \widehat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y_g, K} \longrightarrow \mathbb{C}[[z, x]] \oplus \mathbb{C}[[z, y]] \longrightarrow \mathbb{C}[[z]] \longrightarrow 0,$$

where the last arrow is the difference of restrictions. The depth lemma gives depth $t + 1$; for $c = 1$ this equals the dimension. For $c > 1$ it is strictly smaller. Additivity of leading Hilbert coefficients gives multiplicity two, since the last module has smaller dimension than the two regular branches. $\square$

Remark 8.2. The hypotheses are nonempty in every number of variables: for $e = 2$ one may take $g = 1$, and for $e \geq 3$ one may take two distinct irreducible forms of degree g . The theorem treats an explicitly specified stratum, not all pairs of overlapping degree- g divisors. In particular, it

does not substitute a binary factorization rule for multivariate divisibility. Its high-codimension branch intersections need not be normal-crossing divisors.

8.2. A double common root. For $m \geq 1$, put $R_m = \mathbb{C}[[u_1, \dots, u_m, \Delta]]$ and $I = (u_1, \dots, u_m) \subset R_m$. Define

$$A_m = R_m \oplus It \subset B_m = \mathbb{C}[[u_1, \dots, u_m, t]], \quad \Delta = t^2. \quad (8.4)$$

The right side of (8.4) is a subring, not a square-zero extension: $(It)^2 = \Delta I^2$. For $m = 1$ it is the ordinary pinch-point ring.

Theorem 8.3 (Collision of two binary divisor choices). *Let $e = 2$, $g = 1$, $D = h + 1$, and $2 \leq r \leq D - 1$. At a point $K_0 = \ell^2 L$ with $L \in \text{Gr}(r, S_{D-2})$ and $\gcd(L) = 1$, set*

$$m = r - 1, \quad q = r(D - 1 - r) + 1.$$

Then

$$\widehat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y_1, K_0} \simeq A_m[[z_1, \dots, z_q]]. \quad (8.5)$$

Writing $w_i = u_i t$, a complete presentation of A_m is

$$\mathbb{C}[[u_1, \dots, u_m, \Delta, w_1, \dots, w_m]] / (u_i w_j - u_j w_i, w_i w_j - \Delta u_i u_j), \quad (8.6)$$

where the first relations have $i < j$ and the second have $i \leq j$. Its normalization is B_m , and its conductor is

$$\mathfrak{c} = (u_1, \dots, u_m, w_1, \dots, w_m), \quad \mathfrak{c}B_m = IB_m.$$

The induced map on conductor quotients is

$$\mathbb{C}[[\Delta]] \longrightarrow \mathbb{C}[[t]], \quad \Delta \longmapsto t^2. \quad (8.7)$$

Thus the two reduced divisor lifts merge through a ramified double cover of the conductor. The completed local ring has dimension $q + m + 1$ and depth $q + 2$. It is Cohen–Macaulay if and only if $r = 2$. For $r = 2$, its intrinsic singular ideal, with the smooth variables suppressed, is $(w, \Delta u, u^2)$, whereas its conductor is (u, w) .

Proof. Choose an affine coordinate x with the root of ℓ at zero. Some member $F_0 \in K_0$ has multiplicity exactly two there, since $\gcd(L) = 1$. Extend it to a frame $F_0, \dots, F_{r-1}$. In the completed local ring of the ambient Grassmannian the formal Weierstrass theorem writes the universal F_0 as a unit times

$$P(x) = x^2 + ax + b.$$

Divide each F_i , $i > 0$, by this monic polynomial. Its remainder is $u_i x + v_i$. The $2r$ functions $a, b, u_1, v_1, \dots, u_m, v_m$ are part of a regular parameter system. To see this rather than assume versality, note that K_0 has zero two-jet at the root, while $S_D/K_0 \rightarrow \mathbb{C}[x]/(x^2)$ is surjective. The Grassmannian tangent space $\text{Hom}(K_0, S_D/K_0)$ therefore allows independent variations of both jets in every frame column. Passing from these jets to the displayed remainders is an invertible triangular operation, with leading coefficient $F_0/x^2(0) \neq 0$. Their differentials are consequently independent.

Set

$$t = x + a/2, \quad \Delta = a^2/4 - b, \quad w_i = au_i/2 - v_i.$$

The incidence of a common root near zero is now exactly

$$\Delta = t^2, \quad w_i = u_i t.$$

There are no other normalization points above K_0 , because its exact common divisor is ℓ^2 . Consequently the image of this completed incidence is the completed image defining Y_1 . The ambient dimension is $N_0 = r(D + 1 - r)$. Of the $2r$ parameters above, a is free, as are the other $N_0 - 2r$ parameters. This accounts for $q = N_0 - 2r + 1$ smooth variables in (8.5).

It remains to justify elimination scheme-theoretically. The relations in (8.6) reduce any series to $p + \sum_i w_i p_i$ with $p, p_i \in R_m$. If its image in B_m is zero, the decomposition $B_m = R_m \oplus R_m t$ gives $p = 0$ and $\sum_i u_i p_i = 0$. The first syzygies of the regular sequence $u_1, \dots, u_m$ are generated by the Koszul syzygies. They are precisely the relations $u_i w_j - u_j w_i$. This proves the presentation without taking a radical. The same argument works first over polynomial rings and then by exact completion.

The extension $A_m \subset B_m$ is finite, since $t^2 = \Delta$, and birational, since $t = w_1/u_1$ in the fraction field. The regular ring B_m is thus the normalization. For $p + vt \in R_m \oplus It$, multiplication by t stays in A_m if and only if $p \in I$. As $1, t$ generate B_m , the conductor is $I \oplus It$, proving the quotient map (8.7). Equivalently,

$$A_m = B_m \times_{\mathbb{C}[[t]]} \mathbb{C}[[\Delta]], \quad (8.8)$$

where the first map sets $u = 0$ and the second sends Δ to t^2 . This is a specific conductor square, not an assumption that the normalization descends through its reduced fibres.

As an R_m -module, $A_m = R_m \oplus I$. For $m = 1$, the ideal I is free. For $m > 1$, the exact sequence $0 \rightarrow I \rightarrow R_m \rightarrow \mathbb{C}[[\Delta]] \rightarrow 0$ gives $\text{depth}_{R_m} I = 2$. Hence A_m has depth two for every $m \geq 1$. The maximal ideal of R_m generates an ideal with maximal radical in A_m , so this is also its local ring depth. Adding the q smooth parameters gives the assertion. When $m = 1$, the equation is $w^2 - \Delta u^2 = 0$; its partial derivatives generate $(w, \Delta u, u^2)$ in characteristic zero. $\square$

Corollary 8.4 (The split and ramified parts of the same model). *On the binary locus where the common divisor has degree exactly two, there are two strata. Over two distinct roots the formal local ring has the split form (8.1), with $t = q + 1$ and $c = r - 1$. Over a double root it has (8.5). The support of the singular locus in the latter model is the conductor, and the normalization fibre at a collision is $\text{Spec } \mathbb{C}[t]/(t^2)$. For arbitrary m , its singular subscheme is given without radicalization by the m -minors of the Jacobian of the displayed m^2 relations in (8.6).*

Proof. The assertion at distinct roots is Theorem 8.1. In the collision model the normalization is an isomorphism wherever some u_i is invertible. On $u = w = 0$, a nonzero value of Δ gives two distinct points after an étale square-root extension, while $\Delta = 0$ gives the stated length-two fibre. The exact normality criterion proves the assertion about singular support. There are $2m + 1$ nonsmooth coordinates and dimension $m + 1$; the cotangent presentation therefore gives the m -minors as claimed. This formula specifies the whole singular scheme, even where it is thicker than its conductor support. $\square$

Remark 8.5 (Descent to intrinsic first relations). On the maximal-lower-Hilbert-function stratum of Corollary 7.8, these statements compute the completed smooth-atlas singularities of the intrinsic first-relation algebra stack after tangent-identity rigidification. The conductor is equivariant, and formation of its finite-module annihilator and of the Fitting ideals commutes with flat base change. Thus the calculations descend through the frame atlas. This does not identify these rings with completed local rings of a coarse orbit space, where stabilizers can introduce further singularities.

9. INTERSECTIONS OF DIVISOR-DEGREE IMAGES

Here the total relation degree D is fixed. Write $Y_a \subset \text{Gr}(r, S_D)$ for the image admitting a divisor of degree a ; empty Grassmannians are omitted. In several variables these images are not generally nested. Their reduced intersections nevertheless have a finite description by common parts of two marked divisors.

Proposition 9.1 (The common-part formula). *For $1 \leq a, b < D$ and $0 \leq j \leq \min(a, b)$, let M_j be the scheme-theoretic image of*

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{P}(S_j) \times \mathbb{P}(S_{a-j}) \times \mathbb{P}(S_{b-j}) \times \mathrm{Gr}(r, S_{D-a-b+j}) &\longrightarrow \mathrm{Gr}(r, S_D), \\ (c, u, v, L) &\longmapsto cuvL. \end{aligned} \quad (9.1)$$

A negative last degree or insufficient dimension gives the empty image, and $\mathbb{P}(S_0)$ is a point. Then

$$(Y_a \cap Y_b)_{\mathrm{red}} = \left(\bigcup_j M_j \right)_{\mathrm{red}}. \quad (9.2)$$

On the locus of two marked divisors f_a, f_b with exact common part of degree j , the corresponding factorization is $c = \gcd(f_a, f_b)$, $f_a = cu$, $f_b = cv$, with $\gcd(u, v) = 1$. In particular, at a relation $K = a_0^m L$ with $\gcd(L) = 1$, the set of positive divisor degrees is exactly $\{1, \dots, m\}$. For the boundary point in Theorem 10.1, $m = D - q_n$.

Proof. Each map in (9.1) is defined on a projective scheme: multiplication by a nonzero form has constant rank, so the subspace construction is a morphism. Its image is closed and admits the two divisors cu and cv , proving one inclusion. Conversely, if K has divisors f_a, f_b , unique factorization gives their common part c of some degree j . Their least common multiple is cuv and divides every member of K . Division yields L of degree $D - a - b + j$, of the same rank. This proves equality on geometric points. Over $\mathbb{C}$, a reduced closed subscheme of a finite-type scheme is determined by its closed points, giving (9.2). The last assertion follows because every homogeneous divisor of a power of one linear form is a power of that form. $\square$

The reduction in (9.2) is essential to the statement of this global formula. It is not a prescription to reduce the individual Y_a , their normalization fibres, or their singular subschemes. The full intersection of the two formal branches on the coprime stratum was computed over Artin bases in Theorem 8.1; Theorem 8.3 computes the thickening when those branches collide. Thus the degree-poset description and the local scheme calculations have distinct, explicit roles.

10. A COMMON RAMIFIED BOUNDARY OF PENCIL FAILURE ORBITS

The fixed tensor presentation of a pencil has exact common divisor δ^{n-1} . Varying the pencil alone therefore stays in the exact-divisor locus. The intrinsic finite algebra permits a larger, canonical operation: changing the basis of its entire cotangent space. We now describe a boundary point produced by such changes. The generic members are genuine pencil failure algebras. The central member has a larger common divisor, and its normalization fibre is nonreduced. Thus the boundary of Section 7 occurs inside the orbit closures of the motivating algebras themselves.

Let $n = \dim V = \dim U \geq 3$, $E = V^* \otimes U$, and put

$$e = n^2, \quad N = \binom{n+1}{2}, \quad r = \binom{N}{2}, \quad g = n(n-1), \quad h = 3n-4, \quad D = g+h.$$

For a pencil R , write $K_R = \delta^{n-1} C_R \subset \mathrm{Sym}^D E$ as in Lemma 17.1. Define the projective orbit closure

$$Z_R = \overline{\mathrm{GL}(E) \cdot K_R} \subset \mathrm{Gr}(r, \mathrm{Sym}^D E).$$

It is independent of a chosen basis of the cotangent space. Since Y_g is closed and invariant, $Z_R \subset Y_g$.

Theorem 10.1 (A universal ramified boundary point). *Set*

$$q_n = \begin{cases} 3, & n = 3, \\ 4, & n \geq 4, \end{cases} \quad k_n = h - q_n.$$

There is an explicitly constructed point K_∞ belonging to Z_R for every quadratic pencil R , with

$$K_\infty = a^{g+k_n} L_n, \quad L_n \subset \text{Sym}^{q_n} E, \quad \text{rank } L_n = r, \quad \gcd(L_n) = 1, \quad (10.1)$$

where $a \in E$ is a nonzero linear form. The flag pencil $R_* = \langle x_1^2, x_1 x_2 \rangle$ admits a finite-flat family of first-relation algebras over $\mathbb{A}^1$, with special relation space K_∞ and every nonzero fibre isomorphic to its failure algebra. Together with Theorem 19.1, this gives a chain of two explicit finite-flat specializations from the failure algebra of every R to the same boundary algebra.

The fibre of ν_g over K_∞ has a single geometric point, marked by a^g , and is nonreduced. Its tangent dimension is

$$\binom{e + k_n - 1}{k_n} - 1. \quad (10.2)$$

In particular K_∞ lies in the singular locus of Y_g and outside the exact-degree- g locus. For $n = 3$ this tangent dimension is 44.

The construction requires the exact osculating order of one elementary flag embedding. We include the calculation to distinguish the theorem from a computationally suggested degeneration.

Lemma 10.2 (The flag coefficient filtration). *Write a matrix of independent linear coordinates as*

$$T = aI_n + B, \quad B_{11} = 0.$$

For $C_* = C_{R_*}$, the filtration by vanishing order at $T = I_n$ on the chart $T_{11} = 1$ has last nonzero graded piece in degree q_n . It has a nonzero degree-zero piece. Hence an adapted basis $c_1, \dots, c_r$ has orders $0 \leq d_j \leq q_n$, attaining both endpoints, and

$$\lim_{\tau \rightarrow 0} \tau^{-d_j} c_j(aI_n + \tau B) = a^{h-d_j} p_j(B), \quad (10.3)$$

where the displayed initial forms are linearly independent.

Proof. The complementary-minor identity for $\text{Sym}^2 T$ identifies the vector of primitive coefficients, up to a fixed invertible coordinate change, with

$$\delta(T)^3 (v^2 \wedge vw), \quad v = T^{-1} e_1, \quad w = T^{-1} e_2. \quad (10.4)$$

Indeed $\det(\text{Sym}^2 T) = \delta^{n+1}$, the complementary minors have order two, and division of δI_{N-2} by δ^{n-1} leaves δ^3 . This identity is initially on $\delta \neq 0$; both sides are the same polynomial vector of degree h .

A standard affine flag chart has representatives

$$v = e_1 + \sum_{i=2}^n z_i e_i, \quad w = e_2 + \sum_{i=3}^n y_i e_i.$$

Every coordinate of $v^2 \wedge vw$ is a polynomial of degree at most four. The map from GL_n to this flag chart is smooth, and restricting to $T_{11} = 1$ remains smooth: the scalar subgroup is contained in each flag stabilizer and is transverse to this chart. Normalizing v, w only multiplies the whole wedge by a common unit. Smooth pullback preserves the order of a nonzero function, as does multiplication by a unit. The coordinates in (10.4) are linearly independent by the coefficient-span statement for C_R . Thus no nonzero linear combination can have order exceeding four. For $n \geq 4$, the coordinate indexed by $e_3^2 \wedge e_3 e_4$ is

$$z_3^2 (z_3 y_4 - z_4 y_3),$$

which is nonzero and has order exactly four.

For $n = 3$, put $z = z_2$, $w = z_3$, $t = y_3$. In the ordered basis $e_1^2, e_1 e_2, e_1 e_3, e_2^2, e_2 e_3, e_3^2$, the two factors are

$$(1, 2z, 2w, z^2, 2zw, w^2), \quad (0, 1, t, z, zt + w, wt).$$

Their fifteen wedge coordinates have the same linear span as

$$\begin{aligned} &1, z, w, t, z^2, zw, w^2, zt, wt, z^2t, zwt, w^2t, \\ &z^2w - z^3t, \quad zw^2 - z^2wt, \quad w^3 - zw^2t. \end{aligned} \quad (10.5)$$

This is obtained by subtracting the two coordinates with a common quadratic term and rescaling by 2. Their lowest homogeneous terms are distinct monomials, all of degrees at most three, and some have degree three. Thus the third jet is injective on this coefficient space and the second is not. This proves $q_3 = 3$. The coordinate $e_1^2 \wedge e_1 e_2$ is 1 in every dimension, proving the order-zero assertion. Finally, homogeneity of degree h gives (10.3); an adapted basis is by definition a basis on each associated-graded piece, so its initial forms are independent. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 10.1. The linear substitution $T \mapsto aI_n + \tau B$ is invertible for $\tau \neq 0$. Divide the adapted coefficient c_j by its exact power τ^{d_j} after substitution. There are no negative powers: all its terms have B -degree at least d_j . The resulting columns span a rank- r subbundle $J_\tau \subset \text{Sym}^h E \otimes \mathbb{C}[\tau]$. Independence at zero follows from the lemma, and away from zero from the invertible substitution. A matrix of constant fibre rank has locally split image, which proves the subbundle assertion over the whole line, not just at its closed points. Set

$$K_\tau = \det(aI_n + \tau B)^{n-1} J_\tau.$$

Multiplication by the nonzero homogeneous polynomial in every fibre again has constant rank. Consequently K_τ is a subbundle, and

$$\mathcal{A}_\tau = \text{Sym } E \otimes \mathbb{C}[\tau] / (K_\tau, \mathfrak{m}^{D+1})$$

is finite locally free of rank $\binom{e+D}{D} - r$. For $\tau \neq 0$, its relation space is a linear transform of K_{R^*} .

At zero the marked factor becomes a^g , while $J_0 = \langle a^{h-d_j} p_j(B) \rangle$. It contains a nonzero multiple of a^h , so its gcd is a power of a . It also contains a polynomial with exact a -adic order $h - q_n$, and every column is divisible by that power. Therefore $\gcd(J_0) = a^{k_n}$, proving (10.1). Notice that $0 < k_n < g$ for every $n \geq 3$.

The closed-flag specialization of Theorem 19.1 and its failure-algebra lift imply $K_{R^*} \in Z_R$. A closed invariant subset containing a point contains that point's orbit closure. Hence the just-constructed $K_\infty \in Z_{R^*}$ belongs to every Z_R . This proves the assertion about the two-stage specialization without replacing it by an unproved assertion about one fixed one-parameter subgroup acting on every initial pencil.

The sole degree- g divisor of a^{g+k_n} is a^g . Its overlap with the residual gcd is a^{k_n} . Lemma 7.3 gives (10.2); the fibre is supported at one point and has positive tangent space. The normalization criterion then proves singularity. With $n = 3$, $e = 9$ and $k_n = 2$, the dimension is $\binom{10}{2} - 1 = 44$. $\square$

10.1. The complete normalization fibre at the limiting algebra. The last theorem is not restricted to the tangent space of its fibre. The full local algebra can be given uniformly.

Proposition 10.3 (Pure-power divisor fibre). *Let $E = \mathbb{C}a \oplus W$, $g \geq k \geq 1$, and $K = a^{g+k}L$ with $\gcd(L) = 1$. Introduce coefficient variables for $q_i \in \text{Sym}^i W$, $1 \leq i \leq k$, and define forms c_j recursively by*

$$c_0 = 1, \quad c_j = - \sum_{i=1}^k q_i c_{j-i}, \quad c_j = 0 \ (j < 0). \quad (10.6)$$

The entire fibre of ν_g over K , supported at its unique point, is the Artin algebra

$$\mathbb{C}[[\text{coefficients of } q_1, \dots, q_k]] / (\text{coefficients of } c_{g+1}, \dots, c_{g+k}). \quad (10.7)$$

Its tangent dimension is $s_k(E) - 1$.

Proof. Choose $p \in L$ not divisible by a . Over any local Artin base, a divisor f near a^g is monic in a , and the quotient by f is flat over the base. The reductions of f, p are coprime. The regular-sequence argument used in (8.3) makes p a nonzerodivisor modulo f . Thus $f \mid a^{g+k}p$ is equivalent to $f \mid a^{g+k}$, functorially on these bases. Once this condition holds, it holds for every member of K .

Polynomial division gives a unique monic residual factor $H = a^k + q_1 a^{k-1} + \dots + q_k$. The equation $fH = a^{g+k}$ determines the coefficients of f successively as $c_1, \dots, c_g$ in (10.6). The remaining k product coefficients vanish if and only if $c_{g+1}, \dots, c_{g+k}$ vanish. This follows successively by comparing the product with the reciprocal series $(1 + \sum q_i a^{-i})^{-1}$. Hence (10.7) represents the full infinitesimal fibre, without reduction. Finiteness of ν_g makes it Artin; there is no other geometric divisor, so completion loses no part of the fibre. Since $g \geq k$, these equations have no linear terms in the coefficient variables. Their number is $\sum_{i=1}^k \dim \operatorname{Sym}^i W = \dim \operatorname{Sym}^k E - 1$, as asserted. $\square$

Example 10.4 (The nine-generator limit). For $n = 3$, the construction can be written with four of the nine linear coordinates, denoted a, u, v, w . The other five coordinates remain generators of the algebra. Up to nonzero scalar changes of the relation basis, $K_\infty = a^8 L_3$, where

$$L_3 = \langle a^3, a^2u, a^2v, a^2w, au^2, auv, av^2, auw, avw, \\ u^2v, u^2w, uv^2, uvw, v^3, v^2w \rangle. \quad (10.8)$$

Here one may take $u = B_{21}$, $v = B_{31}$, $w = B_{32}$; the monomials are the lowest terms in (10.5). The relation space has dimension 15 and exact gcd a^8 . The selected divisor has degree $g = 6$, and its fibre has 44 coefficient variables: eight coefficients of a linear form Q_1 and thirty-six of a quadratic form Q_2 in W . Its defining ideal consists of all coefficients of the two forms

$$c_7 = -Q_1^7 + 6Q_1^5Q_2 - 10Q_1^3Q_2^2 + 4Q_1Q_2^3, \\ c_8 = Q_1^8 - 7Q_1^6Q_2 + 15Q_1^4Q_2^2 - 10Q_1^2Q_2^3 + Q_2^4.$$

This is a full presentation of the normalization fibre. Its embedding dimension 44 is not being identified with its length, nor is this fibre algebra being identified with the completed local ring of Y_g .

Remark 10.5 (Relation to pencil invariants). The action defining Z_R is the intrinsic $\operatorname{GL}(E)$ action on first relations, not merely the congruence action on V . The flag pencil is singular: every member has rank at most two. It is therefore outside the regular-pencil open set treated by [4, Theorem 1.1 and §5], where Segre symbols organize classification and degenerations. The theorem above does not purport to classify that poset or all orbits in Z_R . Its conclusion is instead a uniform common boundary and an exact ramification algebra for genuine finite failure algebras. The increase from g to $g + k_n$ in the intrinsic gcd is precisely what is invisible in a fixed-determinant pencil specialization.

11. AN INTRINSIC COEFFICIENT PRINCIPLE

Extracting coefficient data from an abstract scheme and reconstructing a defining relation space from those data are distinct operations. The criterion below isolates the first. Its hypotheses will be verified directly for the multiplication schemes and then on curves.

11.1. The structural criterion. Let X be a finite-type complex scheme with a closed subvariety B specified by a construction preserved by every abstract scheme isomorphism. Write $\mathfrak{b} \subset \mathcal{O}_X$ for its ideal and

$$\mathcal{G} = \bigoplus_{r \geq 0} \mathfrak{b}^r / \mathfrak{b}^{r+1}, \quad \mathcal{A} = \operatorname{Sym}_{\mathcal{O}_B}(\mathcal{G}_1), \quad \mathcal{I} = \ker(\mathcal{A} \twoheadrightarrow \mathcal{G}).$$

Assume the following conditions, for fixed integers $n \geq 2, m \geq 1$.

- (i) B is connected and projective, $H^0(B, \mathcal{O}_B) = \mathbb{C}$, and $\mathcal{G}_1$ is locally free. Its dual admits a presentation $V \otimes \mathcal{U}^*$, where $\dim V = \text{rank } \mathcal{U} = n$.
- (ii) The reduction of $\text{Spec}_B \mathcal{G}$ in its degree-one ambient bundle is the generic determinant cone. The bundle $\mathbb{P}_B(\mathcal{U}^*)$ is not projectively trivial. Thus precisely one of the two ruling parameter bundles of its rank-one locus is projectively trivial.
- (iii) If $\mathcal{D} \subset \mathcal{A}$ is the ideal of that reduced cone and $\mathcal{L} = \mathcal{D}_n$, then $\mathcal{I} = \mathcal{D}\mathcal{J}$, where $\mathcal{J}$ is generated in degree m . Under the Cauchy decomposition in any local frame of $\mathcal{U}$,

$$\mathcal{J}_m = \bigoplus_{\lambda \in \Lambda} L_\lambda \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda \mathcal{U} \subset \text{Sym}^m(V^* \otimes \mathcal{U}), \quad L_\lambda \subset \mathbb{S}_\lambda V^*, \quad (11.1)$$

where Λ is a specified collection of partitions of m of length at most n , and the left subspaces are constant over B . Zero subspaces are permitted. The Cauchy inclusions, not just their representation labels, are the coefficient realizations $\beta \otimes \xi \mapsto [T \mapsto \beta(\mathbb{S}_\lambda(T)\xi)]$.

These conditions are hypotheses on the normal cone and its residual coefficient module. They do not assume that an abstract isomorphism extends to an ambient space, preserves a chosen frame, or already acts on all the left subspaces through a common projective transformation.

Theorem 11.1 (Intrinsic coefficient reconstruction). *Suppose X, B satisfy (i)–(iii). The abstract scheme X determines the collection $(L_\lambda)_{\lambda \in \Lambda}$ up to one common projective coordinate transformation on V . More precisely, an isomorphism between two such schemes induces a constant projective isomorphism $[g] : \mathbb{P}(V) \rightarrow \mathbb{P}(V')$ such that*

$$L_\lambda = \mathbb{S}_\lambda(g)^* L'_\lambda \quad (\lambda \in \Lambda).$$

The equality means equality of subspaces; scalar changes of a linear lift of $[g]$ do not affect it.

Proof. An isomorphism transports B , every power of $\mathfrak{b}$, $\mathcal{G}_1$, and the surjection $\mathcal{A} \twoheadrightarrow \mathcal{G}$. In particular it transports $\mathcal{I}$ in the intrinsic degree-one ambient bundle. Iterated reduced singular loci of the determinant cone give its rank-one locus. Lemma 3.1 reconstructs its two ruling parameter schemes, including their scheme structure. Condition (ii) distinguishes the trivial ruling intrinsically. Lemma 3.2 then gives one constant projective map $[g]$. After choosing a constant linear lift and local frames on both bases, the ambient bundle map has the form $T \mapsto gTh^{-1}$. These local choices are made only after constructing the graded algebra, its degree-one part, and the ruling.

Locally $\mathcal{D} = (d)$ with $d = \det T$. Its leading coefficient is a unit, so it is a nonzerodivisor over every coefficient ring. Hence $(\mathcal{I} : \mathcal{D}) = \mathcal{J}$, and

$$\mathcal{J}_m \simeq \mathcal{L}^* \otimes \mathcal{I}_{n+m}.$$

This recovers the residual module without choosing a scalar determinant equation. Under $T \mapsto gTh^{-1}$, the Cauchy coefficient map transports a tensor by $\mathbb{S}_\lambda(g)^* \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda(h^{-1})$. Projection to the specified Cauchy summand, followed by contraction against its whole right dual, therefore transports exactly L'_λ to L_λ . The right map is invertible and has no effect on that left image. Both determinant-line transition functions and changes of a lift of $[g]$ act by scalar units. Since every partition has size m , this ambiguity is common in degree and disappears on subspaces. This proves the assertion. $\square$

12. QUADRATIC RELATION SPACES AND INTRINSIC RECONSTRUCTION OF PENCILS

The multiplication construction itself supplies a wider natural class for the coefficient criterion. In this section the number of quadratic relations is allowed to vary independently of the embedding dimension. For two relations the resulting theorem recovers every pencil of quadrics, including singular pencils. No extra block is added to the multiplication map.

12.1. Automatic coefficient extraction for quadratic multiplication. Let $\dim V = n \geq 3$, $W = \text{Sym}^2 V$, $N = n(n+1)/2$, and $R \in \text{Gr}(r, W)$, where $1 \leq r < N - n$. Put $p = N - r > n$, $S = W/R$, and

$$A_R = \mathbb{C} \oplus V \oplus S, \quad X_R = \text{Gr}(n, V \oplus S).$$

The only nonzero product in the maximal ideal is the quotient map $\gamma : \text{Sym}^2 V \rightarrow S$. Write $\mathcal{K}$ for the tautological bundle on X_R , and use the same definition (1.1) of $\hat{D}_R$, with A_R in place of B_R . Thus $\hat{D}_R$ is the failure scheme of generating A_R by a varying n -plane and the unit. The notation in this section agrees with the web construction when $(n, r) = (4, 4)$.

Let $\Lambda_{n,p}$ denote the partitions occurring in the classical multiplicity-free decomposition

$$F(V) := \bigwedge^p \text{Sym}^2 V = \bigoplus_{\lambda \in \Lambda_{n,p}} \mathbb{S}_\lambda V. \quad (12.1)$$

Every partition has size $2p$; terms of length greater than n are omitted. Choose a nonzero volume form on S and let $\beta_R \in F(V)^*$ be its pullback by $\bigwedge^p \gamma$. Its component in $\mathbb{S}_\lambda V^*$ is denoted by $\beta_{R,\lambda}$. Only the lines of the nonzero components will be used, so the volume choice is immaterial.

Theorem 12.1 (Automatic intrinsic coefficient extraction). *For every $R \in \text{Gr}(r, \text{Sym}^2 V)$ in the stated range, the abstract scheme $\hat{D}_R$ determines*

$$(\mathbb{C}\beta_{R,\lambda})_{\lambda \in \Lambda_{n,p}}$$

up to one common projective transformation of V , with zero components recorded as zero subspaces. More precisely, the intrinsic construction recovers the base $B = \text{Gr}(n, S)$, its degree-one normal-cone bundle, and the residual ideal generated in degree $2p$ with coefficient module

$$\mathcal{J}_{2p} = \bigoplus_{\lambda \in \Lambda_{n,p}} \mathbb{C}\beta_{R,\lambda} \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda \mathcal{U} \subset \text{Sym}^{2p}(V^* \otimes \mathcal{U}), \quad (12.2)$$

where $\mathcal{U}$ is the tautological rank- n bundle on B . Consequently all geometric hypotheses of Theorem 11.1 hold for this entire Grassmannian family, not just for smooth webs.

Proof. On a frame chart of $\mathcal{K}$, write its inclusion as $\begin{pmatrix} M \\ A_0 \end{pmatrix}$, with M an $n \times n$ matrix. Since A_R is cube-zero, columns of degree greater than two vanish. After retaining the scalar, linear, and quadratic columns, multiplication has the matrix

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & M & 0 \\ 0 & A_0 & \gamma \text{Sym}^2 M \end{pmatrix}. \quad (12.3)$$

A nonzero maximal minor must use the scalar column and all n linear columns: these are the only columns meeting the first $1+n$ rows. Expanding along those rows gives the identity of ideals

$$I_{\hat{D}_R} = (\det M) I_p(\gamma \text{Sym}^2 M). \quad (12.4)$$

The same expansion works for every $m \geq 2$. Where M is invertible, the quadratic map is surjective. Hence the reduction of $\hat{D}_R$ is exactly the Schubert divisor where M is singular, independent of R after identifying the vector spaces S .

Successive reduced singular loci of that divisor are the projection rank loci. Their last nonempty member is $B = \text{Gr}(n, S)$. For clarity, the usual determinantal assertion here is local: at a projection-rank- k point, an invertible k -minor splits away, leaving a generic square $(n-k)$ -matrix and smooth coordinates. Every remaining entry can vary independently by moving the kernel of the projection in V modulo its image. Thus its reduced singular locus is the next rank locus. Since $p > n$, the final base is nonempty, connected and projective, with $H^0(B, \mathcal{O}_B) = \mathbb{C}$.

Near B , a Grassmannian chart consists of a varying plane in S and its graph $T : \mathcal{U} \rightarrow V$. Formula (12.4) is independent of the other graph coordinates and homogeneous in T . It therefore gives its actual normal-cone ideal, not merely an initial reduced support:

$$C_B \hat{D}_R \subset \text{Tot Hom}(\mathcal{U}, V), \quad \mathcal{I} = (\det T) \mathcal{J}, \quad \mathcal{J} = I_p(\gamma \text{Sym}^2 T). \quad (12.5)$$

There are no degree-one equations. The ambient bundle in (12.5) is consequently the dual of the intrinsically recovered degree-one conormal. Its reduced ideal is the determinant ideal $\mathcal{D}$. The determinant polynomial is monic for a suitable monomial order, so cancellation gives $(\mathcal{I} : \mathcal{D}) = \mathcal{J}$. This is an intrinsic ideal quotient; choosing a generator of the determinant line is not part of the recovered datum.

The rank-one locus of the reduced cone determines the two ruling parameter schemes by Lemma 3.1. They are $\mathbb{P}(V) \times B$ and $\mathbb{P}_B(\mathcal{U}^*)$. Exactly the first is projectively trivial. Indeed a Schubert line in $\text{Gr}(n, S)$ restricts $\mathcal{U}^*$ to $\mathcal{O}(1) \oplus \mathcal{O}^{n-1}$. A trivial projective bundle on that line would make this bundle a line-bundle twist of $\mathcal{O}^n$; its determinant would then have degree divisible by n , rather than degree one. Thus the trivial ruling is intrinsically oriented. Lemma 3.2 applies: an abstract isomorphism gives a morphism $B \rightarrow \text{PGL}(V)$, constant because B is connected projective and $\text{PGL}(V)$ is affine. Local linear lifts and right changes of frame give $T \mapsto gTh^{-1}$ for this one fixed $[g]$.

It remains to prove (12.2), rather than assume it as a condition on the example. The minors are the image, for fixed β_R , of the universal coefficient map

$$F(V)^* \otimes F(U) \longrightarrow \text{Sym}^{2p}(V^* \otimes U), \quad \beta \otimes \xi \longmapsto [T \mapsto \beta(F(T)\xi)]. \quad (12.6)$$

In characteristic zero, the polynomial functor F has the multiplicity-free decomposition (12.1); see [3, Theorem 3.5]. The Cauchy decomposition of the target contains each diagonal $\mathbb{S}_\lambda V^* \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda U$ once, and no off-diagonal pair. Equivariance kills every off-diagonal pair. On each diagonal pair the coefficient map is nonzero: identify U with V , evaluate at $T = 1$, and choose β, ξ in that summand with $\beta(\xi) \neq 0$. Schur's lemma then identifies its image with the specified Cauchy summand. This is the actual matrix-coefficient inclusion, not merely a dimension count. Keeping β_R fixed proves (12.2). All generators have degree $2p$, and at least one minor is nonzero since γ is surjective.

Under $T \mapsto gTh^{-1}$, the right map acts within the full factor $\mathbb{S}_\lambda U$. Contracting against its dual therefore leaves exactly the left coefficient line transformed by $\mathbb{S}_\lambda(g)^*$. Determinant-line scalars and local lift ambiguities do not change these lines. This proves the theorem. $\square$

The theorem does not assert that separately projectivized Schur components always determine their relative scalars. For webs this is the recombination problem solved in the separate research archive. For pencils that issue disappears altogether.

12.2. Every pencil, without a regularity hypothesis.

Lemma 12.2 (The exterior square of the quadratic representation). *For $n \geq 2$, $\bigwedge^2 \text{Sym}^2 V = \mathbb{S}_{(3,1)} V$ is irreducible. Consequently $\bigwedge^{N-2} \text{Sym}^2 V$ is irreducible as well.*

Proof. The vector $x_1^2 \wedge x_1 x_2$ is a highest-weight vector of weight $(3, 1)$. By complete reducibility it generates a copy of $\mathbb{S}_{(3,1)} V$. The hook formula gives

$$\dim \mathbb{S}_{(3,1)} V = \frac{n(n-1)(n+1)(n+2)}{8} = \binom{N}{2}.$$

This exhausts the exterior square. The last assertion follows by exterior duality. These are classical representation identities. $\square$

Theorem 12.3 (Intrinsic reconstruction of all quadratic pencils). *Let $n \geq 3$ and let R, R' be two-dimensional subspaces of $\text{Sym}^2 V$. For the natural multiplication-failure schemes of their cube-zero algebras of Hilbert function $(1, n, N - 2)$,*

$$\widehat{D}_R \simeq \widehat{D}_{R'} \iff R' = gR \text{ for some } g \in \text{PGL}(V). \quad (12.7)$$

No pencil, base locus, or discriminant is required to be smooth or regular. The isomorphism on the left is abstract and carries no supplied ambient embedding, base, or tensor-factor marking. All the reduced schemes are isomorphic to the same Schubert divisor.

Proof. Here $p = N - 2 > n$. By Theorem 12.1 and Lemma 12.2, the normal cone has only one left coefficient line to recover: the entire line $\mathbb{C}\beta_R$. The canonical duality

$$\bigwedge^{N-2} W^* \simeq \bigwedge^2 W \otimes (\det W)^* = \bigwedge^2 W \otimes (\det V)^{-(n+1)} \quad (12.8)$$

sends that line to the Pluecker line of R , with the same projective transformation g . Indeed the pullback of a quotient volume is the annihilator-volume dual of the kernel R . The common determinant character is a scalar on projective space. A nonzero decomposable two-vector recovers its plane as $\{w \in W : w \wedge w_R = 0\}$. Thus an abstract scheme isomorphism implies $R' = gR$.

Conversely such a linear coordinate change induces the quotient isomorphism $S_R \rightarrow S_{R'}$, the algebra isomorphism $A_R \rightarrow A_{R'}$, and the corresponding Grassmannian isomorphism. It intertwines multiplication and hence preserves its zeroth Fitting ideal. This proves the reverse implication. The assertion about reductions was proved in (12.4). $\square$

12.3. Discriminants, elementary divisors, and hyperelliptic moduli. A regular pencil means one containing an invertible symmetric matrix; it need not have a reduced discriminant. The classical invariant of such a pencil consists of its discriminant points together with their Jordan-block partitions, usually called its Weierstrass–Segre data. We use the root-labelled partitions, not a pairing of an unlabelled list with an independently unlabelled divisor. Their classification is classical; compare [4, Theorem 1.1, Corollary 2.1 and §2]. The following consequence identifies precisely what the intrinsic failure scheme remembers beyond the discriminant.

Corollary 12.4 (Intrinsic recovery of elementary divisors). *For a regular pencil in any dimension $n \geq 3$, the abstract scheme $\widehat{D}_R$ determines all root-labelled elementary divisors of a matrix pencil, up to projective reparametrization of its parameter line. Conversely these data determine its abstract failure scheme. In particular the invariant distinguishes different Jordan partitions over a fixed multiple discriminant root.*

Proof. The first implication follows by reconstructing R , then choosing an invertible member A and a complementary member B . For completeness, the relevant classical sufficiency can be seen directly. Put $C = A^{-1}B$; it is self-adjoint for A . If $hC = C'h$ identifies the Jordan forms for another pair (A', B') , set

$$H = A^{-1}h^t A' h.$$

Then H is invertible, A -self-adjoint, and commutes with C . There is a polynomial k in H with $k^2 = H$: on each nonzero eigenvalue choose a square root and truncate its Taylor series to the size of the largest Jordan block, then combine by the Chinese remainder theorem. Thus k is invertible, self-adjoint, and commutes with C . The map hk^{-1} is an isometry from A to A' and intertwines C, C' , so it simultaneously identifies A, B with A', B' .

Changing the basis of the pencil replaces C by a fractional linear expression with invertible denominator. At each eigenvalue its derivative is nonzero; hence each Jordan-block size is preserved while its root moves by the same projective transformation. A parameter change can avoid infinity for both finite spectra. Root-labelled elementary divisors therefore suffice, and

(12.7) proves the converse for the failure schemes. This argument recalls the classical classification; the new input is recovery from an unmarked abstract failure scheme. $\square$

Example 12.5 (Identical discriminant, distinct intrinsic failure schemes). Choose distinct nonzero $\mu_3, \dots, \mu_n$, and put

$$S_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad J_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Consider the symmetric pairs

$$\begin{aligned} A_s &= I_n, & B_s &= \text{diag}(0, 0, \mu_3, \dots, \mu_n), \\ A_j &= S_2 \oplus I_{n-2}, & B_j &= S_2 J_2 \oplus \text{diag}(\mu_3, \dots, \mu_n). \end{aligned}$$

Their determinant binary forms agree up to a nonzero scalar:

$$\det(sA_s + tB_s) = -\det(sA_j + tB_j) = s^2 \prod_{i=3}^n (s + \mu_i t). \quad (12.9)$$

At the unique double root the ranks are respectively $n-2$ and $n-1$, so no simultaneous projective equivalence exists. The two root partitions are $(1, 1)$ and (2) . Their abstract failure schemes are therefore nonisomorphic although both their reduced failure schemes and their discriminant divisors, including multiplicities, agree. This realizes inside the same multiplication construction the classical loss of elementary-divisor information under passage to the determinant.

Corollary 12.6 (Hyperelliptic isomorphism classes). *Fix $g \geq 2$ and $n = 2g + 2$. On the locus of pencils with simple discriminant, $\widehat{D}_R$ gives an injective invariant of the isomorphism classes of smooth hyperelliptic curves of genus g . All these failure schemes have the same reduction; their nonreduced structures distinguish a $(2g - 1)$ -dimensional family of curve classes. The pencil invariant also distinguishes the two regular boundary pencils in Example 12.5, where their singular discriminant double covers alone do not.*

Proof. The classical curve associated with a simple-discriminant pencil is the double cover of its parameter line branched at $\det(sA + tB) = 0$; see [6, §4.2, equation (4.3)]. Choose an invertible member. Distinct eigenvalues of $A^{-1}B$ have mutually A -orthogonal eigenlines, each nonisotropic, so simultaneous diagonalization identifies the pencil with $\langle \sum x_i^2, \sum \lambda_i x_i^2 \rangle$. The unordered branch divisor modulo PGL_2 therefore determines the pencil, and every reduced divisor of degree $2g + 2$ arises. A smooth curve of genus at least two has a unique degree-two map to a rational curve up to automorphism of that curve: two distinct such maps would give a birational map to a curve of bidegree $(2, 2)$ in $\mathbb{P}^1 \times \mathbb{P}^1$, whose arithmetic genus is one. Thus curve isomorphism is exactly branch-divisor equivalence. Applying Theorem 12.3 gives the asserted injectivity and well-definedness.

Ordered distinct branch points have dimension $2g + 2$. Normalizing three of them removes the three-dimensional projective action; taking the finite permutation quotient leaves dimension $2g - 1$. Equality of all reductions follows from (12.4). Finally the two binary forms in (12.9) differ only by a scalar, a square over $\mathbb{C}$, and define isomorphic double covers, whereas their failure schemes have already been separated. $\square$

These are statements about complex isomorphism classes. They do not identify moduli stacks, assert a universal family over a coarse moduli space, or eliminate the different automorphism groups of pencils and curves. Nor is the classical pencil-hyperelliptic correspondence a new Torelli theorem. The conclusion here is reconstruction of those objects and of the elementary-divisor information on their boundary from the abstract nonreduced multiplication-failure scheme, while all reduced failure data are fixed.

13. THE EXACT INFINITESIMAL ORDER OF PENCIL RECONSTRUCTION

The all-pencil theorem admits a finite-order strengthening. It identifies the first infinitesimal neighbourhood that retains the pencil, and shows that every preceding neighbourhood is independent of it. We use ideal-adic neighbourhoods of the deepest stratum; these are not arc spaces or jet schemes.

Throughout this section let $n \geq 3$, $W = \text{Sym}^2 V$, and

$$N = \binom{n+1}{2}, \quad p = N - 2, \quad d = n + 2p = n^2 + 2n - 4. \quad (13.1)$$

For a pencil $R \subset W$, put $S_R = W/R$ and $B = \text{Gr}(n, S_R) \subset \widehat{D}_R$. This notation for the socle Grassmannian is local to this section; the cube-zero algebra is denoted by A_R , as in Section 12. Write $\mathfrak{b} \subset \mathcal{O}_{\widehat{D}_R}$ for the ideal of B , and define

$$Z_R^{[k]} = (B, \mathcal{O}_{\widehat{D}_R}/\mathfrak{b}^{k+1}) \quad (k \geq 0). \quad (13.2)$$

Thus $Z_R^{[0]} = B$. No embedding or identification of its reduction is supplied with the abstract scheme $Z_R^{[k]}$.

Theorem 13.1 (Sharp finite-neighbourhood reconstruction). *For any two pencils $R, R' \subset \text{Sym}^2 V$, the following conditions are equivalent:*

$$\begin{aligned} Z_R^{[d]} \simeq Z_{R'}^{[d]} &\iff \widehat{D}_R \simeq \widehat{D}_{R'} \\ &\iff R' = gR \text{ for some } g \in \text{PGL}(V). \end{aligned} \quad (13.3)$$

In contrast, for every $0 \leq k < d$, all the schemes $Z_R^{[k]}$ are isomorphic. Consequently d is the smallest uniform order at which these neighbourhoods classify all pencils up to projective equivalence. Singular pencils are included.

13.1. The first relation in the conormal algebra. Let $\mathcal{U}$ be tautological on B . The open set of X_R where projection to S_R is injective is canonically $\text{Tot } E$, where $E = \text{Hom}(\mathcal{U}, V)$: a plane is the graph of a unique map from its image in S_R to V . In particular this is one open neighbourhood of all of B , not merely a collection of unrelated formal charts. Let $\mathfrak{a}$ be its zero-section ideal. The exact multiplication calculation (12.4) gives

$$\mathcal{I}_R = (\det T) I_p(\gamma_R \text{Sym}^2 T) \subset \text{Sym } E^*. \quad (13.4)$$

It is generated in degree d , with a nonzero degree- d piece K_R . Indeed each quadratic minor has degree $2p$, and an invertible T makes $\gamma_R \text{Sym}^2 T$ surjective. There are no terms of lower degree, even on special pencils. Homogeneity is an equality of ideals in the actual graph neighbourhood, not just an equality of initial supports.

Lemma 13.2 (Intrinsic recovery from the first relation). *The abstract scheme $Z_R^{[d]}$ determines, as a graded $\mathcal{O}_B$ -algebra, the complete normal-cone algebra $\text{gr}_{\mathfrak{b}} \mathcal{O}_{\widehat{D}_R}$.*

Proof. The reduction of $Z_R^{[d]}$ is B , since its zero-section ideal is nilpotent and B is reduced. Hence its nilradical $\mathfrak{n}$ is intrinsic. Put $L = \mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2$. Formula (13.4) and $d > 1$ identify $L = E^*$. Multiplication in the given finite scheme recovers

$$K_R = \ker[\text{Sym}^d L \longrightarrow \mathfrak{n}^d/\mathfrak{n}^{d+1}]. \quad (13.5)$$

The last denominator is zero, but retaining it displays the grading. No splitting of the reduction map is needed to form this kernel. Because $\mathcal{I}_R$ is generated in this single degree,

$$\text{gr}_{\mathfrak{b}} \mathcal{O}_{\widehat{D}_R} = \text{Sym}_{\mathcal{O}_B} L/(K_R). \quad (13.6)$$

Here (K_R) denotes the homogeneous ideal generated by K_R , not its radical. The right side is intrinsic to the finite scheme, proving the assertion. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 13.1. For $k < d$, equations (13.4) and (13.2) give

$$\mathcal{O}_{Z_R^{[k]}} = \text{Sym } E^* / \mathfrak{a}^{k+1}.$$

A linear identification $S_R \simeq S_{R'}$ identifies B , its tautological bundle, and E . It therefore identifies every one of these lower-order neighbourhoods.

An abstract isomorphism at order d induces an isomorphism of reductions, of conormal bundles, and, by Lemma 13.2, of complete graded normal cones. We spell out why the reconstruction in Theorem 12.1 requires no information outside this cone. Its reduced support is the square-matrix determinant cone; its iterated singular loci give the rank-one cone. The relative scheme of maximal linear spaces in that cone has the two rulings $\mathbb{P}(V) \times B$ and $\mathbb{P}_B(\mathcal{U}^*)$. Exactly the first is projectively trivial, as is seen by restriction to a Schubert line. Thus it is intrinsically oriented. The induced projective transformation of the trivial factor is constant on the connected projective base. Local lifts have the form $T \mapsto gTh^{-1}$ for this one $[g]$. The determinant ideal line is intrinsic, so its ideal quotient in (13.4) recovers the residual ideal. Finally Lemma 12.2 identifies the entire left coefficient line $\mathbb{C}\beta_R$, and exterior duality (12.8) recovers the Pluecker line of R . These are operations on the recovered normal cone; we do not assume that its isomorphism extends to X_R or $\hat{D}_R$. They imply $R' = gR$.

Conversely such a projective transformation induces the algebra and failure-scheme isomorphisms, carrying the socle Grassmannian to the socle Grassmannian and preserving all its ideal powers. This proves (13.3), also using Theorem 12.3. For sharpness, there are inequivalent pencils in every dimension under consideration: $\langle x_1^2, x_1x_2 \rangle$ has a common linear factor, whereas $\langle x_1^2, x_2^2 \rangle$ does not. Their neighbourhoods are nevertheless isomorphic at every order below d . Thus no smaller order classifies all pencils. $\square$

13.2. A closed immersion of the full parameter scheme. The finite-order result has a scheme-theoretic parameter version, which records infinitesimal variation as well as closed points. Here tensor coordinates are fixed. This additional qualification is important: we are not asserting an equivalence of unmarked moduli stacks.

Fix an auxiliary n -dimensional vector space U , and put

$$F(V) = \bigwedge^p \text{Sym}^2 V, \quad F(U) = \bigwedge^p \text{Sym}^2 U, \quad M = \dim F(U) = \binom{N}{2}, \quad H = \text{Hom}(U, V).$$

Choose a nonzero scalar representative δ of the determinant polynomial on H ; its scalar has no effect on the subspaces below. Let $K_R \subset \text{Sym}^d H^*$ be the degree- d space of $(\det T)I_p(\gamma_R \text{Sym}^2 T)$ in these fixed coordinates.

Theorem 13.3 (Faithful finite-order parameterization). *The assignment*

$$\Phi : \text{Gr}(2, \text{Sym}^2 V) \longrightarrow \text{Gr}(M, \text{Sym}^d H^*), \quad R \longmapsto K_R, \quad (13.7)$$

is a closed immersion. It is defined on the whole Grassmannian, including singular pencils. Its construction and its inverse on the image commute with arbitrary base change over $\mathbb{C}$. In particular it separates families over nonreduced bases and has injective differential at every pencil.

Lemma 13.4 (Tensoring a line with a fixed space). *For finite-dimensional vector spaces A, B_0 , with $b = \dim B_0 > 0$, the map $\mathbb{P}(A) \rightarrow \text{Gr}(b, A \otimes B_0)$, $\ell \mapsto \ell \otimes B_0$, is a closed immersion.*

Proof. Choose bases $a_0, \dots, a_t$ and a basis of B_0 . Above the projective chart $\ell = \mathbb{C}(a_0 + \sum x_i a_i)$, the subspace is the graph of the block matrices $x_i I_b$. The corresponding Grassmannian chart has arbitrary $b \times b$ blocks. The image is cut out by their off-diagonal entries and the differences

between their diagonal entries; an inverse reads one diagonal entry in each block. These are scheme-theoretic equations over any $\mathbb{C}$ -algebra, not just pointwise conditions. The preimage of this Grassmannian chart is exactly the stated projective chart, since the projection has determinant a_0^b . Such charts cover the image. The map is proper because its source is projective, so these chartwise closed immersions give a global closed immersion. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 13.3. The coefficient map (12.6) becomes

$$\mu : F(V)^* \otimes F(U) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Sym}^{2p} H^*.$$

It is injective: by Lemma 12.2 its source is irreducible for $\mathrm{GL}(V) \times \mathrm{GL}(U)$, and evaluation at an isomorphism $U \simeq V$ shows that the equivariant map is nonzero. Multiplication by the nonzero polynomial δ is injective. Thus $\nu = \delta\mu$ is a fixed linear inclusion and

$$K_R = \nu(\mathbb{C}\beta_R \otimes F(U)). \quad (13.8)$$

In particular $\dim K_R = M$, also on every singular pencil. By exterior duality the quotient-volume map $R \mapsto \mathbb{C}\beta_R$ is the Pluecker closed immersion $\mathrm{Gr}(2, W) \hookrightarrow \mathbb{P}(F(V)^*)$. Factor Φ through this map, the closed immersion of Lemma 13.4, and the Grassmannian closed immersion induced by ν . This proves the theorem. All are morphisms of schemes defined by the displayed polynomial and linear equations. A closed immersion is a monomorphism and remains one after arbitrary base change. This proves the family assertion, not merely separation of complex-valued points. $\square$

Corollary 13.5 (A flat family of finite normal algebras). *Over $\mathrm{Gr}(2, W)$, the algebras*

$$Q_R = \mathrm{Sym} H^* / ((K_R) + \mathfrak{m}^{d+1}), \quad \mathfrak{m} = \bigoplus_{j>0} \mathrm{Sym}^j H^*, \quad (13.9)$$

form a finite locally free family of rank

$$\binom{n^2 + d}{d} - \binom{N}{2}.$$

In fixed coordinates this family determines every base-changed family of pencils. All its truncations below degree d are constant families.

Proof. Theorem 13.3 makes the spaces K_R a rank- M subbundle of the constant degree- d bundle, with locally free quotient. In degree $j < d$ the algebra is $\mathrm{Sym}^j H^*$, and its degree- d piece is $\mathrm{Sym}^d H^* / K_R$; higher degrees vanish. This proves local freeness and base-change compatibility. Summing the ranks gives the displayed binomial identity. The kernel of the coordinate quotient in degree d recovers K_R , and Φ recovers the pencil family. This is a statement about coordinate quotient algebras; it does not discard their coordinate maps and then infer a family reconstruction theorem. $\square$

13.3. Classical moduli at a sharp order.

Corollary 13.6 (Hyperelliptic classes in finite neighbourhoods). *Let $g \geq 2$, $n = 2g + 2$, and $d = 4g^2 + 12g + 4$. For pencils with simple discriminant, $Z_R^{[d]}$ and $Z_{R'}^{[d]}$ are isomorphic if and only if their associated hyperelliptic curves are isomorphic. Every lower-order neighbourhood is independent of the curve. Thus the same $(2g - 1)$ -dimensional family of curve classes is invisible to all these lower-order neighbourhoods and is separated at order d .*

Proof. Combine Theorem 13.1 with Corollary 12.6, and substitute $n = 2g + 2$ in (13.1). $\square$

The order here concerns a neighbourhood of the entire projective socle Grassmannian. Its global ruling distinguishes the constant V -factor from the tautological factor. A single unmarked Artinian normal slice does not supply this orientation; the coordinate statement of Corollary 13.5 is

deliberately different. The result is therefore not a claim that one unmarked local algebra replaces the projective family. The matrix-pencil classification and the hyperelliptic correspondence remain classical. The assertion proved here is that this classical information first appears at the specified order in the intrinsic multiplication-failure neighbourhoods.

14. RECONSTRUCTION ON A PROJECTIVE CURVE

The global part of the inverse argument has a more economical geometric realization. It uses a proper base to make the projective left frame constant, and a nontrivial right projective bundle to distinguish the rulings. Neither step requires the whole socle Grassmannian. We now replace that Grassmannian by a curve. In particular, a neighbourhood supported on one Schubert line already retains every pencil.

Let C be a smooth connected projective complex curve, and let $\mathcal{U}$ be a rank- n bundle on C , where $n \geq 3$. Assume that $\mathbb{P}_C(\mathcal{U}^*)$ is not projectively trivial. A sufficient numerical condition is

$$\deg \det \mathcal{U} \not\equiv 0 \pmod{n}. \quad (14.1)$$

Indeed a projectively trivial rank- n bundle is a line-bundle twist of a trivial bundle, so its determinant degree is divisible by n . Fix V of dimension n , put $E = \text{Hom}(\mathcal{U}, V)$, and let $\mathfrak{a}$ be the zero-section ideal in $\text{Sym } E^*$. For a pencil $R \subset \text{Sym}^2 V$, the quotient $\gamma_R : \text{Sym}^2 V \rightarrow S_R$ defines the homogeneous ideal

$$\mathcal{I}_{R,C} = (\det T) I_p(\gamma_R \text{Sym}^2 T), \quad p = \binom{n+1}{2} - 2, \quad (14.2)$$

where $T : \mathcal{U} \rightarrow V$ is the universal map on $\text{Tot } E$. The expression is independent of local frames: both determinant multiplication and the maximal-minor construction are bundle constructions. Define

$$Y_{R,C}^{[k]} = \text{Spec}_C(\text{Sym } E^* / (\mathcal{I}_{R,C} + \mathfrak{a}^{k+1})).$$

Only its abstract complex scheme is retained, not its projection to C , its embedding in $\text{Tot } E$, or either tensor factor.

Theorem 14.1 (Curve-supported reconstruction). *For fixed $(C, \mathcal{U}, V)$ as above and $d = n^2 + 2n - 4$, every pair of quadratic pencils satisfies*

$$Y_{R,C}^{[d]} \simeq Y_{R',C}^{[d]} \iff R' = gR \text{ for some } g \in \text{PGL}(V). \quad (14.3)$$

All lower-order neighbourhoods are independent of R . The order- d schemes are finite locally free over C of rank $\binom{n^2+d}{d} - \binom{N}{2}$, where $N = \binom{n+1}{2}$. No regularity condition is imposed on the pencil.

Proof. On any frame chart, the ideal in (14.2) is generated in degree d . Its degree- d piece K_R is a subbundle of rank $\binom{N}{2}$, by the fixed coefficient inclusion (13.8); its quotient is locally free. The quotient algebra has its full symmetric powers in degrees less than d , has $\text{Sym}^d E^* / K_R$ in degree d , and is zero above that degree. This proves the rank and the assertion about lower orders.

Its reduction is C , and its nilradical $\mathfrak{n}$ recovers $L = \mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2$ and

$$K_R = \ker[\text{Sym}^d L \rightarrow \mathfrak{n}^d].$$

Thus the abstract finite-order scheme reconstructs the entire graded algebra $\text{Sym } L / (K_R)$, by the same argument as Lemma 13.2. The ideal here means the homogeneous ideal generated by the recovered kernel, not its radical. No splitting of the reduction or supplied projection is used.

The reduction of this reconstructed cone is the determinant cone. Indeed its ideal has the determinant factor, and when T is invertible the quadratic quotient has full rank. Its rank-one Fano scheme has two ruling components, $\mathbb{P}(V) \times C$ and $\mathbb{P}_C(\mathcal{U}^*)$. The hypothesis distinguishes the first one intrinsically. An abstract isomorphism of neighbourhoods may induce a nonidentity

automorphism of C ; pull back the second bundle along that automorphism. The oriented ruling map is nevertheless a morphism from C to PGL_n . It is constant, since C is connected projective and $H^0(C, \mathcal{O}_C) = \mathbb{C}$. Lemma 3.2 therefore supplies one constant projective left frame.

Cancel the intrinsic determinant ideal and apply the coefficient construction of Theorem 11.1. For pencils, Lemma 12.2 leaves just the single line $\mathbb{C}\beta_R$. Exterior duality (12.8) recovers R with respect to that same projective frame. This proves the forward implication in (14.3). Conversely a linear lift of g induces the bundle map on E and the quotient isomorphism on S_R , and carries all the displayed ideals and their truncations to the corresponding ideals for R' . This proves the converse. $\square$

Corollary 14.2 (One Schubert line suffices). *Let $\ell \simeq \mathbb{P}^1$ be any Schubert line in $B_R = \mathrm{Gr}(n, S_R)$, and use the canonical graph projection $Z_R^{[d]} \rightarrow B_R$ to form its restriction $Z_{R,\ell}^{[d]}$. Its abstract isomorphism class is independent of the choice of ℓ , and*

$$Z_{R,\ell}^{[d]} \simeq Z_{R',\ell'}^{[d]} \iff R' = gR \text{ for some } g \in \mathrm{PGL}(V).$$

The smallest uniform reconstruction order for these curve-supported neighbourhoods is again d . Their reductions all have dimension one, instead of $n(p-n)$.

Proof. The tautological bundle on a Schubert line is $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}(-1) \oplus \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}^{n-1}$. Pulling back the homogeneous ideal of the graph neighbourhood gives exactly (14.2) with that bundle. Its isomorphism type depends on this bundle and R , not on the chosen inclusion of the line in the socle. The determinant degree is -1 , so Theorem 14.1 applies. Its lower-order schemes are all independent of the pencil, while $\langle x_1^2, x_1x_2 \rangle$ and $\langle x_1^2, x_2^2 \rangle$ are inequivalent. This proves the uniform minimality assertion. $\square$

This restriction is made in the construction; it is not a claim that an abstract neighbourhood canonically chooses a Schubert line. No line is supplied to an isomorphism in the corollary: the reduced curve is recovered as the reduction of its source. Nor is the corollary a statement about one unmarked Artinian normal slice. The projective curve and the nontrivial ruling remain essential to this argument. The same theorem applies, for example, to $\mathcal{U} = \mathcal{O}_C(-P) \oplus \mathcal{O}_C^{n-1}$ on every smooth projective connected curve with a point P . It isolates the properness and ruling obstruction used in reconstruction, independently of the original Grassmannian realization.

15. RECONSTRUCTION OF MOVING PENCILS AND THEIR ISOMORPHISMS

The inverse need not be applied separately to constant pencils. A single unmarked finite scheme can retain a pencil varying over its entire projective reduction. We prove this assertion, including the recovery of the normal bundle and the ambiguity in lifting the recovered data to an isomorphism. The coefficient lines in this section are subbundles; constancy of the pencil is not assumed.

15.1. The family and its first relation bundle. Fix $n \geq 3$, and write

$$N = \binom{n+1}{2}, \quad p = N - 2, \quad d = n + 2p = n^2 + 2n - 4, \quad M = \binom{N}{2}.$$

An admissible datum consists of a smooth connected projective complex variety B , a rank- n vector bundle $\mathcal{U}$ on B , a constant n -dimensional vector space V , and a rank-two locally direct-summand subbundle

$$\mathcal{R} \subset \mathrm{Sym}^2 V \otimes \mathcal{O}_B.$$

We require that $\mathbb{P}_B(\mathcal{U}^*)$ is not a trivial projective bundle. Put $\mathcal{S} = (\text{Sym}^2 V \otimes \mathcal{O}_B)/\mathcal{R}$ and $\mathcal{E} = \text{Hom}(\mathcal{U}, V \otimes \mathcal{O}_B)$. On its total space, let T be the universal map and let γ denote the quotient onto $\mathcal{S}$. Define the homogeneous ideal and its truncations by

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{R}} &= (\det T)I_p(\gamma \text{Sym}^2 T), \\ \mathcal{A}_{\mathcal{R}}^{[k]} &= \text{Sym}(\mathcal{E}^*)/(\mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{R}} + \mathfrak{a}^{k+1}), \quad Y_{\mathcal{R}}^{[k]} = \text{Spec}_B \mathcal{A}_{\mathcal{R}}^{[k]}, \end{aligned} \quad (15.1)$$

where $\mathfrak{a}$ is the positive-degree ideal. Determinant-line changes of frame multiply local generators by units, so this is an ideal sheaf, independent of all frames. This construction is the pullback of the coefficient construction in Theorem 23.1, with an arbitrary rank- n source bundle. It is not necessary to choose an embedding of B in a socle Grassmannian.

Lemma 15.1 (A varying coefficient line). *The ideal $\mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{R}}$ has no component of degree less than d and is generated by its degree- d component $\mathcal{K}_{\mathcal{R}}$. This component is a subbundle of $\text{Sym}^d \mathcal{E}^*$ of rank M . After cancellation of the determinant line, its degree- $2p$ coefficient module determines $\mathcal{R}$ as a subbundle, once the two tensor factors of $\mathcal{E}$ are supplied. In particular, $Y_{\mathcal{R}}^{[d]} \rightarrow B$ is finite locally free of rank*

$$\binom{n^2 + d}{d} - M.$$

Proof. Put $F(H) = \bigwedge^p \text{Sym}^2 H$ for rank- n vector spaces or bundles H . This is an irreducible polynomial representation by Lemma 12.2; its dimension is M . Write $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}} = \bigwedge^p \mathcal{S}^*$, viewed, by $\bigwedge^p \gamma^*$, as a line subbundle of $F(V)^* \otimes \mathcal{O}_B$. The residual minors are precisely the image of

$$\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}} \otimes F(\mathcal{U}) \longrightarrow \text{Sym}^{2p}(V^* \otimes \mathcal{U}), \quad \beta \otimes \xi \longmapsto [T \mapsto \beta(F(T)\xi)]. \quad (15.2)$$

The full map $F(V)^* \otimes F(U) \rightarrow \text{Sym}^{2p}(V^* \otimes U)$ is the nonzero inclusion of its unique Cauchy summand: evaluation at $T = 1$ is nonzero, as in (12.6). Restricting to a nonzero line on the left therefore has rank M in every fibre. The coefficients vary algebraically. The constant-rank criterion makes the image a subbundle; equivalently one may choose a nonvanishing maximal minor of this coefficient map locally on the Grassmannian of pencils and pull it back to B . Multiplication by the determinant, a nonzero polynomial in every fibre, again has constant rank M .

All defining generators have degree d , proving the assertion about the ideal. For the recovery assertion, the residual image, inside the indicated Cauchy summand, is $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}} \otimes F(\mathcal{U})$. Contraction with $F(\mathcal{U})^*$ has image exactly $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}}$ as a line subbundle of $F(V)^* \otimes \mathcal{O}_B$. This statement is an equality of images of bundle maps, not just equality at closed points. Exterior duality identifies it with the Pluecker line $\bigwedge^2 \mathcal{R}$, up to the fixed determinant line of $\text{Sym}^2 V$. The Grassmannian Pluecker embedding consequently recovers the morphism $B \rightarrow \text{Gr}(2, \text{Sym}^2 V)$, and its pullback of the tautological bundle recovers $\mathcal{R}$. Finally, the truncated algebra is the sum of its free graded pieces below d and the locally free degree- d quotient by $\mathcal{K}_{\mathcal{R}}$. Its rank is the asserted binomial sum minus M . $\square$

15.2. The unmarked inverse.

Theorem 15.2 (Reconstruction of a moving pencil). *Let $(B_i, \mathcal{U}_i, V_i, \mathcal{R}_i)$, $i = 1, 2$, be admissible data of the same rank n . Then*

$$Y_{\mathcal{R}_1}^{[d]} \simeq Y_{\mathcal{R}_2}^{[d]} \quad (15.3)$$

as abstract complex schemes if and only if there exist an isomorphism $\sigma : B_1 \rightarrow B_2$, a constant linear isomorphism $g : V_1 \rightarrow V_2$, and a bundle isomorphism $h : \mathcal{U}_1 \rightarrow \sigma^ \mathcal{U}_2$ such that*

$$\sigma^* \mathcal{R}_2 = (\text{Sym}^2 g) \mathcal{R}_1. \quad (15.4)$$

The reduced base, normal tensor orientation, isomorphism class of the actual source bundle, and the varying pencil are recovered together. Neither the projection onto the base nor the ambient bundle is supplied in (15.3). The constant left map cannot be replaced by a separately chosen change of coordinates in each fibre. A pair (g, h) defining the same normal-bundle map is unique up to simultaneous multiplication by a nonzero constant.

Proof. Let $\mathfrak{n}_i$ be the nilradical of $\mathcal{O}_{Y_{\mathcal{R}_i}}^{[d]}$. Since the positive-degree ideal is nilpotent and B_i is reduced, the reduction is exactly B_i , and this ideal is exactly $\mathfrak{n}_i$. There are no relations below degree d , so multiplication intrinsically recovers

$$\mathcal{E}_i^* = \mathfrak{n}_i / \mathfrak{n}_i^2, \quad \mathcal{K}_i = \ker \left[\text{Sym}^d(\mathfrak{n}_i / \mathfrak{n}_i^2) \longrightarrow \mathfrak{n}_i^d \right]. \quad (15.5)$$

The map is well defined since $\mathfrak{n}_i^{d+1} = 0$. An abstract isomorphism gives σ , an isomorphism of these normal bundles, and the matching relation subbundles. In particular it gives an isomorphism of the untruncated homogeneous cones

$$\text{Spec}_{B_i}(\text{Sym } \mathcal{E}_i^* / (\mathcal{K}_i)).$$

This cone is reconstructed from the first relation module; it is not the associated graded algebra of the finite scheme, whose degrees above d vanish.

The reduction of this cone is the determinant cone. Indeed the residual quadratic map is surjective wherever T is invertible, whereas the determinant factor annihilates the ideal wherever T is singular. On a frame chart the determinant hypersurface is reduced over the smooth base, so the radical ideal is precisely the determinant ideal. Successive relative reduced singular loci give the lower matrix-rank cones. The rank-one cone has the two ruling parameter schemes

$$\mathbb{P}(V_i) \times B_i, \quad \mathbb{P}_{B_i}(\mathcal{U}_i^*),$$

by Lemma 3.1. Only the first is projectively trivial. Thus an isomorphism cannot interchange them. The induced map on the trivial ruling is a morphism $B_1 \rightarrow \text{Isom}(\mathbb{P}(V_1), \mathbb{P}(V_2))$. After choosing one identification this target is the affine variety PGL_n . Since B_1 is connected and projective, every such morphism is constant. Choose one constant linear lift g .

We check that no line-bundle ambiguity remains in the other factor. Locally trivialize both source bundles. The linear rank-one preserver with its left projective map fixed to $[g]$ is of the form

$$T \longmapsto gTh^{-1} \quad (15.6)$$

by Lemma 3.2. Once this particular g is fixed, the local linear map h is unique: if two right maps give the same value for every T , they are equal. The local maps therefore agree on overlaps and glue to an actual bundle isomorphism $\mathcal{U}_1 \rightarrow \sigma^* \mathcal{U}_2$. Alternatively, after removing g the normal-bundle map commutes with $\text{End}(V_1)$; the commutant is the right-factor homomorphism bundle. Rescaling the constant lift g rescales h by the same constant. This proves both existence and the asserted uniqueness for a given normal-bundle map.

Cancel the intrinsic determinant ideal in the recovered homogeneous ideal. On a frame chart the determinant polynomial is a non-zero-divisor and $((\det T)\mathcal{J} : (\det T)) = \mathcal{J}$; the identities glue without selecting a global determinant generator. Apply Lemma 15.1 to the degree- $2p$ part. The right map h acts on the full factor $F(\mathcal{U})$, so contraction against its dual removes that change of frame. The remaining line subbundle transforms by the one constant left map g . Exterior duality yields exactly (15.4). This uses the subbundle version proved above, not the constant-coefficient hypothesis in Theorem 11.1.

Conversely σ, g, h satisfying (15.4) identify the quotient bundles $\mathcal{S}_i$, the quadratic maps, and their maximal-minor ideals. The determinant changes by a unit in local frames. The map (15.6) consequently identifies both the homogeneous ideals and every truncation, proving (15.3). $\square$

Corollary 15.3 (Uniform sharpness over an admissible base). *For fixed $B, \mathcal{U}, V$, all schemes $Y_{\mathcal{R}}^{[k]}$ with $k < d$ are independent of $\mathcal{R}$. Order d is the smallest uniform order at which the moving pencil is recoverable in the sense of Theorem 15.2.*

Proof. Below d the ideal $\mathcal{I}_{\mathcal{R}}$ contributes no relations, and the algebra is $\bigoplus_{j=0}^k \text{Sym}^j \mathcal{E}^*$. Constant pencils are among the admissible subbundles. The pencils $\langle x_1^2, x_1 x_2 \rangle$ and $\langle x_1^2, x_2^2 \rangle$ are inequivalent: all members of the first have a common linear factor and those of the second do not. A base automorphism does not change either constant pencil. The theorem separates their order- d schemes, whereas every lower truncation agrees. This proves uniform, not pairwise, minimality. $\square$

15.3. The part of an isomorphism that the inverse does not record. The recovered data classify isomorphism classes, but an isomorphism of finite schemes need not itself be linear in the nilpotent directions. The following statement identifies this distinction without replacing it by a claim about moduli stacks.

Fix an admissible datum, put $Y = Y_{\mathcal{R}}^{[d]}$, and let $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}}$ be the group of triples (σ, g, h) satisfying (15.4), modulo $(g, h) \sim (cg, ch)$ for $c \in \mathbb{C}^*$. Its group law is composition of their induced normal-bundle maps. Write $\text{Aut}_{\mathbb{C}}(Y)$ for the group of complex scheme automorphisms. For $j \geq 1$, define G_j to consist of the automorphisms inducing the identity on the reduction and satisfying

$$(\alpha^* - 1)(\mathfrak{n}^k) \subseteq \mathfrak{n}^{k+j} \quad \text{for every } k \geq 0, \quad \mathfrak{n}^0 = \mathcal{O}_Y. \quad (15.7)$$

They act on sheaves on the same underlying topological space.

Theorem 15.4 (Linear data and the nilpotent kernel). *There is an exact sequence of groups*

$$1 \longrightarrow G_1 \longrightarrow \text{Aut}_{\mathbb{C}}(Y) \longrightarrow \mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}} \longrightarrow 1. \quad (15.8)$$

The displayed homogeneous presentation of Y supplies a splitting. Moreover $G_{d+1} = 1$, $[G_i, G_j] \subseteq G_{i+j}$, and there are natural injections

$$G_j/G_{j+1} \hookrightarrow H^0(B, \text{Der}_{\mathbb{C}}(\text{gr}_{\mathfrak{n}} \mathcal{O}_Y)_j) \quad (15.9)$$

into additive groups of degree- j derivations. Thus the kernel is nilpotent and records precisely the automorphisms invisible on the associated graded scheme. No surjectivity onto the derivation spaces is asserted.

Proof. An automorphism induces a base map and a degree-one bundle map. The proof of Theorem 15.2 identifies these with a unique class of triples in $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}}$. The graded algebra is generated in degree one over degree zero, with relation subbundle $\mathcal{K}_{\mathcal{R}}$. Hence its entire graded automorphism is already determined by that triple. The kernel is the identity on every graded piece, which is exactly condition (15.7) for $j = 1$. Conversely the homogeneous maps $T \mapsto gTh^{-1}$ give actual automorphisms of Y , respect composition, and induce the prescribed triples. This proves exactness and the splitting. A choice of the homogeneous presentation supplies that section; the assertion does not endow an arbitrary unmarked presentation with a preferred section.

For $\alpha \in G_j$, put $D_{\alpha} = \alpha^* - 1$. It raises filtration by j , and is therefore nilpotent as an additive operator. The inverse of $1 + D_{\alpha}$ is the finite geometric series. Composition of filtration-raising operators shows that a commutator of elements of G_i, G_j raises filtration by at least $i + j$. Also $G_{d+1} = 1$ follows by taking $k = 0$, since $\mathfrak{n}^{d+1} = 0$.

The leading term of D_{α} defines maps $\mathfrak{n}^k/\mathfrak{n}^{k+1} \rightarrow \mathfrak{n}^{k+j}/\mathfrak{n}^{k+j+1}$. They are independent of lifts. The identity

$$D_{\alpha}(ab) = aD_{\alpha}(b) + D_{\alpha}(a)b + D_{\alpha}(a)D_{\alpha}(b)$$

reduces to the Leibniz identity in the indicated graded degree, since $2j \geq j + 1$. Thus the leading term is a sheaf derivation over $\mathbb{C}$, including its action on degree zero; it need not be an $\mathcal{O}_B$ -linear derivation. Leading terms add under composition, and their kernel is exactly G_{j+1} . They glue globally, proving (15.9) and all assertions. $\square$

Example 15.5 (A nontrivial invisible automorphism). Let $B = \mathbb{P}^1$ and $\mathcal{U} = \mathcal{O}(-1) \oplus \mathcal{O}^{n-1}$. The bundle $\mathcal{E}^* = V^* \otimes \mathcal{U}$ has at least two trivial direct summands. Choose their degree-one generators x, y . The substitution

$$x \mapsto x + y^2$$

fixing y , the other summands and $\mathcal{O}_B$, defines a nonidentity automorphism of $Y_{\mathcal{R}}^{[d]}$ in G_1 , for every admissible $\mathcal{R}$. Indeed each relation has degree d ; its change under this substitution has degree at least $d + 1$ and vanishes in the truncation. The inverse is $x \mapsto x - y^2$. The automorphism is nonidentity because there are no degree-two relations. Therefore identifying all finite-scheme automorphisms with the stabilizer of the pencil would be false, even in this simple case. The inverse theorem and the exact sequence retain, rather than suppress, this higher-order freedom.

15.4. A nonconstant family across spectral collisions.

Example 15.6. Take $n = 4$, $B = \mathbb{P}_{[s:t]}^1$, $\mathcal{U} = \mathcal{O}(-1) \oplus \mathcal{O}^3$, and $V = \mathbb{C}^4$. In diagonal quadratic coordinates set

$$A = \text{diag}(1, 1, 1, 1), \quad B_{s,t} = \text{diag}(0, s, t, 2s + 3t).$$

The map $\mathcal{O} \oplus \mathcal{O}(-1) \rightarrow \text{Sym}^2 V \otimes \mathcal{O}$ with columns $A, B_{s,t}$ has rank two everywhere. The first diagonal entry shows that any scalar relation involving A has zero coefficient on A ; the next two entries then force $s = t = 0$, which is impossible on $\mathbb{P}^1$. Its image $\mathcal{R}$ is therefore a locally direct-summand pencil bundle. Since it contains the nondegenerate form A , it is regular at every point, including all spectral collisions.

On the open set of four distinct eigenvalues, an ordered cross-ratio of $0, s, t, 2s + 3t$ is

$$\chi = \frac{t(s + 3t)}{(2s + 3t)(t - s)}.$$

The rational function $J = (\chi^2 - \chi + 1)^3 / (\chi^2(1 - \chi)^2)$ is invariant under the six cross-ratio transformations arising from permutations of four points. It is nonconstant: at $[s : t] = [1 : 2]$ and $[1 : 3]$, the values of χ are $7/4$ and $15/11$, and the corresponding values of J differ. Thus the pencil family is not projectively isotrivial, even allowing a change of parameter within each pencil. The discriminant of $\det(zA - B_{s,t})$ is

$$4s^2t^2(2s + 3t)^2(s - t)^2(s + 3t)^2(s + t)^2. \quad (15.10)$$

No factor is inverted in forming $Y_{\mathcal{R}}^{[20]}$. This finite scheme is locally free over its entire projective reduction of rank $\binom{36}{20} - 45$. By Theorem 15.2, its unmarked isomorphism class recovers the whole morphism into the pencil Grassmannian, including the six collision points and the pencil there, up to one constant transformation of V and an automorphism of the base. This is a consequence about a genuinely moving family, not just the pointwise Pluecker encoding. The cross-ratio and discriminant calculations are classical elementary readouts; their role here is to exhibit a family to which the unmarked global inverse applies.

Remark 15.7 (Scope of the family statement). The reduction in this section is smooth, projective and reduced. The source projective bundle is assumed nontrivial, which orients the two rulings. The theorem allows all fibre pencils, singular or regular; regularity is used only in the spectral description of the last example. Theorem 23.1 separately allows arbitrary complex base change with its specified relative socle ideal. The present intrinsic inverse does not replace that ideal by an absolute nilradical over a nonreduced base. Nor does (15.8) assert an equivalence of unmarked moduli stacks or a description of every infinitesimal deformation. It is an exact classification of geometric isomorphisms, their graded data, and the residual automorphism kernel for the stated admissible objects.

16. COEFFICIENT-SUPPORT ORIENTATION AND A LOCAL ALGEBRAIC INVERSE

For pencils there is a second, entirely local way to distinguish the two tensor rulings. It uses the asymmetry of the residual coefficient module rather than the topology of a projective bundle. Consequently the nontrivial-projectivization hypothesis in the preceding family theorem can be removed, and a single unmarked Artin local algebra already recovers the pencil.

16.1. The coefficient module orients its own tensor factors. If $K \subset A \otimes B$ is a linear subspace, define its two factor supports by

$$s_A(K) = \text{im}(K \otimes B^* \longrightarrow A), \quad s_B(K) = \text{im}(K \otimes A^* \longrightarrow B).$$

The maps here are contractions. Their ranks are invariant under separate changes of basis and are exchanged by interchanging the factors. In particular, if $K = L \otimes B$, then $s_A(K) = L$ and $s_B(K) = B$. The support ranks are therefore $(\dim L, \dim B)$, not the common dimension $\dim K$.

Lemma 16.1 (Asymmetric coefficient support). *Suppose a homogeneous ideal in the matrix space $\text{Hom}(U, V)$, with $\dim U = \dim V = n \geq 3$, has reduced support the determinant cone. Suppose its intrinsic residual ideal after determinant cancellation has, in one multiplicity-one Cauchy summand of degree q , the coefficient subspace*

$$L \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda U \subset \mathbb{S}_\lambda V^* \otimes \mathbb{S}_\lambda U, \quad 0 < \dim L < \dim \mathbb{S}_\lambda U.$$

A linear isomorphism carrying this ideal to another ideal with a coefficient subspace of the same displayed type cannot interchange the two matrix rulings. The conclusion is unchanged by line twists of the locally chosen tensor factors. It also applies fibrewise to subbundles of this type over a reduced base.

Proof. A linear isomorphism of determinant cones preserves their successive rank loci and therefore the rank-one cone. Its action on the two ruling components either preserves them or interchanges them. To make the familiar two alternatives explicit, identify the rank-one projectivization with $\mathbb{P}(V) \times \mathbb{P}(U^*)$. An automorphism preserving its two families of maximal linear spaces acts separately on the two projective factors. Each factor map is projective linear, by restricting the ambient linear map to a ruling. Removing their linear lifts leaves a map fixing every decomposable line; sums of tensors with one factor in common show that this remaining map is scalar. The preserving alternative is thus a left-right matrix map. In the interchanging alternative, compose with transposition to obtain the preserving alternative.

The determinant ideal is carried to the determinant ideal, so its ideal quotient is carried to the residual ideal. The Cauchy decomposition is functorial for separate changes of matrix factors; transposition exchanges the factors in its λ -summand. Put $m = \dim \mathbb{S}_\lambda U$, and $r = \dim L < m$. The displayed subspace has support ranks (r, m) . Separate factor maps preserve these ranks, while transposition changes them to (m, r) . An ideal of the prescribed type on the other side has support ranks (r', m) with $r' < m$. It cannot be the transposed image. This excludes interchanging the rulings.

Tensoring a factor by a line changes its Schur module by a line power, not its contraction rank. The argument therefore does not require a specified linear lift of either projective factor. For bundle maps it applies to each geometric fibre; an interchange on any fibre would contradict the same strict rank inequality there. $\square$

For pencils, take $F(H) = \bigwedge^{N-2} \text{Sym}^2 H$. Lemma 12.2 makes this a single irreducible Schur module, of dimension $M = \binom{N}{2} > 1$. The residual module is precisely $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}} \otimes F(U)$, by Lemma 15.1. Its support ranks are $(1, M)$. The relevant strict inequality holds for every pencil, including singular pencils; it is not a generic-rank condition.

Theorem 16.2 (Removal of the projective-bundle restriction). *In Theorem 15.2, the hypothesis that $\mathbb{P}_B(\mathcal{U}^*)$ is nontrivial can be omitted. The coefficient-subbundle reconstruction, the smallest uniform order, and the automorphism exact sequence remain valid for every rank- n source bundle on a smooth connected projective complex base. In particular the base is allowed to be a point.*

Proof. The first-relation construction, the recovered homogeneous cone, and cancellation of the determinant use neither projective nontriviality nor positive dimension of the base. They recover both the unordered rulings and the residual coefficient module before a ruling is chosen. At this stage apply Lemma 16.1 with support ranks $(1, M)$. It excludes the transposed alternative and hence orients the left ruling even when both ruling bundles are trivial. This replaces exactly the nontrivial-projectivization step in the proof of Theorem 15.2.

The left ruling is the trivial bundle $\mathbb{P}(V) \times B$. Projectivity and connectedness still make its projective-matrix map constant. Choose its constant linear lift; uniqueness of the right bundle map on overlaps gives the same actual isomorphism h , and coefficient contraction recovers the entire pencil subbundle. The converse uses the same homogeneous map. The lower-order algebras and the two inequivalent constant pencils in Corollary 15.3 are unchanged. Finally, the proof of Theorem 15.4 uses only the resulting classification of graded data, not the earlier way of orienting the rulings, so it too applies without the restriction. $\square$

16.2. Every pencil from one Artin local algebra. Choose n -dimensional vector spaces U, V . Let $T = (t_{ij})$ be the universal matrix, and put $\mathfrak{m} = (t_{ij})$. For a pencil $R \subset \text{Sym}^2 V$, let γ_R be its quotient map and set

$$\mathfrak{A}_R^{[k]} = \mathbb{C}[t_{ij}] / ((\det T)I_p(\gamma_R \text{Sym}^2 T) + \mathfrak{m}^{k+1}). \quad (16.1)$$

An isomorphism below means an isomorphism of complex algebras, without a grading, tangent coordinates, matrix decomposition or chosen generators.

Theorem 16.3 (Unmarked local reconstruction). *For every $n \geq 3$ and every pair of quadratic pencils,*

$$\mathfrak{A}_R^{[d]} \simeq \mathfrak{A}_{R'}^{[d]} \iff R' = (\text{Sym}^2 g)R \text{ for some } g \in \text{GL}(V). \quad (16.2)$$

The algebra has embedding dimension n^2 and length $\binom{n^2+d}{d} - \binom{N}{2}$. Every lower-order algebra $\mathfrak{A}_R^{[k]}$, $k < d$, is independent of R . Thus $d = n^2 + 2n - 4$ is the smallest uniform reconstruction order already among these single-point objects.

Proof. Theorem 16.2 applies with $B = \text{Spec } \mathbb{C}$ and the bundle U . To spell out what its intrinsic construction uses in this case, the unique maximal ideal $\mathfrak{n}$ of the finite algebra determines its tangent space and the multiplication kernel

$$K_R = \ker \left[\text{Sym}^d(\mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2) \longrightarrow \mathfrak{n}^d \right].$$

This is precisely the degree- d ideal in the chosen presentation; nonlinear changes of generators contribute only terms above degree d to a degree- d relation. Hence an ungraded algebra isomorphism identifies the homogeneous cones generated by these kernels. Their determinant reductions recover the unordered matrix factors. The residual support ranks $(1, M)$ rule out transposition, and the remaining left-right map carries the left coefficient line to the left coefficient line. Exterior duality then gives $R' = (\text{Sym}^2 g)R$. Conversely such a map, together with any chosen right identification, induces the algebra isomorphism. There are no relations below degree d , so the embedding dimension and the lower-order assertion are immediate. The relation subspace at degree d has dimension M , giving the asserted length. The inequivalent common-factor and no-common-factor pencils prove uniform minimality as before. $\square$

In particular the earlier Schubert-line construction is a sufficient geometric realization, not a lower bound on the dimension of a supporting reduced scheme. The local inverse just proved retains no curve at all. Its additional ingredient is the coefficient-support asymmetry, which was not used in the earlier geometric orientation argument. This is a stronger inverse statement, not a conclusion from knowing the discriminant or the reduced determinant cone.

16.3. The local automorphism kernel is explicit. Put $a = n^2$, $\ell = \text{length } \mathfrak{A}_R^{[d]}$, and $G_R = \{g \in \text{GL}(V) : (\text{Sym}^2 g)R = R\}$. The symbol $\mathfrak{n}^2$ in the next statement is the square of the maximal ideal of the finite algebra.

Proposition 16.4 (Tangent-identity automorphisms). *There is a split exact sequence of complex automorphism groups*

$$1 \longrightarrow U_R \longrightarrow \text{Aut}_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathfrak{A}_R^{[d]}) \longrightarrow (G_R \times \text{GL}(U))/\mathbb{C}^* \longrightarrow 1, \quad (16.3)$$

where the scalar subgroup is diagonal. The kernel U_R is a unipotent algebraic group whose underlying variety is an affine space of dimension

$$a(\ell - 1 - a).$$

More explicitly, after choosing the a degree-one generators $x_1, \dots, x_a$, its elements are exactly the substitutions $x_i \mapsto x_i + u_i$ with arbitrary $u_i \in \mathfrak{n}^2$. The affine-space parametrization is not an assertion that this group law is additive.

Proof. The local inverse and the support-rank argument identify the linear stabilizer of K_R with the indicated left-right quotient; transposition is absent. These linear maps lift homogeneously, giving the quotient and splitting. An automorphism in the kernel is the identity on $\mathfrak{n}/\mathfrak{n}^2$, and consequently has exactly the displayed generator images.

Conversely choose arbitrary $u_i \in \mathfrak{n}^2$. Under this substitution a homogeneous defining relation of degree d changes only by terms in $\mathfrak{n}^{d+1} = 0$, so all defining relations are respected. The induced map is the identity on the associated graded algebra, hence is invertible as a finite filtered linear map and therefore as an algebra map. There are no further conditions on the u_i . Reading the generator images and performing substitutions are polynomial mutually inverse maps between the kernel and the vector space $(\mathfrak{n}^2)^{\oplus a}$. Since $\dim \mathfrak{n}^2 = \ell - 1 - a$, this proves the variety and dimension assertions. On a basis ordered by degree every such automorphism is upper unitriangular; the algebraic group is therefore unipotent. Its law includes higher substitution terms, which accounts for its generally noncommutative structure. $\square$

The positive-dimensional family statement remains useful after the local inverse: it recovers an entire varying subbundle and the actual source bundle up to one global left transformation, whereas separate fibrewise local isomorphisms need not glue. The geometric automorphism statements here still do not identify unmarked moduli stacks or all deformations over nonreduced parameter bases.

17. THE EFFECTIVE MODULI STACK OF PENCIL FAILURE ALGEBRAS

We apply the common-divisor inverse to the actual first relations of quadratic pencils. Their common divisor has a higher multiplicity than the single determinant factor used to recover their support. Removing that multiplicity places every pencil, without a regularity hypothesis, in the smooth stratum of the preceding section.

Keep $W = \text{Sym}^2 V$, $N = \binom{n+1}{2}$, $p = N - 2$, and put

$$\begin{aligned} M &= \binom{N}{2}, & s &= n - 1, & h &= 3n - 4, \\ \mu &= (\underbrace{3, \dots, 3}_{n-2}, 2, 0), & A &= \mathbb{S}_\mu V^*, & F &= \mathbb{S}_\mu U. \end{aligned} \quad (17.1)$$

Both A and F have dimension M . The Cauchy inclusion $A \otimes F \subset S_h(E)$ will be fixed; its subspace and all its projections are equivariant, independent of a choice of bases.

Lemma 17.1 (Exact common multiplicity). *For every $R \in \text{Gr}(2, W)$, including every singular pencil, the first relation space of its order- d failure algebra is*

$$K_R = \delta^{n-1} \tilde{J}_R, \quad \tilde{J}_R = L_R^0 \otimes F \subset S_h(E), \quad \gcd(\tilde{J}_R) = 1. \quad (17.2)$$

Here $L_R^0 \subset A$ is the Pluecker line of R , under the canonical projective identification $\mathbb{P}(A) = \mathbb{P}(\wedge^2 W)$. The common divisor of K_R is therefore exactly δ^{n-1} , up to scalar. Its degree remains $d = sn + h = n^2 + 2n - 4$.

Proof. Exterior duality and $\wedge^2 \text{Sym}^2 H = \mathbb{S}_{(3,1)} H$ give

$$\bigwedge_{N-2} \text{Sym}^2 H = \mathbb{S}_\lambda H, \quad \lambda = (\underbrace{n+1, \dots, n+1}_{n-2}, n, n-2) = \mu + (n-2)^n.$$

Thus this representation is $(\det H)^{n-2} \otimes \mathbb{S}_\mu H$. Applied to the universal matrix, its coefficient polynomials factor as δ^{n-2} times the matrix coefficients of $\mathbb{S}_\mu T$. The additional determinant in the failure ideal gives (17.2). On the left, exterior duality also yields

$$A \simeq \bigwedge^2 W \otimes (\det V)^{-3},$$

which identifies the residual line with the Pluecker line.

We prove a slightly stronger assertion: the matrix coefficient space $\beta \otimes \mathbb{S}_\mu U$ has greatest common divisor 1 for every nonzero $\beta \in \mathbb{S}_\mu V^*$. Its common divisor is taken to a scalar multiple of itself by the full right group. Its zero divisor is therefore invariant under right multiplication. A nonconstant invariant divisor cannot meet the open orbit of invertible matrices. Since the complement of that orbit is the irreducible determinant hypersurface, any such common divisor is a power of δ .

It remains to exclude δ . Choose a rank- $n-1$ map T_0 . The representation $\mathbb{S}_\mu$ has length $n-1$, so $\mathbb{S}_\mu T_0 \neq 0$. Choose a nonzero vector in its image. The span of its left $\text{GL}(V)$ -orbit is the entire irreducible representation. Consequently some left translate gT_0 has a coefficient not annihilated by β . Not all residual coefficients vanish on the rank- $n-1$ locus. They have no determinant factor, proving the assertion. The same argument at an invertible matrix shows that the coefficient vector is nonzero everywhere on the invertible locus. $\square$

Let $\mathcal{P} = \text{Gr}(2, W)$. The morphism

$$\iota : \mathcal{P} \longrightarrow X_{h,M}(E), \quad R \longmapsto L_R^0 \otimes F \quad (17.3)$$

is a closed immersion. Indeed, the Pluecker embedding is followed by the closed immersion $\mathbb{P}(A) \rightarrow \text{Gr}(M, A \otimes F)$, $L \mapsto L \otimes F$, and then by a linear Grassmannian inclusion. The inverse to the middle map is contraction with F^* . This factorization proves the assertion on schemes, including nonreduced test schemes, rather than only on points. Lemma 17.1 shows that its image lies in the open set $X_{h,M}(E)$.

Define the *pencil relation stratum* Z_{pen} inside $Z_{n-1,3n-4,M}^{\det}$ by the following intrinsic scheme conditions. Recover the common-divisor line, its determinant root, and its unordered tensor rulings by Theorem 6.3. In an ordering, the primitive residual relation is required to lie in the indicated Cauchy summand, to have the form $L \otimes F$, and to satisfy the Pluecker equations on L under $A \simeq \bigwedge^2 W \otimes (\det V)^{-3}$. These are equations on subbundles; a test on the fibres alone is not their definition. Use both orderings and descend. The two ordered images are disjoint: their support ranks are respectively $(1, M)$ and $(M, 1)$, with $M > 1$. Each is closed in the residual Grassmannian. Thus this prescription defines a locally closed scheme, independent of the tensor frames. It is an intrinsic image criterion for a natural family of first relations, not a definition by an algebra isomorphism to a preselected pencil.

Theorem 17.2 (Effective all-pencil moduli and deformations). *The stack of first relations in Z_{pen} is*

$$[Z_{\text{pen}}/\text{GL}(E)] \simeq [\mathcal{P}/G^\circ]. \quad (17.4)$$

There is an exact sequence of groups

$$1 \longrightarrow \text{GL}(U) \longrightarrow G^\circ \longrightarrow \text{PGL}(V) \longrightarrow 1, \quad (17.5)$$

and its kernel acts trivially on $\mathcal{P}$. Quotient the morphisms in the algebra stack first by the nonlinear tangent-identity kernel of Proposition 6.4, and then by this ineffective right group, and fppf stackify. The resulting effective pencil failure stack satisfies

$$\mathcal{F}_{\text{pen}}^{\text{eff}} \simeq [\text{Gr}(2, \text{Sym}^2 V)/\text{PGL}(V)]. \quad (17.6)$$

This equivalence is valid over all complex parameter schemes. It identifies automorphisms after the specified quotients, infinitesimal deformation groupoids, and families of degenerating pencils, including singular pencils.

The stack is smooth of dimension $n - 3$. At R , its tangent complex is

$$[\mathfrak{pgl}(V) \xrightarrow{d_R} \text{Hom}(R, W/R)], \quad d_R(X)(r) = (X \otimes 1 + 1 \otimes X)r \bmod R. \quad (17.7)$$

In particular, the dimension of its space of first-order isomorphism classes is $n - 3 + \dim \text{Stab}_{\text{PGL}(V)}(R)$. Within this stratum, every infinitesimal pencil deformation and its effective failure-algebra deformation lift together across a small extension of local Artinian complex algebras.

Proof. In the determinant frame of Theorem 6.3, the residual pencil locus is $\iota(\mathcal{P}) \amalg \tau\iota(\mathcal{P})$, where τ exchanges the two factors. The disjointness just proved and the equivariance of the Cauchy and Pluecker maps give, as schemes with group action,

$$\iota(\mathcal{P}) \amalg \tau\iota(\mathcal{P}) \simeq G \times^{G^\circ} \mathcal{P}.$$

Quotienting by G gives (17.4). All maps used here are morphisms and all inverse operations are contractions, common-divisor descent, or the inverse on the Pluecker image. Consequently this calculation remains valid on a nonreduced base. It is not an inference from equality of complex-point stabilizers.

The map in (17.5) sends the class of (g, h) to $[g]$. If $g = aI$, multiplication by the diagonal scalar a^{-1} writes its class uniquely as $(I, a^{-1}h)$. This proves the asserted kernel. The action on the Pluecker line is the projective action of g ; the full right factor has no effect on R . Every $\text{PGL}(V)$ -valued isomorphism lifts fppf locally to G° , and two lifts differ by that kernel. The quotient of morphisms and stackification therefore gives $[\mathcal{P}/\text{PGL}(V)]$. Combining this with Proposition 6.4 proves (17.6). No splitting of (17.5) over the base is required.

A Grassmannian chart writes a nearby pencil as the graph of a map $R \rightarrow W/R$. Infinitesimal coordinate changes act by d_R , giving (17.7). Grassmannian charts and $\text{PGL}(V)$ are smooth, so the quotient is smooth and the graph coefficients lift over every small extension. A coordinate

change can also be lifted in the smooth group, and its action determines a compatible lift of the corresponding object. Torsors over a local Artinian complex algebra can be trivialized, since smooth torsors lift a point of their algebraically closed residue field. This proves the lifting assertion for deformation groupoids. Finally,

$$\dim \mathcal{P} - \dim \mathrm{PGL}(V) = 2(N - 2) - (n^2 - 1) = n - 3.$$

Taking kernel and cokernel of d_R gives the stated first-order dimension, including stabilizer jumps at singular pencils. $\square$

Corollary 17.3 (Native specialization loci). *Every $\mathrm{PGL}(V)$ -invariant locally closed subscheme $Q \subset \mathrm{Gr}(2, \mathrm{Sym}^2 V)$, with its specified scheme structure, has a corresponding intrinsic effective failure stratum isomorphic to $[Q/\mathrm{PGL}(V)]$. Its infinitesimal equations and its specializations are retained, not just its closed points. In particular, this applies to rank-incidence and spectral Fitting conditions on the universal pencil, including their intersections. A family in such a locus specializes to a pencil in its closure exactly when its effective failure family has the corresponding specialization in the associated closure stratum.*

Proof. Restrict the equivariant closed immersion (17.3) and its inverse to Q . The construction of Z_{pen} and its two quotient steps then restrict to give the stated isomorphism. Equations for a rank or a Fitting condition are equivariant equations in the universal pencil, so they are included in this argument with their scheme structures. Apply the same construction to the closure of Q to obtain the specialization assertion. $\square$

Remark 17.4. Theorem 17.2 does not say that the unrigidified algebra stack is the pencil stack. At a complex pencil its linear stabilizer remains $(G_R \times \mathrm{GL}(U))/\mathbb{G}_m$, and its full algebra automorphism group also has the nonlinear kernel in Proposition 2.2. Both are real automorphisms, not redundant notation. They are explicitly removed only in the effective comparison. Nor is the quotient asserted to be proper, although its framed Grassmannian is projective.

The parameter base in this theorem is distinct from the intrinsic projective reduction in Theorem 16.2. Here projective coordinate changes may vary over the parameter scheme. In that moving theorem, properness of the intrinsic reduction forces one constant left map and recovers an actual source bundle. Neither assertion is substituted for the other. The present equivalence upgrades the geometric orbit statement to a family statement without changing the hypotheses or conclusions of the moving inverse.

18. UNIVERSAL PROPERTIES OF THE TWO RIGIDIFICATIONS

The effective stacks used above have a universal characterization. This specifies what is forgotten from isomorphisms, as opposed to what is retained from objects. We use rigidification in its standard sense of removing a flat normal subgroup of inertia; see [18, Tag 04V2]. The argument below gives the universal property directly in the present situation, including the nonconstant subgroup obtained by descent.

Let $H_0 \subset \mathrm{Gr}(r, S_D(E))$ be a $\mathrm{GL}(E)$ -invariant locally closed subscheme. Let $\mathcal{A}_{H_0}$ be the stack of algebras satisfying the trace, filtration and Hilbert-function conditions of Proposition 6.4, whose intrinsic kernel is in H_0 . Write $\mathcal{R}_{H_0} = [H_0/\mathrm{GL}(E)]$.

Theorem 18.1 (First-relation rigidification). *Taking the first relation defines an fppf gerbe*

$$q : \mathcal{A}_{H_0} \longrightarrow \mathcal{R}_{H_0}.$$

Its relative inertia $\mathcal{U}$ consists exactly of the substitutions which induce the identity on $\mathcal{N}/\mathcal{N}^2$. It is a smooth affine normal subgroup of the inertia. In a homogeneous presentation its underlying

scheme is $\mathrm{Hom}(\mathcal{E}, \mathcal{N}^2)$, with the substitution group law. For every stack $\mathcal{Z}$ in groupoids on complex schemes, precomposition with q identifies

$$\mathrm{Hom}(\mathcal{R}_{H_0}, \mathcal{Z}) \simeq \{F \in \mathrm{Hom}(\mathcal{A}_{H_0}, \mathcal{Z}) : F(\mathcal{U}) = 1\}. \quad (18.1)$$

The right side is the full subgroupoid, including all natural isomorphisms, of functors killing the indicated relative inertia. The construction is compatible with base change on the relation stack.

Proof. A relation bundle has its homogeneous truncated algebra as a lift. Every algebra over that relation bundle is locally isomorphic to this lift. The first-relation proposition shows that an isomorphism of relation bundles lifts fppf locally, and any two lifts differ by a unique element of the indicated kernel. These assertions are exactly the gerbe and relative-inertia assertions. The kernel is intrinsic, so it is stable under conjugation. Its local affine-space description shows smoothness and flatness; no additive group law is being asserted.

For clarity, we prove the descent implicit in (18.1). Given F on the right and an object y of $\mathcal{R}_{H_0}$, choose local lifts a_i over an fppf cover. Locally choose comparison isomorphisms on overlaps above the identity of y . Two choices differ by $\mathcal{U}$, hence have the same image under F . On triple overlaps the failure of the chosen lifts to satisfy the cocycle condition is again in $\mathcal{U}$. Their images therefore give a genuine descent datum for $F(a_i)$, which is effective because $\mathcal{Z}$ is a stack. Refinements and different lift choices give canonically isomorphic descended objects. An arrow between two objects of $\mathcal{R}_{H_0}$ is treated in the same way, using local lifts of that arrow. This constructs the descended functor. Natural isomorphisms descend by the same argument, proving full faithfulness as well as essential surjectivity. Conversely every functor pulled back by q kills its relative inertia. All the constructions use covers and isomorphism sheaves, so commute with base change. $\square$

Corollary 18.2 (The effective pencil stack is a successive rigidification). *On the pencil relation stratum the second morphism*

$$[\mathcal{P}/G^\circ] \longrightarrow [\mathcal{P}/\mathrm{PGL}(V)], \quad \mathcal{P} = \mathrm{Gr}(2, \mathrm{Sym}^2 V),$$

is the rigidification by the normal relative inertia induced from $\ker(G^\circ \rightarrow \mathrm{PGL}(V)) = \mathrm{GL}(U)$. Consequently Theorem 17.2 has the universal property of first killing $\mathcal{U}$ and then this right-factor inertia. It does not kill the stabilizer of the pencil in $\mathrm{PGL}(V)$.

Proof. The right factor acts trivially on $\mathcal{P}$, and the quotient map of groups is fppf surjective. Objects and isomorphisms of the second quotient therefore lift locally to the first, with differences in that kernel. Apply the descent proof of Theorem 18.1. Over an object represented by a G° -torsor the subgroup is its conjugation-associated $\mathrm{GL}(U)$ -bundle; it need not be a constant group scheme on the base. This describes the actual subgroup stack and shows that no global splitting is assumed. Composing with the first rigidification gives the asserted successive universal property. All remaining pencil automorphisms survive in the target. $\square$

19. A COMMON CLOSED SPECIALIZATION OF ALL QUADRATIC PENCILS

We give an orbit-closure consequence directly on the pencil side. Unlike restricting an equivalence to a previously specified locus, the following argument constructs the specialization. It works for every pencil, including pencils with singular generic member. Its mechanism is elementary projective representation theory; the additional failure algebra statement uses the all-pencil, exact-multiplicity construction.

Theorem 19.1 (Explicit common closed orbit). *Let $\dim V = n \geq 3$. The action of $\mathrm{PGL}(V)$ on $\mathcal{P} = \mathrm{Gr}(2, \mathrm{Sym}^2 V)$ has a unique closed orbit, namely*

$$\mathcal{C} = \{\ell H : \ell \subset H \subset V, \dim \ell = 1, \dim H = 2\}. \quad (19.1)$$

It is the flag variety $\mathrm{Fl}(1, 2; V)$, of dimension $2n - 3$. More precisely, after a fixed change of coordinates every pencil has a degeneration along the one-parameter subgroup

$$\lambda(t) = \mathrm{diag}(1, t, t^2, \dots, t^2)$$

to $\langle x_1^2, x_1x_2 \rangle$. The pencil family is a subbundle on the whole affine line.

Proof. Take independent forms q_0, q_1 . The rational function q_1/q_0 on $\mathbb{P}(V^*)$ is nonconstant. In characteristic zero its differential is not identically zero: on an affine coordinate chart the common kernel of the coordinate derivations of the rational function field is $\mathbb{C}$. Choose a point $[v]$ where $q_0(v) \neq 0$ and this differential is nonzero. Replace q_1 by $q_1 - (q_1(v)/q_0(v))q_0$. Then $q_1(v) = 0$, whereas its differential has a nonzero value on some vector w independent of v . Euler's identity shows that its value on the radial vector v is zero. Extending v, w to a basis of V^* gives dual coordinates in which

$$[x_1^2]q_0 = a \neq 0, \quad [x_1^2]q_1 = 0, \quad [x_1x_2]q_1 = b \neq 0.$$

Here brackets denote a coefficient.

Apply $\lambda(t)$ to the variables. The forms

$$Q_0(t) = q_0(x_1, tx_2, t^2x_3, \dots, t^2x_n), \quad Q_1(t) = t^{-1}q_1(x_1, tx_2, t^2x_3, \dots, t^2x_n)$$

have polynomial coefficients: the only possible weight-zero term in q_1 was removed. Their limits are ax_1^2 and bx_1x_2 . For $t \neq 0$ they span a coordinate transform of R ; at zero they are independent. Thus their coefficient matrix has rank two everywhere, defines a subbundle, and supplies the asserted morphism from $\mathbb{A}^1$ to $\mathcal{P}$.

The orbit of $\langle x_1^2, x_1x_2 \rangle$ is exactly $\mathcal{C}$. A pencil of the form ℓH recovers ℓ as its gcd and H by division. These are scheme-theoretic inverse operations on the exact-gcd-one-degree stratum by Corollary 7.5, applied to $g = h = 1, r = 2$. Under that inverse the condition $\ell \subset H$ is the usual closed flag incidence. The flag-to-pencil map is therefore a locally closed immersion; since the flag variety is projective it is a closed immersion. It identifies $\mathcal{C}$ with the flag variety, and the dimension is $(n - 1) + (n - 2)$. Every pencil orbit closure contains $\mathcal{C}$, by the constructed family and equivariance. Any closed orbit must consequently be $\mathcal{C}$, proving uniqueness. $\square$

Corollary 19.2 (Flat closed specialization of failure algebras). *For every quadratic pencil R there is a finite locally free family over $\mathbb{A}^1$, of rank $\binom{n^2+d}{d} - \binom{N}{2}$, whose nonzero fibres are isomorphic to $\mathfrak{A}_R^{[d]}$ and whose zero fibre is $\mathfrak{A}_{\langle x_1^2, x_1x_2 \rangle}^{[d]}$. The intrinsic first relations throughout the family have exact gcd δ^{n-1} . In a fixed determinant frame, the two ordered copies of the flag orbit form the unique closed G -orbit in the pencil relation locus. Equivalently the effective pencil failure stack has the common closed specialization described in Theorem 19.1.*

Proof. Let R_t be the polynomial subbundle just constructed. Its Pluecker line gives, under the fixed exterior-duality identification, a line bundle $L_t^0 \subset \mathbb{S}_\mu V^* \otimes \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{A}^1}$. Set

$$\mathcal{K}_t = \delta^{n-1}(L_t^0 \otimes \mathbb{S}_\mu U), \quad \mathcal{A}_t = \mathrm{Sym}(E \otimes \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{A}^1})/((\mathcal{K}_t) + \mathfrak{m}^{d+1}).$$

The first is a rank- M subbundle. The second is finite locally free by its graded direct-sum presentation, with the claimed rank. Lemma 17.1 gives the exact gcd at every fibre, including zero; in fact this family lies scheme-theoretically in the fixed-divisor exact stratum. Equivariance and the local inverse identify its nonzero fibres as asserted. In a determinant frame the pencil locus is $G \times^{G^\circ} \mathcal{P}$. The previous closed-orbit calculation therefore gives the assertion for G . This is a statement inside that locus; it does not assert closedness under arbitrary degenerations of the determinant form in the full relation Grassmannian. $\square$

The closed specialization is very coarse compared with the unmarked local inverse: many pairwise nonisomorphic finite algebras have this same limiting fibre. The full first relation, not its common limit, retains the original pencil. The explicit family also differs from transport of spectral rank loci: it crosses from arbitrary pencils to a singular common-factor pencil without a regularity hypothesis. Theorem 7.4, on the other hand, describes divisor collisions in the larger natural first-relation boundary, outside the exact pencil image. These are two distinct geometric statements, and neither is a classification of every congruence-orbit adjacency of quadratic pencils.

20. TRANSVERSE DEFORMATIONS WITH UNCHANGED DETERMINANT SUPPORT

The larger determinant-divisor stratum has deformations which are not pencil deformations and need not satisfy either factor-invariance condition. We now identify their tangent directions and construct complete families in which the homogeneous radical remains exactly the determinant ideal. Thus the intrinsic stratum theorem has content outside the coefficient class, not merely a different description of the same symmetry hypothesis.

Let $J = L \otimes F$ be the primitive relation of a pencil $R \in \text{Gr}(2, W)$. In degree $h = 3n - 4$, write the equivariant Cauchy decomposition as

$$S_h(E) = (A \otimes F) \oplus H_{\text{other}},$$

where A, F, L are as in (17.1). The summand H_{other} contains every partition different from μ ; this notation denotes its full vector space, not a quotient chosen separately at each pencil.

Theorem 20.1 (Normal directions to the pencil stratum). *The normal space at J of the pencil locus in $X_{h,M}(E)$ has the following equivariant direct-sum description:*

$$\begin{aligned} N_J \simeq & \text{Hom}(\bigwedge^2 R, \bigwedge^2(W/R)) \\ & \oplus (\text{Hom}(L, A/L) \otimes \mathfrak{sl}(F)) \\ & \oplus \text{Hom}(L \otimes F, H_{\text{other}}). \end{aligned} \tag{20.1}$$

The summands respectively record departure from the Pluecker locus, departure from a full right multiplicity factor inside the same Cauchy summand, and departure into other Cauchy summands. They are all transverse directions in the effective first-relation stack: the infinitesimal G° -orbit lies in the pencil tangent space, so no vector in N_J is removed by that orbit. Every such direction is the first-order term of a local algebraic family in the determinant-divisor stratum. This last assertion refers to the common-divisor stratum; preservation of the entire homogeneous radical for complete families is supplied below.

Proof. The tangent space of a Grassmannian and the Cauchy splitting give

$$\text{Hom}(J, S_h(E)/J) = (\text{Hom}(L, A/L) \otimes \text{End}(F)) \oplus \text{Hom}(L \otimes F, H_{\text{other}}). \tag{20.2}$$

Under $L \mapsto L \otimes F$, the tangent to $\mathbb{P}(A)$ is the first factor tensored with the identity of F . In characteristic zero the trace splits $\text{End}(F) = \mathbb{C}I \oplus \mathfrak{sl}(F)$. It remains to identify the normal space of the Pluecker embedding. The natural map $\bigwedge^2 W \rightarrow \bigwedge^2(W/R)$ has kernel $R \wedge W$. At the line $\bigwedge^2 R$, the tangent image is $\text{Hom}(\bigwedge^2 R, (R \wedge W)/\bigwedge^2 R)$, which is the image of $\text{Hom}(R, W/R)$. Its quotient in the projective tangent space is $\text{Hom}(\bigwedge^2 R, \bigwedge^2(W/R))$. The common determinant twist in A cancels in this Hom space. Substitution in (20.2) proves (20.1) as a normal-space isomorphism. No splitting of the tangent sequence of the Pluecker embedding is being asserted.

The left group preserves the Pluecker locus, and the right group fixes $L \otimes F$; hence the differential of its orbit is in the pencil tangent. Passing to the quotient tangent complexes in (6.4) does not change this normal quotient. Finally $X_{h,M}(E)$ is open in a Grassmannian. A tangent vector is integrated by a graph with coefficients linear in one parameter, after restricting to a

neighbourhood of zero which stays in this open set. Multiplication by δ^{n-1} and Proposition 6.4 give the claimed family of finite flat algebras. $\square$

Theorem 20.2 (Complete fixed-support families through every pencil). *Put $e = n^2$. For every pencil R there is an e -dimensional subspace $B \subset J = \tilde{J}_R$ such that $\gcd(B) = 1$ and the forms in B have no common zero on the invertible matrix locus. The projective Grassmannian*

$$\Sigma_B = \{J' \in \text{Gr}(M, S_h(E)) : B \subset J'\} \simeq \text{Gr}(M - e, S_h(E)/B) \quad (20.3)$$

contains J , is contained in $X_{h,M}(E)$, and satisfies

$$\sqrt{(\delta^{n-1}J')} = (\delta) \quad \text{for every geometric } J' \in \Sigma_B. \quad (20.4)$$

Its universal first relation gives a finite flat family of the prescribed Hilbert function. It contains a projective line through J whose every other point is invariant under neither full factor group. Consequently determinant-radical relations through each pencil admit positive-dimensional complete families outside the recognized coefficient class, and their intrinsic deformation problem is described by Theorem 6.3.

Proof. By Lemma 17.1, the residual coefficient vector is nonzero on every invertible matrix. Evaluation gives a morphism

$$\text{GL}_n / \mathbb{G}_m \longrightarrow \mathbb{P}(J^*).$$

Its projective image closure Y has dimension at most $e - 1$. Since $M > e$ for $n \geq 3$, a general projective linear subspace of codimension e in $\mathbb{P}(J^*)$ misses Y . For such a subspace $\mathbb{P}(B^\perp)$, the associated e -plane $B \subset J$ has no common zero on the invertible locus. To justify the generic avoidance directly, the incidence of pairs consisting of a point of Y and an e -plane annihilated by it has dimension strictly smaller than $\text{Gr}(e, J)$. Its projection is closed because Y is projective.

The condition $\gcd(B) = 1$ is a second nonempty open condition on $\text{Gr}(e, J)$. To see nonemptiness, take any nonzero $b_1 \in J$. It has only finitely many irreducible factors. Since $\gcd(J) = 1$, a general $b_2 \in J$ avoids divisibility by each such factor; then $\gcd(b_1, b_2) = 1$. Extend their span to an e -plane. Openness follows from Lemma 6.1. The two nonempty opens intersect, as $\text{Gr}(e, J)$ is irreducible.

Every J' containing this B has greatest common divisor 1, and its forms cannot vanish simultaneously on an invertible matrix. The common zero set of $\delta^{n-1}J'$ is thus exactly $V(\delta)$. The Nullstellensatz over an algebraically closed field proves (20.4). This is a statement about geometric homogeneous radicals. The scheme-theoretic family used here is the universal subbundle $\delta^{n-1}\mathcal{J}'$, not an operation of taking radicals on a nonreduced parameter ring. Multiplication by this fixed nonzero form gives a subbundle; its quotient in degree d and all the lower symmetric powers are locally free. The truncated algebras are therefore finite flat.

For the final assertion, choose $j_0 \in J \setminus B$, a complement C to $\mathbb{C}j_0$ in J containing B , and a nonzero decomposable vector

$$\eta \in \text{Sym}^h V^* \otimes \text{Sym}^h U \subset H_{\text{other}}.$$

The inequality $M > e$ allows the choice of C . The family

$$J_{[a:b]} = C \oplus \mathbb{C}(aj_0 + b\eta), \quad [a:b] \in \mathbb{P}^1,$$

is a projective line in Σ_B through $J = J_{[1:0]}$. For $b \neq 0$ its projection to the (h) -Cauchy summand is exactly the line $\mathbb{C}\eta$. A decomposable line in $\text{Sym}^h V^* \otimes \text{Sym}^h U$ is invariant under neither full factor group: each of the two irreducible factors has dimension greater than one. Equivariance of the Cauchy projection therefore excludes both possible admissible orientations of $J_{[a:b]}$. The determinant-preserver theorem says that these are the only orientations after any change of the recovered matrix coordinates. This proves the assertion intrinsically, not only in the chosen matrix frame. $\square$

Remark 20.3. The three normal modes and the complete fixed-support families separate two questions. The effective pencil stratum has exactly the deformation theory of quadratic pencils, including their singular boundary. The larger determinant-divisor stratum contains additional directions, explicitly described here, which cease to be pencil or coefficient relations. Retaining the determinant radical does not suppress these directions. Conversely, no classification of all ideals with a prescribed radical is needed to describe this larger locally closed stratum and its family inverse. These assertions enlarge the reconstruction problem without replacing the all-pencil theorem by a generic statement.

21. COVERING MAPS INSIDE ONE FIBRE ORBIT OF QUADRATIC PENCILS

We give a consequence native to the pencil construction. It embeds the equivalence problem for maps $\mathbb{P}^1 \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^1$ into unmarked finite failure schemes, while keeping the fibre algebra and every nilradical graded vector bundle fixed. Unlike a varying spectral invariant, the phenomenon occurs within a single orbit of singular pencils.

Fix $n \geq 3$, a two-dimensional subspace $H = \langle x, y \rangle \subset V$, and the trivial source bundle $\mathcal{U} = \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}^n$. Let $f = [a : b] : \mathbb{P}^1 \rightarrow \mathbb{P}(H)$ be a morphism of degree $m \geq 1$, where a, b are homogeneous of degree m with no common zero. Its tautological line subbundle is

$$\mathcal{L}_f = \mathcal{O}(-m) \xrightarrow{(a,b)} H \otimes \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}.$$

Multiplication in $\text{Sym } V$ defines a rank-two subbundle

$$\mathcal{R}_f = \mathcal{L}_f H \subset \text{Sym}^2 V \otimes \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^1}, \quad \mathcal{R}_f|_{[s:t]} = \langle (ax + by)x, (ax + by)y \rangle. \quad (21.1)$$

Let $Y_f = Y_{\mathcal{R}_f}^{[d]}$ be its order- d failure thickening, with

$$N = \binom{n+1}{2}, \quad p = N - 2, \quad d = n^2 + 2n - 4, \quad M = \binom{N}{2}, \quad e = n^2.$$

All schemes below are compared without projection, grading, embedding, matrix factors, or coefficient markings.

Theorem 21.1 (Unmarked realization of the covering equivalence problem). *For fixed $n \geq 3$ and $m \geq 1$, the schemes Y_f have the following properties.*

(i) *They are finite locally free over their reduction $\mathbb{P}^1$, of rank $\binom{e+d}{d} - M$, and are Zariski locally trivial with the same Artin algebra as fibre. Every fibre pencil is equivalent to $\langle x^2, xy \rangle$.*

(ii) *Writing $\mathfrak{n}_f$ for their nilradicals, their graded vector bundles are independent of f :*

$$\begin{aligned} \mathfrak{n}_f^j / \mathfrak{n}_f^{j+1} &\simeq \mathcal{O}^{\binom{e+j-1}{j}} \quad (1 \leq j < d), \\ \mathfrak{n}_f^d &\simeq \mathcal{O}^{\binom{e+d-1}{d}-3M} \oplus \mathcal{O}(m)^{\oplus 2M}. \end{aligned} \quad (21.2)$$

Their abstract first-relation bundles are all $\mathcal{O}(-2m)^{\oplus M}$, and their pencil and quotient bundles are respectively $\mathcal{O}(-m)^2$ and $\mathcal{O}(2m) \oplus \mathcal{O}^{N-3}$.

(iii) *For two degree- m maps,*

$$Y_f \simeq Y_{f'} \iff f' = \alpha \circ f \circ \sigma \quad \text{for some } \alpha, \sigma \in \text{PGL}_2(\mathbb{C}). \quad (21.3)$$

Thus the double-orbit set of degree- m morphisms $\mathbb{P}^1 \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^1$ is realized faithfully by unmarked quadratic-pencil failure schemes with all the additive data in (ii) fixed. This is a statement about isomorphism classes, not an equivalence of their automorphism groupoids.

Proof. The pencil and local triviality. Multiplication by a nonzero linear form is injective on H . Since (a, b) never vanishes, the map $\mathcal{O}(-m) \otimes H \rightarrow \text{Sym}^2 H \otimes \mathcal{O}$ has rank two everywhere. Its image is a subbundle with locally free quotient. In the basis x^2, xy, y^2 its two columns are

$$\begin{pmatrix} a & 0 \\ b & a \\ 0 & b \end{pmatrix}, \quad \text{with Pluecker coordinates } (a^2, ab, b^2). \quad (21.4)$$

It follows that $\mathcal{R}_f \simeq \mathcal{O}(-m)^2$. The quotient of $\text{Sym}^2 H \otimes \mathcal{O}$ is a line bundle of degree $2m$. A constant complement to $\text{Sym}^2 H$ in $\text{Sym}^2 V$ gives $\mathcal{S}_f \simeq \mathcal{O}(2m) \oplus \mathcal{O}^{N-3}$. On an open set where $\mathcal{L}_f$ is trivialized, complete its nonvanishing generator to a frame of $H \otimes \mathcal{O}$. The inverse frame map takes $\mathcal{R}_f$ to $\langle x^2, xy \rangle$. Extend it by the identity on a fixed complement of H in V . With the source bundle trivial, it identifies the defining minors and the truncated algebra with a product on that open set. This proves local triviality, not merely equality of fibre isomorphism classes. Lemma 15.1 gives finite local freeness and the asserted rank.

The entire graded bundle calculation. The first relations occur in degree d , so all lower positive graded pieces are the full constant symmetric powers of $E = V^* \otimes \mathbb{C}^n$. Put $F(V) = \bigwedge^p \text{Sym}^2 V$, of dimension M . The coefficient line $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}_f} = \bigwedge^p \mathcal{S}_f^*$ is $\mathcal{O}(-2m)$. Under exterior duality

$$F(V)^* \simeq \bigwedge^2 (\text{Sym}^2 V) \otimes \det(\text{Sym}^2 V)^*,$$

its inclusion is the Pluecker line of $\mathcal{R}_f$. The constant determinant twist does not affect the bundle calculation. Thus it lies in a fixed three-dimensional subspace of $F(V)^*$, with column (a^2, ab, b^2) . There is an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}(-2m) \xrightarrow{(a^2, ab, b^2)^t} \mathcal{O}^3 \xrightarrow{\begin{pmatrix} -b & a & 0 \\ 0 & -b & a \end{pmatrix}} \mathcal{O}(m)^2 \longrightarrow 0. \quad (21.5)$$

Indeed the composite is zero; the maximal minors of the second map are $b^2, -ab, a^2$, which have no common zero. It is therefore everywhere surjective. Its rank-one kernel is the image of the displayed nowhere vanishing column. Taking a constant complement proves

$$(F(V)^* \otimes \mathcal{O})/\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}_f} \simeq \mathcal{O}^{M-3} \oplus \mathcal{O}(m)^2. \quad (21.6)$$

The fixed Cauchy inclusion, followed by multiplication by the fixed determinant, embeds $F(V)^* \otimes F(\mathbb{C}^n)$ as an M^2 -dimensional constant subspace of $\text{Sym}^d E$. The first relation bundle is precisely $\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}_f} \otimes F(\mathbb{C}^n)$ in that subspace. Choose a constant complement to the whole subspace, not to its varying relation subbundle. The top graded quotient is therefore

$$\mathcal{O}^{\binom{e+d-1}{d}-M^2} \oplus \left((F(V)^* \otimes \mathcal{O})/\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{R}_f} \right)^{\oplus M}.$$

Equation (21.6) gives exactly (21.2). It also shows that the first relation bundle is $\mathcal{O}(-2m)^{\oplus M}$. All assertions in (ii) concern vector bundles; their multiplication maps have not been identified.

The global inverse is the covering equivalence. Suppose $Y_f \simeq Y_{f'}$. Their reductions give an automorphism of $\mathbb{P}^1$. By Theorem 16.2, or the actual descent theorem with the pencil coefficient line, the varying pencil subbundles are identified by that base map and a single constant $g \in \text{GL}(V)$. For a nonzero $\ell \in H$, the common polynomial divisor of the two-dimensional space $\ell H \subset \text{Sym}^2 V$ is precisely ℓ , up to scalar: x and y have no common nonconstant divisor in $\text{Sym} V$. Dividing the pencil space by this common factor recovers H . These operations are equivariant under $\text{GL}(V)$. Consequently an equality between $g(\ell H)$ and a pencil of the form $\ell' H$ forces $gH = H$ and $[g\ell] = [\ell']$. The constant restriction $g|_H$ therefore supplies a single $\alpha \in \text{PGL}(H)$ for the whole map. Replacing the recovered base map by its inverse if necessary gives the right-hand side of (21.3).

Conversely choose linear lifts of α on H and extend by the identity on a complement in V . Together with the base map and the identity identification of the trivial source bundles, this gives equivalent pencil data. Their homogeneous normal maps induce an isomorphism of the finite schemes. This proves (iii) and the theorem. $\square$

Corollary 21.2 (A pencil-native separating pair). *For every $n \geq 3$, the degree-three maps*

$$f_0 = [s^3 : t^3], \quad f_1 = [s^3 + st^2 : t^3]$$

give nonisomorphic unmarked order- d failure schemes of quadratic pencils, although they have the same Artin fibres, the same conormal and first-relation bundles, the same pencil and quotient bundles, and isomorphic nilradical graded vector bundles in every degree. For $n = 3$ their common finite rank is 167945, and their top graded bundle is

$$\mathcal{O}^{75537} \oplus \mathcal{O}(3)^{\oplus 30}.$$

Proof. The pairs of cubics have no common zero. In the affine coordinate $z = s/t$ the maps are z^3 and $z^3 + z$. The first has two ramification points, both of index three. The second has the two distinct zeros of $3z^2 + 1$, each of index two, and infinity of index three. Independent projective changes in source and target preserve this multiset of indices, so the two maps are inequivalent. The theorem proves all the geometric assertions. For $n = 3$, $e = 9$, $d = 11$, $M = 15$, whence $\binom{20}{11} - 15 = 167945$ and $\binom{19}{11} - 45 = 75537$. $\square$

This consequence uses the global inverse essentially. Pointwise local reconstruction returns the same pencil orbit at every point for every f ; it cannot recover the map f . Even supplementing it with all the abstract bundles displayed in the theorem leaves the covering equivalence problem unresolved. It is the multiplication in the total unmarked thickening, followed by descent to one constant left transformation, that recovers that problem. The double-orbit description is not an assertion that the scheme has the automorphism group of the cover: the unused complement of H , the right factor, and the higher-order kernel remain present, as recorded by the previous automorphism theorems.

22. SPECTRAL TORSION AND RANK-PRESERVING SPECIALIZATION

The finite-neighbourhood theorem recovers more than the discriminant or the corank of each member of a regular pencil. We identify its classical spectral invariant and then give a flat specialization on which the entire discriminant and every reduced rank locus remain constant, while the recovered invariant changes. The two specializations are separated at exactly the order of Theorem 13.1. The parameter space throughout is the usual Grassmannian of pencils; the failure map is the original multiplication map, not an added coefficient-evaluation block.

22.1. The spectral torsion sheaf. Let $R \subset \text{Sym}^2 V$ be a regular pencil, meaning that it contains a nonsingular quadratic form. On its parameter line $L_R = \mathbb{P}(R)$, the tautological quadratic form gives an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow V^* \otimes \mathcal{O}_{L_R}(-1) \xrightarrow{q_R} V \otimes \mathcal{O}_{L_R} \longrightarrow \mathcal{T}_R \longrightarrow 0. \quad (22.1)$$

The first arrow is injective because its determinant is nonzero at the generic point of the smooth integral curve L_R . Thus $\mathcal{T}_R$ is a torsion sheaf of length n , whose zeroth Fitting divisor is the full discriminant. The pair $(L_R, \mathcal{T}_R)$ is considered up to isomorphism of the parameter line. Its definition involves no choice of a basis of R . The relation with elementary divisors is classical; see [4, §2, Corollary 2.1 and equation (5)]. We record the argument to make precise which datum is recovered.

Lemma 22.1 (Sheaves on the affine spectral line). *Let A, B be symmetric complex matrices with A invertible. On the affine line with coordinate z , the cokernel of $zA - B$ is the finite-dimensional $\mathbb{C}[z]$ -module on $\mathbb{C}^n$ for which multiplication by z is $C = A^{-1}B$. An isomorphism of such sheaves, in this fixed coordinate, is equivalent to similarity of the corresponding matrices.*

Proof. Multiplication on the target by A^{-1} identifies the presentation with $zI - C$. Reduction of a polynomial vector modulo these relations sends $\sum_j z^j v_j$ to $\sum_j C^j v_j$; constant vectors give the inverse identification. The equivalence between coherent sheaves on an affine scheme and finitely generated modules identifies a finite-length sheaf supported in this affine line with this module. The support is finite, so its underlying complex vector space is finite dimensional. A module isomorphism is a linear isomorphism G satisfying $GC = C'G$, which is exactly similarity. Extension by zero across a point outside the support loses no sheaf data. $\square$

Lemma 22.2 (Polynomial square roots of invertible operators). *For every invertible complex matrix K there is $h \in \mathbb{C}[x]$ with $h(K)^2 = K$. If K is self-adjoint for a nondegenerate symmetric form and commutes with C , then $h(K)$ has both properties.*

Proof. Write the minimal polynomial as $\prod_\lambda (x - \lambda)^{a_\lambda}$, where $\lambda \neq 0$. In its local Artinian factor choose a square root $\mu_\lambda^2 = \lambda$, and put

$$h_\lambda(x) = \mu_\lambda \sum_{j=0}^{a_\lambda-1} \binom{1/2}{j} \left(\frac{x - \lambda}{\lambda} \right)^j.$$

The formal binomial identity, truncated modulo $(x - \lambda)^{a_\lambda}$, gives $h_\lambda(x)^2 = x$. The Chinese remainder theorem joins these polynomials to a single class modulo the minimal polynomial. Evaluation at K proves the assertion even when K is not semisimple. Polynomials in one self-adjoint operator remain self-adjoint, and every polynomial in K commutes with every operator commuting with K . $\square$

Theorem 22.3 (Spectral reconstruction at the first relation). *Let $n \geq 3$, $d = n^2 + 2n - 4$, and let R, R' be regular pencils. The following are equivalent:*

- (1) *the unmarked schemes $Z_R^{[d]}$ and $Z_{R'}^{[d]}$ are isomorphic;*
- (2) *there is an isomorphism $f : L_R \rightarrow L_{R'}$ with $\mathcal{T}_R \simeq f^* \mathcal{T}_{R'}$;*
- (3) *the pencils R, R' are projectively equivalent.*

In particular the finite scheme determines the full root-labelled spectral torsion sheaf, not only its Fitting divisor or its support. This is an equivalence of isomorphism classes of objects; it is not an assertion identifying their automorphism groups or moduli stacks.

Proof. The equivalence of the first and third conditions is Theorem 13.1. A congruence of pencils induces an isomorphism of (22.1), so the third implies the second.

For the converse choose a common affine coordinate whose point at infinity avoids the two spectral supports, using f to identify the lines. Write the corresponding symmetric pairs as (A, B) and (A', B') , with A, A' invertible, and set $C = A^{-1}B$, $C' = A'^{-1}B'$. Choose the presentation $zA - B$ for the affine coordinate on both lines. Lemma 22.1 identifies the two sheaves with the modules of C, C' , so their isomorphism gives a similarity. After applying that change of coordinates, assume $C' = C$. Both A and A' are nondegenerate symmetric forms for which C is self-adjoint. Then $K = A^{-1}A'$ commutes with C and is self-adjoint for A . Lemma 22.2 provides a polynomial h with $h(K)^2 = K$. Put $H = h(K)$. It commutes with C , is self-adjoint for A , and satisfies

$$H^t A H = A', \quad H^t B H = H^t A C H = A' C = B'.$$

Thus the pairs, and hence the pencils, are congruent. This also shows why the spectral sheaf alone suffices here; no additional pairing on that sheaf is required over $\mathbb{C}$. $\square$

For $x \in \text{Supp } \mathcal{T}_R$, put

$$\ell_a(x) = \text{length}(\mathcal{T}_{R,x}/\mathfrak{m}_x^a \mathcal{T}_{R,x}), \quad a \geq 0. \quad (22.2)$$

If the elementary-divisor exponents at x are $e_1, \dots, e_b$, the structure theorem over the discrete valuation ring $\mathcal{O}_{L_R,x}$ gives

$$\ell_a(x) = \sum_{j=1}^b \min(a, e_j), \quad \ell_a(x) - \ell_{a-1}(x) = \#\{j : e_j \geq a\}. \quad (22.3)$$

Thus these intrinsic local lengths recover every exponent, including repeated roots. The corank of the pencil at x gives only $\ell_1(x)$, and the multiplicity of the discriminant gives only the eventual value $\ell_a(x) = \sum_j e_j$. The intermediate values are genuinely additional information.

22.2. A specialization with constant discriminant and coranks. The following family keeps both ends of this length profile fixed. Fix $i \in \mathbb{C}$ with $i^2 = -1$, and set

$$N_0 = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & i \\ i & -1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad P_t = \frac{t}{2} N_0, \quad A_0 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & I_2 \\ I_2 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad C_t = \begin{pmatrix} P_t & I_2 \\ 0 & P_t \end{pmatrix}. \quad (22.4)$$

Put

$$B_t = A_0 C_t = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & P_t \\ P_t & I_2 \end{pmatrix}, \quad R_t = \langle A_0, B_t \rangle \subset \text{Sym}^2 \mathbb{C}^4. \quad (22.5)$$

Both matrices are symmetric and A_0 is invertible. They are independent for every t . For $n > 4$, append I_{n-4} to A_0 and append $\text{diag}(\mu_5, \dots, \mu_n)$ to B_t , where the μ_j are fixed distinct nonzero numbers. Denote the resulting matrices by $A^{(n)}, B_t^{(n)}$ and their pencil again by R_t .

Theorem 22.4 (Separation inside fixed reduced rank data). *For every $n \geq 4$, the family R_t , $t \in \mathbb{A}^1$, has the following properties.*

- (1) *Its full discriminant, with multiplicities, is independent of t :*

$$\det(sA^{(n)} + uB_t^{(n)}) = s^4 \prod_{j=5}^n (s + \mu_j u). \quad (22.6)$$

For every minor size, the reduced determinantal locus on the marked parameter line is also independent of t .

- (2) *At the root $s = 0$, the spectral module has exponents $(3, 1)$ for $t \neq 0$ and $(2, 2)$ for $t = 0$. Consequently $Z_{R_t}^{[d]} \not\cong Z_{R_0}^{[d]}$ for every $t \neq 0$, whereas all the punctured fibres are isomorphic.*
- (3) *The schemes $Z_{R_t}^{[d]}$ form a flat projective family over $\mathbb{A}^1$, with fixed reduction. After one identification of the socle quotient bundles, every truncation of order $k < d$ is a constant family. Thus the first separating order remains exactly $d = n^2 + 2n - 4$ even under the constraints in part (1).*

Proof. The identities $N_0^2 = 0$ and $\text{rank } N_0 = 1$ give

$$C_t^2 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & tN_0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad C_t^3 = 0, \quad C_t = \begin{pmatrix} I_2 \\ P_t \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} P_t & I_2 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (22.7)$$

The right factor in the last expression is surjective and the left factor is injective. Hence $\text{rank } C_t = 2$ for every t , whereas $\text{rank } C_t^2 = 1$ precisely when $t \neq 0$. The nilpotent partitions are therefore $(3, 1)$ and $(2, 2)$. Also $\det A_0 = 1$ and $\det(sI_4 + uC_t) = s^4$, proving (22.6). At $s = 0$ the full pencil has corank two for all t ; at each remaining root it has corank one, and elsewhere corank zero. Equality of these functions on $\mathbb{P}^1(\mathbb{C})$ implies equality of the reduced closed determinantal subschemes for each minor size.

At the unique multiplicity-four root, formula (22.3) yields respectively

$$(\ell_1, \ell_2, \ell_3, \dots) = (2, 3, 4, \dots), \quad (2, 4, 4, \dots).$$

No automorphism of the parameter line can exchange this root with a simple one. Theorem 22.3 separates the special fibre from the punctured fibres and identifies the latter with one another. This is a statement about geometric fibres; no choice of a simultaneous trivializing congruence on $\mathbb{A}^1 \setminus 0$ is needed.

For flatness we use the relative gluing of Theorem 23.1; the following coordinates identify its pullback in the present family. First note that $t \mapsto R_t$ is a morphism to $\text{Gr}(2, \text{Sym}^2 V)$, not merely a collection of pencils. In symmetric matrix coordinates the two fixed linear functionals

$$a(Q) = Q_{13} + iQ_{14}, \quad b(Q) = Q_{33}$$

satisfy $a(A^{(n)}) = b(B_t^{(n)}) = 1$ and $a(B_t^{(n)}) = b(A^{(n)}) = 0$. Their common kernel is a fixed complement to every R_t . It trivializes $S_{R_t} = \text{Sym}^2 V / R_t$, and hence identifies the relative socle Grassmannian with $B \times \mathbb{A}^1$.

On a frame chart of its tautological bundle, the graph description (13.4) identifies the truncated algebra with

$$\bigoplus_{j=0}^{d-1} \text{Sym}^j E^* \oplus (\text{Sym}^d E^* / K_{R_t}). \quad (22.8)$$

By Theorem 13.3, K_{R_t} is a subbundle of constant rank $\binom{N}{2}$, with locally free quotient. This statement commutes with pullback to the present base and with right changes of frame, so the local descriptions glue. Thus (22.8) is locally free on $B \times \mathbb{A}^1$, of rank $\binom{n_2+d}{d} - \binom{N}{2}$. The graph projection is a finite flat morphism to that base. Since B is projective, its composition with projection to $\mathbb{A}^1$ is flat and projective. Below degree d there is no relation, and the fixed complement identifies the entire lower truncated algebra, including multiplication, with a constant family. These arguments prove flatness of the finite neighbourhoods; they make no assertion about flatness of the unrestricted failure schemes. $\square$

The qualifier “reduced” in part (1) is necessary. At $s = 0$, in a local parameter $z = s/u$, the gcd of the three-row minors of the four-dimensional block is a unit times z for $t \neq 0$ and a unit times z^2 for $t = 0$. Both radicals are (z) . Thus the family retains exactly the higher Fitting information discarded by reduction; it does not contradict the classical classification by the full determinantal ideals.

22.3. An independently visible change of reciprocal geometry. For a regular pencil let its reciprocal curve be the projective closure of the inverses of its nonsingular members. These curves and their strata are studied independently of multiplication-failure schemes in [4, §3].

Corollary 22.5 (A conic specializes to a line). *For the four-dimensional family (22.5), the reciprocal curve is a smooth plane conic when $t \neq 0$ and a projective line when $t = 0$. The unmarked twentieth neighbourhood distinguishes these two cases, while all earlier neighbourhoods, the full discriminant, and all reduced rank loci agree.*

Proof. For $s \neq 0$, multiplication on the right by the fixed invertible matrix A_0^{-1} identifies the projective inverse with

$$(sI_4 + uC_t)^{-1} = s^{-1}I_4 - us^{-2}C_t + u^2s^{-3}C_t^2.$$

If $t \neq 0$, the matrices I_4, C_t, C_t^2 are linearly independent: their span has dimension equal to the degree three of the minimal polynomial. The closure is therefore the quadratic Veronese image $[s : u] \mapsto [s^2 : -su : u^2]$, a smooth conic in its spanning plane. At $t = 0$ the last term vanishes, and I_4, C_0 are independent, giving a line. The remaining assertions follow from Theorem 22.4,

with $d = 20$. The degree drop does not assert that the reciprocal curves themselves form a flat family; the flat family proved above consists of the finite failure neighbourhoods. $\square$

23. THE UNIVERSAL FINITE NEIGHBOURHOOD AND SPECTRAL STRATA

The finite-order construction is a family of actual neighbourhoods in multiplication-failure schemes. This fact is needed when passing from individual pencils to degenerations and infinitesimal parameter spaces. We establish it before discussing the spectral incidence schemes.

Put $P = \text{Gr}(2, \text{Sym}^2 V)$, and write $\mathcal{R}$ and $\mathcal{S} = (\text{Sym}^2 V \otimes \mathcal{O}_P)/\mathcal{R}$ for its universal relation and quotient bundles. Let

$$\pi : \mathcal{B} = \text{Gr}_P(n, \mathcal{S}) \longrightarrow P, \quad \mathcal{E} = \text{Hom}(\mathcal{U}, V \otimes \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{B}}),$$

where $\mathcal{U}$ is tautological of rank n . As before, $N = n(n+1)/2$, $p = N - 2$, $d = n + 2p$, and $M = \binom{N}{2}$.

Theorem 23.1 (Universal neighbourhood and arbitrary base change). *The universal multiplication-failure scheme has a canonical order- d neighbourhood $\mathcal{Z}^{[d]}$ of $\mathcal{B}$. There is a rank- M vector subbundle $\mathcal{K} \subset \text{Sym}^d \mathcal{E}^*$ such that*

$$\mathcal{Z}^{[d]} = \text{Spec}_{\mathcal{B}} \left(\text{Sym} \mathcal{E}^* / (\mathcal{K}, \text{Sym}^{d+1} \mathcal{E}^*) \right). \quad (23.1)$$

This is finite locally free over $\mathcal{B}$, of rank

$$\binom{n^2 + d}{d} - \binom{N}{2}, \quad (23.2)$$

and is projective and flat over P . Its construction, its ideal-adic filtration, and its identification with the actual multiplication-failure neighbourhood commute with every morphism of complex schemes $T \rightarrow P$, including nonreduced ones. For $k < d$, its order- k truncation is $\text{Spec}_{\mathcal{B}} \bigoplus_{j=0}^k \text{Sym}^j \mathcal{E}^$, with truncated multiplication. After trivializing $\mathcal{S}$ on the parameter base, these lower-order families are constant.*

Proof. The locus in $\text{Gr}_P(n, V \oplus \mathcal{S})$ on which projection to $\mathcal{S}$ is injective is canonically $\text{Tot } \mathcal{E}$. It is an open neighbourhood of $\mathcal{B}$, not a choice of formal coordinates. On a frame chart of $\mathcal{U}$, let $T : \mathcal{U} \rightarrow V$ be the universal graph map and let $\gamma : \text{Sym}^2 V \rightarrow \mathcal{S}$ be the quotient. The same block elimination that proves (13.4) works over its coordinate ring: the ideal of the multiplication-failure scheme is

$$(\det T) I_p(\gamma \text{Sym}^2 T).$$

Every generator is homogeneous of degree d .

Here is also a coordinate-free description of its first relation bundle. The coefficient map, followed by determinant multiplication, is a morphism

$$\det V^* \otimes \det \mathcal{U} \otimes \det \mathcal{S}^* \otimes \bigwedge^p \text{Sym}^2 \mathcal{U} \longrightarrow \text{Sym}^d \mathcal{E}^*. \quad (23.3)$$

The inclusion used in this expression is $\det \mathcal{S}^* \hookrightarrow (\bigwedge^p \text{Sym}^2 V)^*$. The determinant factors evaluate $\det T$, and the remaining factors evaluate $\bigwedge^p \text{Sym}^2 T$ followed by the quotient. Thus the image is exactly the span of the displayed maximal minors, not a separately inserted coefficient module.

On a frame chart this map is the fixed injective linear coefficient map ν of Theorem 13.3, restricted to a line subbundle tensored with the fixed space $\bigwedge^p \text{Sym}^2 \mathbb{C}^n$. Its image is a subbundle of rank M : locally split the line in the source, and split the fixed complex linear inclusion ν . Both splittings remain splittings over any complex algebra. Denote its image by $\mathcal{K}$. A right change of frame of $\mathcal{U}$ changes the graph coordinates and this coefficient map contragrediently. The determinant character in (23.3) is exactly the one arising from $\det T$. Hence these local ideals

and their degree- d subbundles agree on overlaps. In particular, they glue as ideals of the given graph neighbourhood.

Let $\mathfrak{b}$ be the ideal of the zero section inside the multiplication-failure scheme. In graph coordinates its preimage is the positive-degree ideal. Quotienting by $\mathfrak{b}^{d+1}$ therefore gives precisely (23.1). This identifies the gluing with the actual ideal-adic neighbourhood, not merely with algebras having the correct geometric fibres. Its underlying module is

$$\bigoplus_{j=0}^{d-1} \mathrm{Sym}^j \mathcal{E}^* \oplus (\mathrm{Sym}^d \mathcal{E}^* / \mathcal{K}).$$

All terms are locally free. Counting monomials in n^2 variables gives (23.2). The morphism $\mathcal{B} \rightarrow P$ is smooth and projective, so the asserted flatness and projectivity follow. Finally the graph description, the split coefficient inclusion, and the homogeneous quotient all commute with base change. Below degree d the ideal contributes no relation. This proves the final assertion as well. $\square$

Remark 23.2. Over a nonreduced base, the theorem concerns the specified relative socle subscheme $\mathcal{B}_T$ and its ideal. It does not identify that ideal with the absolute nilradical of $\mathcal{Z}_T^{[d]}$, which can also contain nilpotents from the base. On geometric fibres $\mathcal{B}_t$ is exactly the reduction. Nor is this theorem an equivalence of unmarked deformation groupoids: extra automorphisms of truncated algebras are not being identified with pencil congruences.

23.1. Spectral incidence schemes from the first relation space. On the regular-pencil locus, pass locally to ordered generators (A, B) with A invertible, and put $C = A^{-1}B$. For a marked point with affine coordinate z , set $X = C - zI$. The next elementary presentation works over an arbitrary coefficient ring; no diagonalization or division by eigenvalue differences is involved.

Lemma 23.3 (Truncated spectral presentation). *Let D be a commutative ring, $X \in \mathrm{Mat}_n(D)$, and $a \geq 1$. There is a natural isomorphism*

$$\mathrm{coker}(wI - X) \otimes_{D[w]} D[w]/(w^a) \simeq \mathrm{coker}(X^a : D^n \rightarrow D^n). \quad (23.4)$$

Equivalently, the a -square block presentation with diagonal blocks X and subdiagonal blocks $-I$ is equivalent, by invertible row and column operations over D , to $I_{n(a-1)} \oplus X^a$.

Proof. Map the class of $\sum_{j=0}^{a-1} w^j v_j$ to the class of $\sum_{j=0}^{a-1} X^j v_j$ modulo $X^a D^n$. The relation $wv = Xv$ and the relation $w^a v = 0$ show that this map is well-defined. Sending a constant vector to its class is inverse. Eliminating successively the blocks with coefficient $-I$ gives the stated presentation equivalence, using only unit pivots. This also proves naturality under ring homomorphisms. $\square$

Theorem 23.4 (Scheme-theoretic spectral readout). *In the fixed tensor presentation of Theorem 13.3, the first relation subspace determines, on the regular-pencil locus, every closed spectral incidence scheme*

$$\mathfrak{S}_{a,h} = V(I_{n-h+1}((C - zI)^a)), \quad 1 \leq a, h \leq n. \quad (23.5)$$

This determination commutes with arbitrary complex base change. At a geometric point, membership is equivalent to $\mathrm{length}(\mathcal{T}_z / \mathfrak{m}_z^a \mathcal{T}_z) \geq h$. Consequently the schemes of specified spectral length profiles, and not only their reduced supports, can be read from the order- d relation subspace.

Proof. The closed immersion Φ of Theorem 13.3 has an inverse on its scheme-theoretic image. Thus a family of relation subspaces in that image recovers its morphism to P , over any base, and hence its universal pencil. In the displayed chart its spectral sheaf has presentation $(z+w)I - C = wI - X$. Lemma 23.3 gives the presentation X^a for restriction to the order- a fat point centred at z . Its

$(h - 1)$ -st Fitting ideal is exactly the ideal in (23.5); Fitting ideals of finitely presented modules commute with base change. On a field the cokernel has dimension at least h exactly when these minors vanish.

These descriptions are independent of the chosen frames. A change of basis in V conjugates X ; a change of affine coordinate replaces the parameter ideal at the marked point by a unit multiple locally. Alternatively, restriction of the spectral sheaf to the fat diagonal on its parameter line defines the same finite module without a coordinate. Thus the Fitting ideals glue. Rank equality is imposed by the corresponding rank inequality together with the open complement of the next inequality. Intersecting these locally closed conditions gives each specified length profile. Formula (22.3) then identifies its geometric fibres with the prescribed elementary-divisor partition. $\square$

23.2. Realizing the complete Segre stratification. Let P_σ denote the reduced closure in P of a regular Segre stratum, and let $J_\sigma = \Phi(P_\sigma)$. Because Φ is a closed immersion, it gives isomorphisms

$$P_\sigma \simeq J_\sigma, \quad P_{\sigma_1} \cap_P \cdots \cap_P P_{\sigma_s} \simeq J_{\sigma_1} \cap_{\Phi(P)} \cdots \cap_{\Phi(P)} J_{\sigma_s}, \quad (23.6)$$

where the intersections carry their scheme structures. In particular their local rings and formal completions are preserved. Pulling back Theorem 23.1 realizes these parameter schemes by flat projective families of the actual finite failure neighbourhoods. The classical inclusions among Segre-stratum closures [4, Theorem 5.1] are therefore all realized, rather than just the one degeneration of Theorem 22.4.

There are two distinct assertions here. The Segre closure order is classical, and transport of closed subschemes through a closed immersion is formal. The geometric input proved here is the base-change-compatible realization by actual multiplication-failure neighbourhoods and the recovery of their spectral Fitting schemes. The ambient parameter space in (23.6) is the image of Φ , not a moduli space of every possible unmarked deformation of a finite scheme.

24. FIXED-DISCRIMINANT STRATA AND ALL ADMISSIBLE SPECIALIZATIONS

The universal family of Section 23 and the example of Section 22 lead to a classification of the entire fixed-discriminant, fixed-reduced-rank locus. The spectral orbit order is classical. Every allowed specialization is realized here by a flat family of the original finite multiplication-failure neighbourhoods, and the same first relation detects every strict transition.

Fix distinct $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_s \in \mathbb{C}$, positive m_i with $\sum m_i = n \geq 3$, and $1 \leq c_i \leq m_i$. Fix a nonsingular symmetric A , and let $\mathfrak{p}_A$ be its self-adjoint endomorphisms. Consider the reduced locally closed variety

$$X_{m,c}(A) = \left\{ C \in \mathfrak{p}_A : \det(zI - C) = \prod_i (z - \alpha_i)^{m_i}, \quad \dim \ker(C - \alpha_i I) = c_i \right\}. \quad (24.1)$$

Exclude $s = 1, c_1 = n$, for which C is scalar and $\langle A, AC \rangle$ is not a pencil. Every other datum is realized. Put $R_C = \langle A, AC \rangle$, $d = n^2 + 2n - 4$, and $Z_C = Z_{R_C}^{[d]}$. The full binary determinant is $\det(A) \prod_i (u + \alpha_i v)^{m_i}$. The coranks and labelled roots specify all reduced determinantal loci on the line.

Write $\mathcal{P}(m, c)$ for partitions into exactly c positive parts. For equal-size partitions, $\mu \preceq \lambda$ means $\sum_{j \leq a} \mu_j \leq \sum_{j \leq a} \lambda_j$ for every a ; write λ' for the conjugate partition.

24.1. The classical orthogonal input. We isolate the orbit theorem used below, with its precise group and source. Let (H, A) be a nondegenerate complex symmetric space of dimension m . The acting group is the full orthogonal group $O(A)$, and the operators are A -self-adjoint, not elements of the skew-adjoint Lie algebra $\mathfrak{o}(A)$.

Lemma 24.1 (Self-adjoint nilpotent orbits). *The full $O(A)$ -orbits of self-adjoint nilpotent operators are indexed by all partitions λ of m . If $\mathcal{O}_\lambda$ denotes the orbit, then*

$$\dim \mathcal{O}_\lambda = \frac{1}{2} \left(m^2 - \sum_a (\lambda'_a)^2 \right), \quad \mathcal{O}_\mu \subset \overline{\mathcal{O}_\lambda} \iff \mu \preceq \lambda.$$

An $O(A)$ -orbit is one $SO(A)$ -orbit when λ has an odd part. When every part is even, it is the disjoint union of two $SO(A)$ -orbits, interchanged by an isometry of determinant -1 . The closure statement above is for the full orthogonal orbit and does not identify the closures of its two components.

Proof. The classification and closure assertions are [5, Proposition 1, p. 444; Theorem 1, p. 447], respectively, with $\varepsilon = 1$ and $G(V)$ as defined in [5, §1.1, p. 443]. Remark 1 on p. 444 specifies that all partitions occur; the order in §1.4 on p. 446 is precisely the row-dominance order used here. The proof of Theorem 1 occupies pp. 447–451. These references concern the full group, not its identity component.

For the dimension formula there is a short independent calculation. The trace pairing on $\text{End } H$ is nondegenerate on both its self-adjoint and skew-adjoint summands. For a self-adjoint nilpotent N , the commutator with N exchanges the summands, and the two resulting maps are adjoint up to sign for that pairing. They have equal rank. Consequently $\dim \text{GL}(H)N = 2 \dim O(A)N$, also the identity in [5, §2.4, Remark 8(i), p. 456]. The general linear centralizer has dimension $\sum_{i,j} \min(\lambda_i, \lambda_j) = \sum_a (\lambda'_a)^2$, as follows by writing homomorphisms between the cyclic $\mathbb{C}[t]$ -modules of the Jordan decomposition. This proves the stated dimension.

We give the component argument explicitly. The good bases of [5, Lemma 1, p. 444] decompose the symmetric space orthogonally into cyclic Jordan blocks, each with a reversed-identity Gram matrix. If one block has odd size, its negative identity, extended by the identity on the other blocks, centralizes N and has determinant -1 . The centralizer then meets both components of $O(A)$, so the orbit is a single $SO(A)$ -orbit.

For the converse, write

$$E_k = \ker N^k / (\ker N^{k-1} + N \ker N^{k+1}).$$

The form induced by $A(u, N^{k-1}v)$ on E_k is nondegenerate and symmetric; this is immediate on the same cyclic blocks. A commuting isometry induces $g_k \in O(E_k)$. A filtration of the Jordan module by its cyclic lengths and powers of t gives

$$\det g = \prod_k (\det g_k)^k.$$

Indeed the multiplicity-space action of a length- k block occurs k times on the associated graded; the strictly triangular terms of a module automorphism do not change its determinant. If all lengths are even, this product is one. The centralizer lies in $SO(A)$, and the index-two quotient of $O(A)$ therefore gives exactly two $SO(A)$ -orbits. Since $SO(A)$ is connected, these are the connected components of the full orbit. This does not preclude their closures from meeting. $\square$

Theorem 24.2 (Classification and specialization at the first relation). *The following statements hold.*

- (1) *The $O(A)$ -orbits in $X_{m,c}(A)$ are indexed by $\lambda \in \prod_i \mathcal{P}(m_i, c_i)$, with dimensions*

$$\dim \mathcal{O}_\lambda = \frac{1}{2} \left(n^2 - \sum_i \sum_a (\lambda'_{i,a})^2 \right). \quad (24.2)$$

Unmarked isomorphism classes of Z_C are these tuples modulo the permutation group induced on the roots by projective transformations preserving their multiplicities and coranks.

(2) A specialization from λ to μ inside (24.1) exists if and only if

$$\mu_i \preceq \lambda_i \quad \text{for every } i. \quad (24.3)$$

Every such pair is realized over a smooth pointed algebraic curve, after shrinking at the special point, with A fixed and with constant full determinant and reduced rank loci.

- (3) Every such pencil family induces a flat projective family of Z_C . After shrinking the curve, every truncation of order $k < d$ is constant. If at least one dominance inequality is strict, the generic and special Z_C are nonisomorphic; their first distinguishing order is d .
- (4) The recovered spectral module at α_i has length profile

$$L_{i,a} = \sum_j \min(a, \lambda_{i,j}). \quad (24.4)$$

Every $L_{i,a}$ can only increase in the stated specialization. All these inequalities together are equivalent to (24.3), giving an intrinsic numerical criterion for every admissible transition.

Proof. We use Lemma 24.1. Its full-orthogonal classification and dominance order have exactly the group and self-adjoint convention needed here. The comparison for Grassmannian Segre strata is [4, Theorem 5.1].

The primary spaces $V_i = \ker(C - \alpha_i I)^{m_i}$ are an orthogonal direct sum: the Chinese remainder idempotents are polynomials in the self-adjoint C , hence self-adjoint projections. Each restricted form is nondegenerate, and $C|_{V_i} = \alpha_i I + N_i$, with N_i self-adjoint nilpotent. The prescribed corank is its number of Jordan blocks. The classical theorem gives the indexing. Conversely, a Jordan block is self-adjoint for the reversed-identity Gram matrix; an isometry with the chosen nondegenerate form realizes each partition.

The space of orthogonal decompositions has dimension $(n^2 - \sum_i m_i^2)/2$. Adding the nilpotent orbit dimensions proves (24.2). These are dimensions in the fixed- A matrix space, not in an unmarked moduli stack. Full orthogonal orbits need not be connected; no irreducibility assertion is needed. Theorem 22.3 identifies the unmarked neighbourhood with the pencil, and its spectral module determines the partition at each root. A projective change of the line can therefore do exactly the stated root permutations. For one or two roots the projective stabilizer may be infinite; only its finite permutation image is used.

For necessity, the same polynomial idempotents decompose a family with fixed characteristic polynomial into subbundles of ranks m_i . The rank of N_i^a cannot increase at specialization. Since $m_i - \text{rank } N_i^a = \sum_j \min(a, \lambda_{i,j})$, this gives the length inequalities. Summing the first a columns of conjugate Young diagrams shows that they are equivalent to dominance: conjugation reverses the dominance order.

For sufficiency, fix an orthogonal decomposition of (V, A) . The closure criterion puts a chosen representative of μ_i in the closure of the orbit for λ_i . Thus the special tuple lies in the closure of the product of the generic orbits. Choose an irreducible component of that closure containing the point and meeting the generic orbit product. Successive general hyperplane sections through the point, avoiding the closed complement, give an integral algebraic curve with generic point in that open orbit product. Normalize it and choose a point over the prescribed point. A normal complex curve is smooth. Remove the other points outside the generic orbit product. A constant curve suffices in the equality case. The resulting block operator $\bigoplus_i (\alpha_i I + N_i(t))$ is self-adjoint for the same A . Its determinant is unchanged, and its coranks agree generically and specially, hence throughout the shrunk curve. This gives the required specialization. It does not assert constancy of the full higher Fitting ideals.

For part (3), pull back Theorem 23.1 along the curve's morphism to $P = \text{Gr}(2, \text{Sym}^2 V)$. That theorem identifies the family with the actual ideal-adic neighbourhoods and proves flatness and projectivity under arbitrary base change. No inference from fibrewise isomorphisms is

needed. An affine Grassmannian chart around the special pencil supplies a fixed complement to nearby R_C , identifying S_{R_C} , B , and E . There is no relation below degree d , so all lower neighbourhoods become constant. For a strict dominance transition, $\sum_{i,a} (\lambda'_{i,a})^2$ strictly increases; this sum is invariant under permutations of the decorated roots. The generic and special tuples therefore cannot be related by such a permutation. Part (1) separates their unmarked degree- d neighbourhoods. Flatness is asserted only for these finite neighbourhoods, not unrestricted failure schemes. $\square$

Corollary 24.3 (Exactly when the coarse data lose a labelled class). *The number of root-labelled congruence classes with the prescribed data is $\prod_i \#\mathcal{P}(m_i, c_i)$. It is one precisely when, for every i , either $c_i = 1$ or $m_i - c_i \leq 1$. The first possible ambiguity with fixed full determinant and all reduced rank loci occurs in dimension four, at $(m, c) = (4, 2)$, with partitions $(3, 1)$ and $(2, 2)$.*

Proof. Subtracting one from every part identifies $\mathcal{P}(m, c)$ with partitions of $m - c$ into at most c parts. There is one if $c = 1$ or $m - c \leq 1$. Otherwise $(m - c)$ and $(m - c - 1, 1)$ are distinct admissible partitions. The theorem gives the count and the minimal example. $\square$

24.2. The first relation as a standard graded Betti space. The finite invariant has a usual Hilbert-scheme interpretation. The first Betti space means the generator space in the first free module of a minimal graded resolution of the quotient, not the space of relations among generators of its defining ideal. The following statement retains the marked quotient presentation.

Proposition 24.4 (A graded Hilbert locus and its first Betti space). *In the fixed coordinates of Theorem 13.3, let $S = \text{Sym } H^*$, $N = \binom{n+1}{2}$, $M = \binom{N}{2}$, and $Q_R = S/((K_R) + S_{\geq d+1})$. Then*

$$\text{Tor}_1^S(Q_R, \mathbb{C})_d = K_R. \quad (24.5)$$

This identity commutes with arbitrary complex base change. The functor of graded quotients with Hilbert function

$$h_j = \begin{cases} \dim S_j, & 0 \leq j < d, \\ \dim S_d - M, & j = d, \\ 0, & j > d \end{cases}$$

is represented by $\text{Gr}(M, S_d)$. The pencil locus is a closed copy of $\text{Gr}(2, \text{Sym}^2 V)$. Its degree- d first Betti space recovers every scheme-theoretic pencil parameter, including parameters over nonreduced bases.

Proof. Put $J = (K_R) + S_{\geq d+1}$ and $S_+ = \bigoplus_{j>0} S_j$. The augmented sequence $0 \rightarrow J \rightarrow S \rightarrow Q_R \rightarrow 0$ gives $\text{Tor}_1^S(Q_R, \mathbb{C}) = J/S_+J$, since its map to S/S_+ is zero. Its degree- d part is K_R . The same argument over a base algebra applies to the degree- d subbundle with locally free quotient and commutes with pullback. A graded quotient with the indicated locally free components has zero ideal below degree d , a rank- M subbundle in degree d , and the full ideal in higher degrees. Conversely, every such subbundle defines an ideal, as its positive-degree products lie above degree d . This is the Grassmannian functor. The closed immersion and its inverse on the image are Theorem 13.3. This is not an inference from closed-point Torelli to unmarked deformation-groupoid equivalence. $\square$

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Additional disclosure for the present revision. GPT-6 Astra Pro assisted specifically with the conductor and collision models, the scalar-matrix degeneration, the flag-jet calculation, the reciprocal-polynomial fibre presentation, literature comparisons, and exact computational checks. The proofs above state the complete mathematical arguments; finite computations are consistency checks, not universal proof certificates. No journal decision or historical priority determination is inferred from the build and source audits.

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